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‘It kind of feels like nothing has changed’

As Cornell case stokes women’s rage, it raises questions about #MeToo progress

By Janelle Nanos
GLOBE STAFF

It was the screen grabs that did it.

Over the last week, as news spread about the lawsuit filed by Jane Doe, a former Cornell student who alleges that she was gang raped by seven Chi Phi fraternity brothers in 2024, the tenor of

the reaction on social media can perhaps best be described as white hot fury.

For many women, it was as if seeing the vile messages shared that night — the accused offenders advertised “free” sex on Snapchat, saying “you can walk in and whip it out” — had roused an army of sleeper cell agents into action. This incident, judging by the online out-

rage, was not just another #MeToo moment: It was cause for a flip-the-table, burn-it-all-down primal scream.

►Federal government quiet on sexual assault cases. **A2.**

As the actor Rati Gupta put it: “Maybe instead of Me Too, this round is [Expletive] Off.”

It’s been nearly a decade since the #MeToo hashtag went viral, and “it feels like ‘Groundhog Day,’” said Caitlin Lawson, a professor of

gender and media studies at Emmanuel College. “We’ve already talked about this. We already talked about how institutions fail survivors. We’ve talked about the myth of the perfect victim. We’ve done this before, but we’re here again, and so it kind of feels like nothing has changed.”

Feminist author Soraya Chemaly, whose 2018 book “Rage Becomes Her” chronicled the power of female anger, said American women have watched their rights

CORNELL, Page A5

Heating oil prices go through the roof

\$2 a gallon higher than last year; consumers brace

By Karyna Cheung
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

The heating oil trucks rumbling up to homes around New England these days are delivering more than fuel for the coming cold weather: a widening sense of dread, as the global energy shock caused by the Iran war pushes prices above \$6 a gallon.

In many places, prices are more than \$2 a gallon higher than last year, presenting some customers with the prospect of paying \$1,500 or more for a full tank.

And given how prices have jumped on so many other essentials, many heating oil customers say their household budgets are at a breaking point.

“Now you’re going to double my heating oil bill? This is just a slap in the face,” said Lisa Furman, who owns a home in Hancock County in northern Maine. “There’s no reason for this.”

She expects to pay \$3,400 for heating oil over the next 10 months, significantly more than the \$1,500 she’s used to spending on heating in a season.

A community therapist, Furman makes too much to qualify for federal heating assistance, so she’s cutting back on any expenses she can spare, and putting more purchases on her credit card.

“It’s this really weird, middle class place that I fall into,” Furman said.

In Massachusetts, the high energy costs prompted Governor Maura Healey to declare a

HEATING OIL, Page A6



PHOTOS BY ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

Above and below, children read together and played on computers at the Edgerley Family South Boston Club.

MASS. IN THE MIDDLE ON ‘STUDENT SCHOLARSHIPS’

Foes fear they’d take money from public schools, while backers say they would help all

By James Vaznis
GLOBE STAFF

A heated debate is intensifying over whether Massachusetts should join President Trump’s effort to expand school choice by creating “student scholarships” with taxpayer donations.

Teachers unions and other critics, who launched a new coalition against the measure Monday, are deriding the scholarships as a veiled attempt to bring school vouchers to Massachusetts. They say losing students could worsen financial hardships for districts, which rely heavily on per-



student aid.

“This is just another voucher scheme that is really about privatizing public education and will be extremely harmful to our students,” said Jessica Tang, president of the American Federation of Teachers Massachusetts, a union that represents educators in Boston, Lawrence, Lowell, and elsewhere.

But many philanthropic organizations and other supporters, who also have their own coalition, say the scholarships could be a boon for public school families, helping them pay

STUDENTS, Page A10

Info-overloaded parents dream of going old school

BETH TEITELL

Where did Janelle Bruno see that notification from the school? Was it on ParentSquare? In an email from the teacher, the district, the superintendent? Was it a text? Does she need to do something? Create an account, download an app, log on to a platform, monitor a portal, enter a code, add lunch funds, or . . . oh, God, the password. What was it?

Please don’t let it be pajama day. Wasn’t that next week???

“I’m losing control,” said Bruno, a mother of three in Charlestown and a photographer who runs her own business, Janelle Carmela Photography.

Oh, we haven’t even talked about the sports apps yet. TeamSnap,

GameChanger, Crossbar, Swimmingle, SwimmingleFan, and maybe one more, but she can’t remember.

Bruno’s two sons are playing town soccer and club soccer. That’s four teams, and on TeamSnap, one boy is identified as “b56-4” and the other is “b56-1.” “I don’t even know who’s who,” Bruno said.

The technical term for what’s going on is the “platformization of education.” Technology in the classroom existed way before the pandemic, but remote learning supercharged the category. And now the learning management systems, family engagement platforms, assessment, testing, and security tools, fee-management solutions, and who knows what else have escaped containment.

PLATFORMS, Page A10

The Trump administration is likely to continue its attempts to ban all international students from enrolling at Harvard University, lawyers told federal judges. **B1.**

Eva Marie Saint died at 102. She won an Oscar for her first movie, “On the Waterfront,” and starred opposite Cary Grant in the Alfred Hitchcock thriller “North by Northwest.” **C8.**

Cambridge tech firm HubSpot is laying off nearly 660 employees, about 7 percent of its workforce. **B7.**

Jury selection began in the trial of Matthew Farwell, accused of killing Sandra Birchmore. **B1.**

The ride-share giant Uber is acquiring Boston-based ezCater, one of the top office catering companies in the country, for \$2.3 billion. **B7.**

Suddenly, lasting summer

Wednesday: Sunny and warming up. High 65-70. Low 54-59.

Thursday: Heating up even more. High 72-77. Low 51-56.

Weather and Comics, G8-9.

Pizzas that deliver the goods

After eating far and wide, we’ve whittled it down to 12 — each one a compelling reason to break out of your pizza routine, writes Devra First. **G1.** Also check out the pizza lover’s style guide. **G4.**



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The Nation

Under Trump, a quiet take on sexual assault cases

Cornell reflects muted approach in second term

By Michael C. Bender
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — In President Trump's first term, news reports of sexual abuse allegations at San Jose State University prompted a Justice Department investigation that forced the school to make extensive policy changes and pay the victims, and to remain under federal monitoring for four years.

But the intense focus on allegations that a Cornell University student was assaulted by multiple men at a fraternity party has barely drawn a response from the federal government. The hands-off stance reflects the more muted approach that Trump's administration has taken to sexual abuse cases on campuses in his second term.

"I don't know that much

about it," Trump told reporters Thursday in response to a question about the case. "But Cornell is a fine school, and I'm sure they'll do what's right."

Government officials have not said whether they plan to investigate the allegations or the university's response under Title IX, the federal civil rights law that bans sex discrimination in education and allows federal officials to investigate university responses to such cases.

The administration's lack of action so far on the Cornell case comes amid an apparent drop from Trump's first term in resolved investigations of sexual assault, which are cases that end with a signed agreement to remedy violations of civil rights law, according to a review of public records. The administration has largely used Title IX to open dozens of investigations aimed at removing protections for transgender students, blocking transgender athletes from participating on female sports

teams, and eliminating gender-neutral bathrooms from schools.

During the initial 20 months of Trump's first term, the Education Department's Office for Civil Rights, which investigates discrimination complaints in schools, resolved more than 150 cases of sexual harassment and sexual violence, according to a public government database. The database does not show investigations that remain open.

In the first 20 months of Trump's second term, the same database shows the office has resolved one case. Julie Hartman, an Education Department spokesperson, said the department had resolved dozens of sexual harassment and sexual assault cases, but declined to provide documents or explain why they were not in the database. The New York Times could not independently verify the full scope of the department's claim.

The Justice Department, where civil rights investigators examine allegations of systemic

discrimination in colleges and universities under Title IX, has seen a similar shift away from sexual assault and harassment cases over Trump's two terms.

In addition to the San Jose State settlement, which resolved an investigation into the school's head athletic trainer abusing female student athletes, the department in Trump's first term also resolved an investigation into Utah State University after reports that the school had failed to respond to numerous reports of sexual assaults.

Civil rights lawyers who previously led investigative units at both departments said they would have opened investigations into Cornell by now.

Catherine E. Lhamon, who oversaw the Education Department's Office for Civil Rights under Presidents Joe Biden and Barack Obama, said the allegations had received "a wildly tepid response" from the university and the government. Shaheena Simons, who led the Justice De-

partment team focused on civil rights in schools under Trump and Biden, called the administration's lack of resolved cases by this point in Trump's term a sign that it doesn't take seriously its role vetting sexual assault allegations under Title IX.

A spokesperson for the Justice Department, Kiersten Pels, said the department "does not generally confirm or deny the existence of investigations," though it has announced other civil rights investigations.

The drop-off in resolved sexual misconduct investigations comes after a decades-long political battle in Washington over how to enforce the sexual discrimination ban under Title IX. Each of the past three presidential administrations has rewritten, or attempted to rewrite, those enforcement rules.

In 2011, Obama's administration issued a public letter telling colleges that sexual harassment and assault create an environment so hostile that women's ac-

cess to education is jeopardized and violates their civil rights.

Trump's administration rescinded that letter in 2017 and rewrote the guidelines, providing more protections for people facing accusations.

In 2024, Biden's administration attempted to overhaul those rules again, extending protections from sexual discrimination to transgender students. A federal court blocked the move, and the Education Department said last week it had formally repealed those changes.

But the most significant change to civil rights enforcement during Trump's second term has been his push for a broader reorientation of federal investigation targets. Those changes include ending the federal government's oversight in dozens of school desegregation orders, focusing on antisemitism cases that mostly stem from anti-Israel protests, and purging programs that promote diversity, equity, and inclusion.

DAILY BRIEFING



CHRIS O'MEARA/ASSOCIATED PRESS

A REGULAR BLACK SWAN EVENT — Steve Platt, also known as “the swan father,” chased a swan during the 46th annual swan roundup on Lake Morton in Lakeland, Fla., on Tuesday. City workers gather all the resident swans (both black ones and white ones) so that veterinarians can give them their yearly medical checkups.

California couple arrested on child abuse charges in surrogacy probe

LOS ANGELES — A California couple has been arrested on child abuse charges following an investigation into a surrogacy scheme involving at least 21 children ranging in age from a few months to 13 years, authorities said Tuesday.

Guojun Xuan, 66, and his wife, Silvia Zhang, 39, face several counts of child abuse, as

well as conspiracy to commit child abuse, accessory after the fact, and dissuading a witness, Los Angeles County District Attorney Nathan Hochman said.

“This case is unprecedented. It is horrific,” Hochman said during a news conference Tuesday morning. “The physical abuse, beating, and punishment that these very young children

received is despicable.”

Prosecutors are seeking \$100 million bail for the couple because of the serious nature of the charges and because they are flight risks, Hochman said. They were scheduled to be arraigned at the Pasadena courthouse later Tuesday.

Fifteen children were removed from the couple's opu-

lent home in Arcadia last year after an allegation of abuse, and another six living elsewhere were also located. They ranged in age from 2 months to 13 years, with most between 1 and 3. Police believe Zhang gave birth to one or two of the children while the rest were carried and delivered by surrogates.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

2nd person charged in B.C. shootings

SEATTLE — Federal authorities arrested and charged a 30-year-old from Washington state on Tuesday in connection with a February school shooting in British Columbia.

The US attorney's office in Seattle says James Cody Bryant of Bellingham, Wash., communicated with the 18-year-old shooter for six months ahead of time. Bryant, who identifies as female, did not report the shooter's plans to authorities and conspired with her to broadcast the attacks, authorities allege.

“Without Bryant's misplaced loyalty and willingness to operate the livestream, we don't ultimately know if the

shooter would have gone through with the crime,” said W. Mike Herrington, the special agent in charge of the FBI's Seattle office.

Authorities say Jesse Van Rootselaar killed eight people and wounded 25 others. She first killed her mother and stepbrother at home before attacking a nearby school in the mountain community of Tumbler Ridge, killing five children ages 12 and 13 at the school as well as an educational assistant. It was Canada's deadliest mass shooting in years.

Van Rootselaar was later found dead from an apparent self-inflicted gunshot wound.

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Alito displeased by rhetoric about court

WASHINGTON — Supreme Court Justice Samuel Alito says the escalating volume of emergency appeals before the court isn't a good thing, but he adds there's little the court can do to change the trajectory.

The number of petitions asking the justices to intervene quickly has skyrocketed during President Trump's second administration, putting the court at the center of hotly debated issues such as the Republican president's new ballroom construction and his proposed restrictions on mail-in ballots in the midterm elections.

The number of emergency applications now rivals the annual tally of cases the justices

consider with full briefing and oral arguments, Alito wrote in a new book released Tuesday.

The justice said in a rare interview that the rhetoric about the court from Trump doesn't sit well with him.

“I personally am not pleased with that,” he said. “Everybody in this country has the right to criticize what we do. The substance of their criticism can be quite harsh. If we deserve it, then that's fine. But rhetoric is a different story.”

Alito spoke in connection with his first book, “So Ordered: An Originalist's View of The Constitution, The Court and Our Country.”

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Tenn. woman who survived execution regains consciousness

Christa Pike, a Tennessee inmate who survived Tennessee's attempt to execute her, is awake and speaking as she receives treatment at a hospital, her attorneys said Tuesday.

Pike's attorneys said her prognosis is still unclear “and said she faces “a long recovery.”

“Against all odds, Christa Pike is conscious, speaking, and continues to receive critical medical care,” attorneys for Pike

said in a statement. “Despite the severe damage she endured to her arms, she is still handcuffed and shackled to the bed. Her recovery is medically unprecedented.”

Her attorneys said they are grateful for the first responders and the medical team at the hospital “who treated Christa like a human and have provided exceptional care to her.”

The statement was the first

indication that Pike has improved since an ambulance carried her away from a Nashville prison last Wednesday.

Pike survived two doses of pentobarbital as the state attempted to put her to death for the 1995 beating and stabbing death of Colleen Slemmer. The lethal injection drug didn't kill her, but her lawyers said her arms were left burned.

ASSOCIATED PRESS



AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Christa Pike's attorneys have asked that her sentence be reduced to life in prison.

An alluring catch in Florida's Keys isn't fish. It's drugs.

Man's sentence shows smuggling is 'alive and well'

By David Ovalle
NEW YORK TIMES

Plastic-wrapped bricks of drugs floating in the waters of the Florida Keys are common enough that they have a locally flavored nickname: square grouper.

This summer, lobster divers plucked a brick of cocaine from the waters off Big Pine Key, about 30 miles northeast of Key West. The boat captain, unable to find any sheriff's deputies once she anchored, left the brick — printed with a fiery sun, praying hands, and the words “With God” in Spanish — on the hood of a fire-rescue ambulance.

Eager to score an easy payday — the bricks can fetch tens of thousands of dollars — others are not so honest.

Consider John Strama, a longtime boat builder and mechanic in the Keys who led a ring of people recently sentenced to prison for distributing cocaine found at sea. Strama, 44, used his knowledge of local waterways, tides, and currents to home in on cocaine bricks that either fell off boats or were dumped by spooked traffickers, federal prosecutors said.

“Fishing for ‘square groups’ in the waters off the Florida Keys is not a harmless pastime. It is drug trafficking,” Jason A. Reding Quiñones, the US attorney for the Southern District of Florida, said in August.

The drug trade in the Keys has ebbed and flowed over decades, but cocaine is seeing a resurgence globally. Rick Ramsay, the sheriff of Monroe County, said packages of cocaine surface nearly every week, a consistent pattern, though a string of recent cases have drawn more attention than usual.

Although the Trump administration has ordered strikes on what it says are suspected drug boats in the Caribbean, the operations have taken place far from the Keys, making it unlikely that they are causing more cocaine to end up adrift. Neither the Coast Guard nor the Drug Enforcement Administration responded to requests for information.

The Keys remain an ideal place to off-load drugs: The island chain offers hundreds of miles of coastline dense with mangroves and tiny spoil islands that make good spots to hide from the law.

During the heyday of the marijuana trade in the 1970s,

traffickers enlisted commercial fishing boat captains and crews in the region. For some local teens, racing to catch bales of pot ditched at sea became something of a sport.

Strama, a father of four, knew the trade as a child, according to one of his lawyers, Sam Rabin. “His father sent him to sea alone to search for floating bales of marijuana,” Rabin wrote in a sentencing memo before a judge gave Strama 10 years in prison.

More than a few Keys residents made fortunes off their hauls as square grouper became local lore. Restaurants, T-shirts, and bumper stickers bear the sobriquet. Residents rode square grouper floats at parades in Key West.

Over time, drug traffickers off the Florida coast have changed their tactics. In the 1980s, cocaine smugglers knifed through the ocean on “Miami Vice”-style speed boats that could easily outrun police boats. Today, they are more likely to use inconspicuous sailboats or freighters, Ramsay said.

The packages are typically marked with numbers or symbols identifying their intended buyers, he said. Bricks stamped “333” have repeatedly popped up recently. On Friday, someone cleaning a popular state park found a package featuring the cat from “Tom and Jerry.”

“Drug smuggling in the Keys is alive and well,” Ramsay said.

Square grouper has occasionally proved deadly.

In 2011, a Keys man died of a cocaine overdose after ingesting drugs from a brick he found while on a fishing boat with his brother. Four years later, sheriff's deputies discovered a young couple shot to death inside their Keys home, victims of a dispute that stemmed from the sale of cocaine that had been found at sea by a charter boat crew. A boat mate is serving life in prison for the murders.

Last month, Bradford Picariello, who owns Outlaw Fishing Charters in Marathon, Fla., pleaded not guilty after a federal indictment charged that he sold a brick of cocaine found at sea to an undercover investigator. Picariello, 66, faces between 10 years and life in prison if convicted.

Discovering cocaine at sea played out differently for Danielle Nutten, the boat captain who left a brick on an ambulance in August. Nutten tossed the brick in the center console of her truck and drove around Big Pine Key looking for the authorities, a decision she now says might have gone wrong had she been pulled over.

The World

250,000 rally for schools in France

Anger mounts as police clash with protesters

By Nicolas Garriga and Oleg Cetinic
ASSOCIATED PRESS

PARIS — Police fired tear gas to control crowds in Paris and elsewhere in France on Tuesday as more than a quarter of a million people rallied nationwide to support school pupils demanding more education funding, according to government figures. The protests increased pressure on the administration of outgoing President Emmanuel Macron.

As pupils again blockaded high schools, large crowds waving flags and placards gathered in Marseille, Strasbourg, and other cities. The demonstrations showed how protests that began at a high school in the Paris region in mid-September have grown into a nationwide movement — the latest of many that have marked Macron’s nearly decade-long tenure.

“We need to listen to them,” said Léa Monimart, a demonstrator in the northern city of Lille. “They are 17 years old; they are not completely clueless, and they know what they are talking about. It’s important to show that there are adults who support them.”

The Interior Ministry estimated that 256,000 people took part in demonstrations across the country on Tuesday, including 56,000 in Paris, where small groups of protesters clashed with riot officers at a city square during a largely peaceful march through the city.

The widespread use of arrests, tear gas, and riot-control weapons against teenagers is fueling defiance and angering some parents and teachers.

Interior Minister Laurent Nuñez said that the police re-



JEREMIAS GONZALEZ/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Demonstrators rallied during a protest against under-resourced schools, in Rennes, western France, on Tuesday.

sponse had been proportionate in “almost all cases,” and that the protests had at times turned into riots, requiring police intervention.

French Prime Minister Sébastien Lecornu said the government and school leaders must listen to students’ concerns and find solutions.

Questioned in parliament on Tuesday about the protest movement, Lecornu denounced “ultra violence” threatening schools. Responding to criticism of police tactics, he pledged that any “accidents” would be investigated and described allegations that the police are racist as a “lie.”

More than two weeks of class boycotts, school blockades, and

policing that has led to more than 6,100 arrests, mostly of minors have become a flashpoint in the early days of the presidential election campaign.

Felix Barney, a university student, described the police response as disproportionate, saying it doesn’t make “any sense to hit minors.”

“Riot police, batons, rubber bullets, tear gas,” said Aurélien Le Coq, a lawmaker with the far-left France Unbowed party. Its presidential candidate is strongly backing the protests.

The violence is “absolutely unbearable,” Le Coq said.

Nuñez defended police tactics despite a growing number of severe injuries blamed on officers’ riot-control weapons. In

the latest case, a 15-year-old boy lost a hand Monday in an incident involving a police stun grenade. He said 715 officers had been injured.

The teenage protesters have struck a chord amid widespread discontent in France. Frustrations extend beyond immediate difficulties, such as fuel prices that have soared because of the Iran war, to broader concerns about constraints on public spending, rising poverty, and wealth inequality under Macron, who can’t run for a third consecutive term.

Against that backdrop, pupils’ complaints that education funding shortfalls are endangering their futures have found a sympathetic audience.

“You say ‘young people are the future,’ so listen to them,” read a handwritten placard attached to a metal barrier outside a Paris school.

At the Hélène Boucher lycée, or high school, in Paris’ 20th district, protesters tipped over trash cans and bicycles onto their sides to create a makeshift barricade.

Like hundreds of others around the country, the school was closed. Authorities began shutting schools last week to take some steam out of the demonstrations after widespread damage to schools and mounting injuries among staff, students, and police. Classes were totally or partially suspended on Tuesday at 891 schools.

Research on ‘ghost’ particles honored

US physicist awarded Nobel

By Adithi Ramakrishnan, Stefanie Dazio, and Kostya Manenkov
ASSOCIATED PRESS

STOCKHOLM — Francis Halzen won the Nobel Prize in physics Tuesday for his efforts to demystify a rare group of neutrinos, tiny cosmic particles that researchers believe offer clues to how the universe evolved.

“It was a great surprise, and I obviously didn’t expect it,” Halzen said, speaking to the Nobel Physics Committee by phone from Italy, in a call broadcast at the news conference to announce the winner.

Halzen, a Belgian-born physicist at the University of Wisconsin-Madison, said the work was a massive collaborative effort. He was working on a research proposal when the Nobel committee called just before lunchtime.

“I hope that this prize will help getting it approved,” he said to chuckles from the audience.

Neutrinos are tiny cosmic particles with no electric charge and extraordinarily small mass, making them difficult to detect. Yet they are everywhere: They spew from stars like the sun, and trillions zip through our bodies every second.

Scientists cannot glimpse the mysterious ghost particles zooming around on their own, so they measure what happens when the particles collide with other bits of matter. Neutrinos bump into other particles only rarely, so scientists build large detectors to improve their odds of catching collisions.

Halzen had the idea to turn the vast Antarctic ice into such a detector. The Nobel committee said his work was instrumental to the construction of the IceCube Neutrino Observatory in Antarctica, which glimpsed the first high-energy neutrinos from faraway galaxies.

“This experiment in the Antarctic is a revolutionary way of understanding the universe that we didn’t have before,” said Michael Moloney, chief executive for the American Institute of Physics.

When a neutrino interacts with ice in the detector, it produces a flash of light that’s picked up by sensors. The transparent ice makes it easier for scientists to pick up on faint signals from the particles, and the sensors are buried about 8,200 feet deep to protect against interference from cosmic rays and radiation.

“People always thought this was a cute idea, right, but it would never work,” Halzen said at a news conference hosted by his university, which also operates the observatory. “The greatest surprise is that we did make it work.”

The 82-year-old scientist helped pull back the curtain on an elusive crew of neutrinos that scientists say carry clues about the development of other galaxies and the universe as a whole.

“It’s all part of working out the story of where we are in the universe, what’s our place in the universe, how did our galaxy form?” said Jonathan Bagger, chief executive of the American Physical Society.

Supported by the National Science Foundation, the IceCube Neutrino Observatory involves more than 400 scientists in 14 countries.

“IceCube is like no other telescope in the world,” the university’s interim chancellor, Eric M. Wilcots, said in a news release. “And there is no other scientist quite like Francis Halzen, whose idea to create a neutrino detector under almost a mile of ice has led to a remarkable multinational and multi-institutional scientific collaboration and a fundamental shift in how we think about the universe.”

DAILY BRIEFING

Drones strike two commercial ships in the Black Sea

SOFIA, Bulgaria — Bulgarian Prime Minister Rumen Radev said two commercial vessels were struck by drones on Tuesday in the first attack on shipping in the NATO member’s exclusive economic zone in the Black Sea.

“This is an unacceptable attack in Bulgaria’s exclusive economic zone,” Radev said. “It is a blatant violation of international law and maritime law.”

Speaking after an emergency government meeting, Radev said sea and aerial drones attacked the ships at around 3 a.m., about 80 miles off Bulgaria’s coast.

The Togo-flagged Alfa Watan suffered critical structural damage and sank at the scene. The second vessel, the Palau-flagged Able, caught fire after the attack. A Bulgarian ferry evacuated all 18 crew members. Two suffered severe injuries and were flown to a hospital in Varna.

The origin of the drones was not immediately established.

According to the available information, the Able was carrying wheat and sailing south, while the Alfa Watan was heading north. The Alfa Watan’s cargo was unknown, Radev said.

The attacks came a day after a Turkish-owned cargo ship carrying corn caught fire following a drone attack and later sank in the Black Sea. Two people died and 11 crew members were rescued, Romanian authorities said.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky described that attack as “a horrific strike by two Russian drones on a civilian vessel” in neutral waters.

ASSOCIATED PRESS



KARIM JAAFAR/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

OVER THE HUMP — A handler led his camels during a training session at sunset in Al-Shahaniya, west of Doha, on Thursday, ahead of Qatar’s upcoming camel racing season.

City accused of padding census numbers

In Japan, one of the world’s most rapidly graying societies, officials often face pressure to stem the tide of demographic decline, which can bring budget cuts and public shame. Now, one city is being accused of inflating its numbers to avoid the appearance of a shrinking population.

Regional police raided city hall in Toyama, in western Japan, on Saturday after a central government ministry said it had found inconsistencies during a review of census data. Japan’s Ministry of Internal Affairs said last week that it had filed a complaint against city officials involved with the

census, accusing them of inflating population numbers by adding empty households to the survey.

Experts say the falsification claims reflect the extremes that some local governments will go through to maintain at least the appearance of stable population levels. Japan’s population peaked at 128 million in 2008, and currently stands at 123 million people, roughly the same size it was in 1989.

Mayor Hirohisa Fujii of Toyama apologized in a statement Saturday and said that city officials would cooperate fully with the probe.

NEW YORK TIMES

Canada leader downplays separatists’ win

TORONTO — Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney said Tuesday that Quebec should focus on immediate economic challenges rather than wait for a possible independence referendum years from now, a day after the separatist Parti Québécois returned to power.

Carney said he would respond to the prospect of another referendum by working with Quebec through “cooperative federalism” while focusing on affordable housing, economic growth, infrastructure, and support for workers affected by President Trump’s tariffs.

“This is a crucial time for our country. It is a crucial time for Quebec,” Carney said. “This is not a time to wait for something a few years down the road. It’s the time to act. It’s a time for boldness.”

Carney said he spoke Tuesday morning with Quebec Premier-designate Paul St-Pierre Plamondon, congratulated him, and discussed infrastructure funding and support for workers in the province affected by the US trade war.

St-Pierre Plamondon has pledged to hold another referendum on Quebec independence.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

UK police arrest seventh man in air base terror plot

LONDON — British police on Tuesday arrested a 22-year-old man in London on suspicion of a terror offense over a security incident at a US-run military air base in England that authorities have linked to Iran.

The arrest is the seventh in connection with a suspected plot against RAF Fairford, located 100 miles west of Lon-

don, which has been used by American planes to strike Iran during this year’s war.

Police have released few details of their investigation into an incident that sparked speculation and concern — and was followed days later by the removal of US bombers from the base.

Five British men in their 20s were detained near the perime-

ter of the base in the early hours of Sept. 27, and a 25-year-old British-Iranian man was arrested in London on Thursday. All six have been released on bail under investigation.

The UK-owned base has been used by American B-1 and B-52 bombers during the ongoing Iran war.

ASSOCIATED PRESS



AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

The Fairford base was being used by US bombers.



ARUN SANKAR/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Members of the Communist Party of India’s student wing were detained by police at a protest against the culling of voting rolls.

India cuts 130m from voter rolls, sparking protests

By Mujib Mashal and Pragati K.B.
NEW YORK TIMES

NEW DELHI — Nearly 1 billion people in the world’s biggest democracy are being asked to show documents to prove that they should keep the right to vote.

The exercise is billed by an election commission appointed by Prime Minister Narendra Modi as cleaning India’s voter roll of duplicates and discrepancies. So far, it has expunged more than 130 million names — more than the population of Mexico.

Tens of millions of voters have been flagged by algorithms for deletion over anomalies in their information. Millions who have appealed their deletions remain stuck in adjudication, deprived of their right to vote during close-fought elections earlier this year. Some removed for being dead are challenging the decision based on the fact they are alive.

Public anger is turning into widespread protests, as evidence piles up that the exercise is disenfranchising parts of society seen as less likely to support Modi’s ruling Hindu nationalist party. India’s 200 million Mus-

lims appear to have been disproportionately targeted.

Protesters are calling for the resignation of Gyanesh Kumar, chief of the election commission, a body that was long held in high regard for running relatively fair polls in a region with a history of coups and autocratic governance.

“The heart of our democracy, which is the right to vote, is at great peril,” Rohinton Nariman, a former solicitor general of India and a supreme court judge, said in a lecture last week.

The exercise, which began last summer in one state before being expanded to every voter in the country, has struck the biggest blow to election integrity in India’s more than seven decades as a republic, former Indian polling officials and analysts say. The anger is intensifying on the back of recent revelations that officials within the election commission and the Supreme Court have expressed reservations about the revision.

“The entire approach has changed from making the rolls inclusive,” said Ashok Lavasa, a former election commissioner.

“The effort, and the priority, seems to be getting rid of people on the slightest pretext.”

While previous revisions of the voter roll focused on “physical verification, door to door” to make sure that every citizen was included, he said the current process puts the onus of proof entirely on citizens and otherwise excludes them. That leaves a large section of the electorate at the mercy of algorithms and mistakes in old records that could largely be clerical errors, he said.

To be sure, inaccuracies in the voter roll, which included about 970 million names before the recent revisions, have long been a fixture in a country where tens of millions of people are on the move for work, enabling abuses by some. But the list is routinely updated before every local and national election, and public faith in the electoral system was strong enough that the impact of the remaining discrepancies was believed to be marginal. Modi won three terms in office through elections based on the voter roll before the nationwide revision, and his Bharatiya Janata Party flour-

ished.

The sudden discovery and deletion of more than 20 million dead people and 90 million others categorized as “absent, shifted, and others,” has cast doubt about the integrity of previous elections or raised suspicion about the ruling party’s intentions for upcoming ones, analysts and opposition leaders say.

Since a weaker showing in 2024 national elections, Modi’s party has strung together a series of wins at the state level, including flipping one large state that it had never won based on a revised voter list. The next national election is in 2029.

Election commission officials did not respond to multiple requests for comment. Leaders of Modi’s party have rejected the uproar as fomented by a struggling opposition, which had earlier asked for similar revisions.

Two senior officials who would talk about the governing party’s strategy only anonymously said the process was aimed at entrenching its electoral advantage. The officials asked not be named for fear of retribution.

Kenya records its first confirmed Ebola case, death

By Evelynne Musambi
ASSOCIATED PRESS

NAIROBI — A Kenyan citizen who had been living in Congo before returning to Nairobi over the weekend became Kenya’s first confirmed case of Ebola and the country’s first death from the disease in the fast-moving outbreak, authorities said Tuesday, sparking urgent contact-tracing efforts to try to contain the spread of the virus.

The man had been residing in Congo for the past seven years and fell ill about a month ago. He was treated at various hospitals before traveling by road to Kampala, Uganda, where he boarded a flight to the Kenyan capital, arriving on Saturday afternoon, Health Minister Aden Duale said.

Health authorities in Kenya have placed the country’s border points on high alert and are monitoring for possible additional cases.

Duale said that the man had been isolated and treated at Nairobi Hospital, where he tested positive for the Ebola virus and died late Monday.

Ebola is highly contagious and spreads in the human population through contact with bodily fluids such as vomit, blood, or semen, and with contaminated surfaces and materials such as bedding and clothing.

The current outbreak was declared in mid-May, months after it had been spreading in a remote part of eastern Congo. At least 8,400 cases have been recorded, including more than

4,000 deaths, according to government data, making it the fastest-growing outbreak of the disease in history.

Kenya has never had an outbreak of Ebola, according to the Kenya Medical Research Institute.

The country hosts a United States-funded isolation center for American citizens exposed to Ebola to quarantine for 21 days before traveling back to the United States. The isolation facility faced legal battles and deadly protests by locals who feared it was exposing them to the virus.

Kenya is the fourth country to record an Ebola case in the current outbreak. Uganda has recorded 20 cases and France one. Before Kenya reported its case, there had been no active

cases outside Congo since Uganda declared its outbreak over in late August.

Duale said that 28 contacts of the man who had returned on Saturday had been identified. Another 23 passengers on the flight and four crew members, who traveled on the same plane from Uganda, were being traced.

The contacts will remain in isolation for 21 days and will be released after testing negative for the virus, said the ministry’s director-general, Dr. Patrick Amoth.

After the man arrived in Nairobi, his relatives took him in a private vehicle to Nairobi Hospital, where he was immediately isolated. He was buried Tuesday afternoon in accordance with public safety protocols.

German far right claims first state speaker since 1945

AfD member will lead legislature

By Christopher F. Schuetze
NEW YORK TIMES

MAGDEBURG, Germany — A normally ho-hum procedural vote in a small state was closely watched across Germany on Tuesday, when a far-right politician was elected to lead a state legislature for the first time since the Nazi era.

In the legislative election last month in the state of Saxony-Anhalt, the Alternative for Germany party, labeled “suspected extremist” by Germany’s domestic intelligence service, won 39 of 83 seats. The party, known by its German initials AfD, far outperformed every other party, delivering a shock to the country’s postwar consensus.

The next step toward taking power occurred Tuesday, when lawmakers were sworn in and elected the AfD’s Tobias Rausch as president of the parliament. In that role, Rausch, 35, will preside over the legislative agenda, parliamentary bureaucracy, and ceremonial roles, like hosting memorials commemorating the Holocaust.

In the anonymous vote, 48 lawmakers voted for Rausch, meaning that he received the support of some members of mainstream parties that have officially refused to work with the AfD.

A higher, more important hurdle awaits in December, when the state parliament is expected to fill the most powerful state position, minister president — the equivalent of governor, with control of the executive branch. It is unclear if the AfD’s candidate, Ulrich Siegmund, can win that vote; until then, Sven Schulze of the Christian Democrats remains acting governor of Saxony-Anhalt, one of Germany’s least populous states, with about 2.1 million people.

The party has made it clear that it does not intend to allow business as usual.

The AfD successfully ran on an anti-immigration, antiestablishment, pro-fossil fuel campaign, but such issues are decided on the federal level, beyond the reach of a state government. At the state level, it plans to focus on education and culture issues.

During the campaign, Siegmund vowed to segregate schools, separating the children of asylum seekers from other students, and to replace all rainbow flags in schools with German flags. The party has called for more patriotic arts from institutions that rely on state funding.

In the state parliament, the AfD tried to solidify its power by increasing the number of seats on the legislative committees from 11 to 12, giving the party six seats rather than five. After threats of lawsuits by the other parties, it backed down.

But the party still plans to try to create and fill a second state

legislative vice presidential seat, giving it more control over the day-to-day running of the house.

On a symbolic level, it has shuffled the traditional seating arrangement in the legislative chamber. Rather than be positioned on the far right, the AfD will sit in the center, a statement of how it sees itself. The progressive Greens will sit on the farthest right.

While the AfD’s result last month was historic — it won 44 percent of the vote, more than double its performance five years ago — it fell three seats short of a majority in the state parliament, so it cannot elect the state’s leaders on its own. (The conservative Christian Democrats, long the state’s dominant party, fell from 40 seats to just 15.)

Although coalitions are common in Germany, the mainstream parties have refused to work with the AfD in forming

‘I’m not a hard-liner; I’m pragmatic.’

TOBIAS RAUSCH, of the Alternative for Germany party, to the DPA, a German newswire

governments. But a new, fringe party said its five legislators would vote for Rausch, enough to make him the parliament leader.

That party, the Sahra Wagenknecht Alliance, was formed in 2024, in a split from the Left party.

It has vowed not to vote for Siegmund for governor, so the AfD will have to look elsewhere for those votes — and it could find them, if the vote Tuesday was anything to go by. Rausch won the support of at least four lawmakers who aren’t members of the AfD or the Sahra Wagenknecht Alliance.

Although the AfD went into this election with a number of extremist politicians, Rausch is portrayed in the German news media as somewhat more moderate.

“I’m not a hard-liner; I’m pragmatic,” he recently told the DPA, a German newswire. Unlike others being sworn in Tuesday, he also has plenty of experience, having sat in the statehouse since 2016 and having run the AfD parliamentary group since 2021.

But Rausch is not without controversy. The AfD was caught up this year in a scandal involving its deputies hiring the family members of other deputies, in a kind of circular nepotism network that ensured that state money that goes to running lawmakers’ offices would stay in their families.

Rausch was at the center of the furor. He has publicly acknowledged that his siblings and friends from his soccer club were once hired either by his office or by others in the AfD.

Ex-CIA officer who hid gold admits to far larger \$145m scam

Details revealed amid guilty plea

By Devlin Barrett
NEW YORK TIMES

ALEXANDRIA, Va. — A former CIA officer who authorities say stashed hundreds of gold bars in his home admitted in court on Tuesday to a far larger web of deception, including a \$145 million scam involving luxury real estate and providing sensitive intelligence to a foreign government official.

The shocking details of the case were revealed in federal court in Alexandria, Va., where David J. Rush pleaded guilty to a single count of wire fraud, which could earn him up to 20 years behind bars.

The new details of his crimes, however, far surpassed what had been known about the unusual case, even as they in some ways deepened the mystery of an episode at the heart of America’s in-

telligence community that has been cloaked in secrecy.

Those crimes included his admission in court that he had shared the identity of a human source with a foreign government, a grave violation of what is among the CIA’s most highly protected secrets.

CIA Director John Ratcliffe said Rush had “abused his position and betrayed the public trust and should be held fully accountable for his actions.”

Rush, a 49-year-old former intelligence officer, was arrested in May after investigators found roughly 300 gold bars stashed in the basement of his Virginia home. US officials have previously said he created a fake classified program — one that only a few people were permitted to know about — that allowed him to accumulate the bars, worth more than \$40 million.

In court on Tuesday, a federal prosecutor, Kevin Hakala, described far more sweeping and



JUSTICE DEPARTMENT VIA ASSOCIATED PRESS

This image provided by the Department of Justice showed gold and cash that was seized from David J. Rush’s home.

potentially consequential crimes beyond the gold bar scam. In all, the schemes totaled more than \$193 million in fraud.

In October 2025, Rush used his “position of trust” as a senior CIA officer to create a fake secret government program to purchase roughly \$145 million

worth of “luxury real estate in South Florida,” Hakala said. All the luxury properties were in the Palm Beach area, according to court papers.

The funds for the purchases were transferred to a holding company by a government contractor who expected to be reim-

bursed, officials said. Rush planned to also have expensive renovations done on the properties so they could be resold for profit, the prosecutor said.

Separately, in 2025, Rush knowingly disclosed “certain descriptive information of a US government clandestine human source” to a “foreign government official,” Hakala told Judge Michael S. Nachmanoff of the US District Court for the Eastern District of Virginia.

Prosecutors did not explain further, and a portion of Rush’s guilty plea was conducted under seal. Court papers, however, say that on April 28, during an interview conducted by the CIA, Rush admitted to disclosing the information to a foreign official.

Rush also orchestrated a scheme in which he arranged to take roughly \$1.8 million in private charter flights, paid for by the government, that had no legitimate purpose, prosecutors said.

After prosecutors recounted his crimes in open court, Rush, wearing an olive green prison jumpsuit, agreed that he had committed those acts.

A lawyer for Rush declined to comment outside court. His sentencing was scheduled for January.

Officials say they learned about the full details of Rush’s schemes after he was arrested.

When FBI agents first searched his house, they said they found 303 gold bars. In court on Tuesday, prosecutors said that the correct number was 298 gold bars, and that they had cost the government more than \$46 million to obtain. As part of that scheme, Rush told colleagues that he had given the gold to others as part of the secret program, when in fact he had taken them from his office in Loudoun County, Va., to his home nearby.

“The program did not exist,” Hakala said in court.

Olympian seeks inquiry in Reflecting Pool case

WASHINGTON — Lawyers for a former Olympian who was cleared of charges of vandalizing the Lincoln Memorial Reflecting Pool are asking internal government watchdogs to investigate the conduct of senior Justice and Interior Department officials, accusing prosecutors of indicting him despite knowing that a renovation of the pool was failing.

In a letter sent Tuesday to the inspectors general for those agencies, lawyers for the former athlete, David Hearn, say the agencies ignored their own evidence in a rush to satisfy President Trump's desire for criminal charges. Prosecutors then provided a court "blatantly false" information about when they became aware that the real culprit for the badly peeling liner in the pool was a botched renovation overseen by Trump, his lawyers wrote.

"Because of the actions of various DOJ and DOI employees, Mr. Hearn was deprived of his liberty, indicted for a crime he did not commit, threatened with incarceration of up to 10 years and endured the defaming of his name and reputation by high-ranking government officials," Hearn's lawyers wrote. Among the lawyers requesting the investigation is Michael Bromwich, a former inspector general at the Justice Department. Representatives for the inspectors general and the office of Jeanine Pirro, the US attorney in Washington, did not immediately respond to messages seeking comment. Pirro has defended her decision to pursue the prosecution and blamed the Interior Department for not providing relevant evidence in time. But the letter from Hearn's lawyers says that her office knew at least a day before it took the case to a grand jury that the pool liner had been failing for weeks. "In its motion to dismiss, the

government claims it first learned of the liner's pervasive failures during a defense expert's inspection on July 17, 2026," Hearn's lawyers wrote. "This is blatantly false and is directly refuted by the government's own file."

NEW YORK TIMES

Russian oligarch: Trump Jr. paid him back for celebration

NEW YORK — The Russian oligarch who helped bankroll Donald Trump Jr.'s wedding celebration says the president's eldest son has paid back the money.

"Yes, he did," Umar Kremlev told an International Boxing Association press conference in Istanbul on Tuesday. "He did repay the money I spent on the present." Still, he said he felt the repayment was unnecessary. "Frankly speaking, I do not understand why he decided to do so," he went on. "There are all kinds of events organized by all kinds of people. It is as if I invite you to come and visit my country house. Would you expect me to issue an invoice to them afterward?" Speaking through an interpreter, he said that would be "ridiculous."

ProPublica, a nonprofit investigative website, reported last month that Kremlev, who has close ties to Russian President Vladimir Putin, "footed the bill for hundreds of thousands of dollars of wedding expenses" when Trump Jr. married socialite Bettina Anderson in the Bahamas in May. That included paying to rent one of two private islands where the three-day party was held.

In a subsequent post on her Instagram page signed by the couple, Bettina Trump wrote that they had been married "surrounded ONLY by our family," but that Kremlev, head of the boxing association, was a "dear friend" who "very generously hosted two incredible nights of celebrations for us AFTER our wedding."



SAJJAD HUSSAIN/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES/FILE

Umar Kremlev, a Russian oligarch who has close ties to Russian President Vladimir Putin, said Donald Trump Jr. has repaid him money spent on Trump's wedding celebrations.

President Trump, who did not attend the nuptials, previously defended the arrangement but told reporters that the money would be paid back.

"It's totally allowed," he said. "But, as I understand it, he paid them back."

Kremlev, who was recently honored with the Order of Friendship by Putin, also played down the significance, saying the celebration was "a shared event" and "people blew it out of proportion."

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Trump doesn't commit to repaying federal funds

WASHINGTON — A day after President Trump said he would start paying for controversial taxpayer-funded ads with a campaign account, there's no sign he plans to refund the millions of federal dollars already spent on them.

Nearly \$12 million worth of ads have already aired, according to AdImpact, as part of the \$20 million the Homeland Security Department tapped for the contract.

But Trump's plan to pay for the ads with MAGA Inc. doesn't mean there's any reimbursement coming, said a White House official who was not authorized to talk publicly and spoke on the condition of anonymity.

Speaking to reporters Tuesday, Trump said the ads were "really good" and "promotion for the country, done by many presi-

dents before." Asked whether he'd repay the already spent funds, he said, "we'll decide."

Senate Democratic leader Chuck Schumer slammed Trump for not committing to reimbursement and said he believes the president's plan for covering future costs represents illegal coordination with his super PAC.

"Trump must return this money to the American people, and there must be a full investigation into this gross waste and abuse of taxpayer dollars," Schumer told the Associated Press.

The four ads, which began airing in late September, glorify Trump and echo his political messaging going into the midterms. One features a clip of Trump talking about the threat of communism and another is a replay of an ad from his last presidential campaign.

Republicans and Democrats alike have said the ads aren't an appropriate use of US government money. Senate majority leader John Thune, a Republican from South Dakota, said they shouldn't be paid for with taxpayer dollars.

Legal experts said the ads might even violate federal statutes, including a law against congressionally appropriated money being used for "publicity or propaganda" and another limiting the partisan political activities of government employees.

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Shock gloves to be used by ICE found to cause pain, fear

Agency knew of effects before sale

By Ryan J. Foley

ASSOCIATED PRESS

The shock gloves immigration agents could soon use to control detainees and protesters worked so powerfully during a military exercise that participants felt intense pain, stopped fighting immediately, and feared additional exposures, according to a previously unreleased Army study.

Immigration and Customs Enforcement leaders were aware of the findings before signing a \$16.7 million contract to purchase 6,000 pairs of shock gloves in August, according to records obtained by the watchdog group American Oversight and shared with the Associated Press.

The shocks had a profound impact on Army employees who played the role of combative prisoners during the exercise, which took place at the military prison at Fort Leavenworth in Kansas in October 2024. The participants, several of whom were large-statured men, stopped resisting seconds after officers applied shocks by touching gloves to their skin, and were left with "fatigue, soreness, and excessive apprehensiveness to being shocked again," the study found.

"After experiencing the effects of the GLOVE ... participants stated just seeing the GLOVE was enough to make them want to comply," the authors wrote.

ICE has called the gloves "distraction and de-escalation devices" that will be safer than other non-lethal options to subdue targets for arrest and deportation and protesters who create civil disturbances. The agency has argued the rapid compliance they

cause will keep officers safer and prevent incidents from requiring potentially lethal force.

But critics have warned the gloves will give ICE another weapon to intimidate and brutalize people even as the agency is under fire for excessive force that has left a trail of deaths and injuries across the nation. The gloves, they note, are easy to discharge, do not leave a mark, and have not been extensively used in settings outside of jails. The manufacturer warns they should not be used on high-risk populations such as kids, pregnant women, or disabled people.

"The military assessment in ICE's own files shows that these gloves can cause 'intense pain' and force compliance. It does not establish that they are safe," said Chioma Chukwu, executive director of American Oversight. "Everyone should be alarmed that ICE is preparing to deploy a tool designed to inflict, at best, intense pain, without showing that it is safe for the people who will be subjected to it."

ICE released the study and other documents to American Oversight as part of the group's Freedom of Information Act lawsuit against the agency seeking records related to its use of force.

The military prison study assessed whether the gloves could be used effectively to forcibly remove combative prisoners from their cells, to respond to disturbances in common areas, and to transport uncooperative inmates.

The study found the devices "increased the efficiency" of teams carrying out forced cell extractions and responding to disturbances by reducing the length of physical encounters, keeping guards from becoming exhausted, and preventing injuries. They did not "significantly change" the time it took to control inmates but required less effort.

Heating oil prices going through the roof

► HEATING OIL

Continued from Page A1

state of emergency and provide additional funding for people with low incomes to help pay their energy bills. This week, she announced a new assistance fund aimed at middle-income households relying on heating oil.

Electric and gas heat bills are expected to rise this winter, too. But oil prices are already seeing the most extreme spike.

Prices are high because every level of the supply chain is affected, said Michael Ferrante, president of the Massachusetts Energy Marketers Association. Oil supply has been unsteady since the Iran war began; that makes it harder on refineries to stock wholesalers, who in turn have less for the retailers who bring heating oil to residents' homes.

But heating costs were increasing even before the overseas conflict, Ferrante said. Ferrante described this coming winter, coupled with inflated prices on other household needs, as the "most troubling scenario" he's seen in decades, for both consumers and small retailers who can't keep up with high costs.

"This is going to be a very ex-

pensive winter," he said.

Some Massachusetts retailers are offering homeowners different methods to reduce costs. One way is via cap prices, where customers commit to a single price per gallon even if week-to-week retail prices fluctuate. Others offer budgeting options to spread payments out, rather than making multiple large purchases for each tank refill — an empty, standard 275-gallon oil tank would cost more than \$1,500 to fill at Massachusetts' current average retail price of \$6.12 a gallon.

Some higher-income households are considering longer-term solutions, such as converting to heat pumps and ditching heating oil altogether. But these switches can be costly. Pembroke resident Matt Fitch, a software engineer, asked an HVAC company to price out a conversion. The quote: \$75,000, he said. Even with a rebate from Mass Save, that's far more than he can pay this season.

He said he will have to settle for absorbing the higher oil prices for now.

"We can technically afford it," Fitch said. But, "it comes out of other parts of the budget."

Over the past few years, public assistance programs for lower-income households haven't kept up with rising costs, even outside of the approaching winter. Initiatives such as Massachusetts' Home Energy Assistance Program, or HEAP, help low-income homeowners and renters cover a portion of their energy bills; more than 150,000 Massachusetts households received HEAP assistance last winter, and the governor is expanding the state's HEAP fund to an additional 150,000 households.

But that often isn't enough. Northern Maine, for example, is more reliant on home heating oil than much of the country. There, the average household HEAP award this season is about \$700, said Jason Parent, chief executive of Avec Community Action, one of the region's heat assistance agents. With average prices running close to \$6 per gallon in Maine, the federal money would barely fill half a tank just once, in a climate

where households need multiple refills during a winter season. Throughout the state, the maximum gross income for a household of four to qualify for HEAP is \$73,213 this season.

The number of households requesting assistance has also increased. Avec and other agents across Maine have had to cap applications in the past because there are more households applying than they have funds for, Parent said.

Last season, Avec processed 10,000 applications, and this season, appointments to qualify for help are already booked out into January. And many other energy assistance programs have had their funding reduced or cut entirely.

"All signs point to this being the most challenging year we've had," Parent said.

This winter, Parent is advising people to wear more layers indoors as the months get colder. He worries that space heaters and makeshift heat sources that people sometimes rely on can be fire hazards. And in extreme situations where someone might run out of oil, he's recommending that people stay with relatives or friends who have heat.

US senators in New England and beyond have pushed the Trump administration to release the majority of \$4 billion in allocated heating assistance funding, referred to as LIHEAP on the federal level, before the coldest months hit.

Senators signed a letter last week demanding the administration also provide an additional \$3 billion in emergency LIHEAP funds. Healey sent a similar letter to congressional leaders this week.

"We're just going to keep looking for all the ways that we can try to help people," Healey said this week. "Particularly when it comes to their energy needs and energy costs."

Parent said he's worried the current funds won't be enough.

"It's very challenging to know that this is the potential of the outcome of what we're up against this winter," he said.

Karyna Cheung can be reached at karyna.cheung@globe.com.

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R.I. town concerned about safety at Amazon warehouse

►AMAZON
Continued from Page A1
ters are located. And it wasn’t long before calls for rescues at the Johnston facility began to escalate.

Since the Amazon facility opened, firefighters have responded there about 200 times through Sept. 26, roughly four times a week, according to Johnston records.

About 160 of those calls from the Amazon facility were for some type of medical assistance, including complaints of chest pain, back pain, psychiatric problems, pregnancy issues, and “sick person.”

While some calls were for workplace-related issues, such as an eye injury reported on Sept. 9, Calci said most of the emergency calls appear to be for people who take ill while at work.

“Our rescue crews come back and tell us that the people that work there say that they can’t call in sick, or they’ll risk being fired,” Calci said. “So they come to work sick and then call us, and the rescue has to go pick them up.”

Sam Stephenson, an Amazon spokesperson, said in an interview that employees get paid annual “flexible time,” which includes sick time, of 40 hours for part-time workers and up to 48 hours for full-time employees, and they are encouraged to call 911 any time they feel it’s necessary.

“It’s important to keep these numbers in perspective,” Stephenson said of the rescue calls. “Thousands of people work at this site, and our own records show only a small fraction of these calls were related to work. The vast majority were for personal health matters, and of course we encourage our team to take care of themselves first and foremost, whether they’re at home or at work.”

But the mayor said he’s concerned that town rescue squads are being used as a type of “medical Uber.”

“The rescue system is to re-

spond to emergencies as they happen,” Polisena said. “It should not be used as a medical taxi, so to speak.”

One worker at the facility, who asked to withhold his name out of fear of retribution, said that it’s difficult to take paid sick days and that employees instead end up taking unpaid time off.

“I look at it as this is a job where you stay at until you figure out what you really want to do,” he said. “It’s just something to keep you afloat, to survive.”

Calci said the high number of calls at the Amazon warehouse

‘If something doesn’t change, it’s only going to be a matter of time before something bad happens.’

MAYOR JOSEPH M. POLISENA

could put residents at risk by forcing the Johnston Fire Department to rely on rescue squads from neighboring towns, which would increase response times. (The Fire Department gets about 7,000 rescue calls a year, Calci said.)

In July, a 911 call for a fire in a conveyor belt on the second floor of the Johnston facility raised additional concerns about fire safety and cooperation by the retail giant.

No one had pulled the fire alarm, which delayed the response time, Calci said. Workers were told about the fire via two-way radio and ordered to leave the building.

When firefighters arrived, they were forced to push through a bottleneck of about 850 Amazon employees who were all trying to flee through the front entrance, instead of the 55 emergency exits that ring the

building, Calci said.

“They have a very long distance to walk in that building,” Calci said. “So that was obviously a huge public safety concern for all of us.”

While Stephenson said the employees had cut the power to the equipment, the fire chief said Amazon officials balked when they were told to cut power to that area of the building, saying they needed to “check with corporate.”

The fire was quickly contained, and no one was injured. But as fire officials investigated the incident, Calci said, they were repeatedly pestered by Amazon officials about when employees could get back to work.

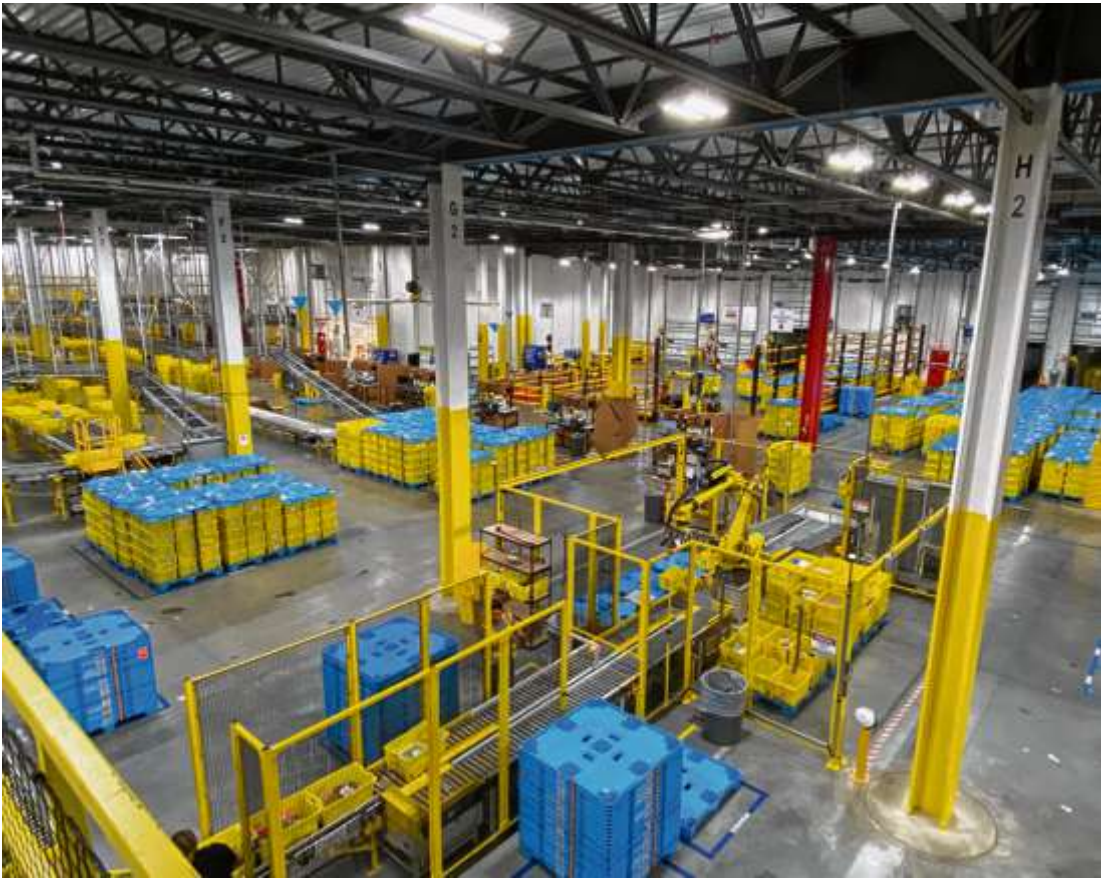
“Quite frankly, they’re lucky that was only a small fire,” Polisena said. “God forbid, if that was a large fire. They have a lot of people up there. If something doesn’t change, it’s only going to be a matter of time before something bad happens.”

A report by the Office of the State Fire Marshal concluded the fire was accidental — caused by friction when debris jammed under a running conveyor belt — and affirmed problems with the company’s fire safety practices.

Amazon and Johnston fire officials were meeting Tuesday to discuss evacuation procedures and other concerns. “In reviewing the July incident, we identified several opportunities to improve the execution of our emergency response procedures, and we immediately remediated those gaps,” Stephenson said.

He said Amazon has provided additional KnoxBoxes, which help first responders get into secure areas during an emergency. The building meets all relevant fire codes and regulations, he said. (The fire chief confirmed that the building is up to code.)

However, the fire chief said Amazon has not acted on multiple requests to place additional firefighting equipment throughout the building. Polisena said he was “surprised” and “disap-



CHRISTOPHER GAVIN/GLOBE STAFF

The Amazon warehouse in Johnston stretches nearly a quarter-mile.

pointed” by Amazon’s failure to comply with the requests.

While firefighters carry 30 minutes of oxygen supply, it can take them 15 to 20 minutes to walk from the front entrance to the far end of the massive building, Calci said, and oxygen gets used up more quickly when firefighters are lugging hoses in or carrying people out.

Calci said they’ve asked Amazon to place hoses and compressed air tanks at various points inside the building. But Amazon has not yet done so, he said.

Amazon said that there was no formal request for the equipment, which is not required by code.

The Occupational Safety and Health Administration has cited Amazon warehouses across the country for unsafe working conditions. In 2021, a Globe investigation found Amazon’s Fall River warehouse — which opened in 2017 — had one of the highest rates of worker injuries in Amazon’s national network of distribution centers.

The largest Amazon facility in Massachusetts is in North Andover, a town of about 32,000

people where a \$400 million, 3.8-million-square-foot warehouse opened in April 2024.

North Andover Fire Chief John Weir said that Amazon warehouse also had a conveyor belt fire recently, but workers exited safely. “To be honest with you, we have not had a problem yet,” he said.

Deputy Fire Chief Graham Rowe said North Andover has responded to 71 calls from the Amazon facility this year, including 62 emergency medical service calls — less than two calls per week, compared to an average of four per week in Johnston.

In North Haven, Conn., the fire department has responded to Amazon’s 855,000-square-foot warehouse there 68 times in the past year, mostly for medical calls, Fire Chief Paul Januszewski said. They average fewer than two calls per week.

Stephenson said that since 2019, Amazon has invested more than \$2.5 billion to “advance safety progress including innovations, ergonomic improvements, and training programs.” The company’s incident rate, which includes injuries that require

more than basic first aid, has improved 43 percent, he said.

“Additionally, our global lost time incident rate, which includes any work-related injury that requires someone to take time away from work, has improved 70 percent,” Stephenson said.

States offer big incentives for Amazon to set up shop. As part of a 20-year tax deal in Johnston, Amazon is set to pay an average of \$7.2 million a year in property taxes, and it committed to providing \$5.3 million to add four additional firefighters to a nearby station.

Even so, the mayor and fire chief said Amazon hasn’t been responsive to their concerns about public safety and equipment.

“This is a company with a \$1 trillion market cap,” Polisena said. “I mean, the company’s bigger than some small countries. There’s no excuse. Clearly, it’s not a money issue, right?”

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INBOX

State oversight lagged as nursing homes’ quality plummeted

DPH failed in its role as RegalCare bought up more facilities

I commend the Globe’s Spotlight Team for yet another stunning expose of high-level corruption, this time in the Commonwealth’s nursing home industry (“‘Aren’t these places regulated?’: He’s buying up nursing homes here, cutting spending and slashing care. Massachusetts regulators keep signing off,” Page A1, Oct. 4).

What is horrifying about what Eli Mirlis managed to achieve, swooping in to mount his rapid-fire acquisitions and ongoing predations at numerous nursing homes here, is how he proceeded with what seemed like nary a check on his activities by the Massachusetts Department of Public Health.

How was it that a state agency with about 3,200 employees and an annual budget of \$1.1 billion was unable to monitor homes whose ratings quickly declined, under the ownership of Mirlis’s company RegalCare, from five stars to one star? Not only did the DPH fail to minimally assess Mirlis’s credentials, educational background, and record in nearby states, but it also continued to allow him to acquire yet more nursing facilities and run them into the ground.

Given that this comes on the heels of the Steward Health Care collapse, one is driven to ask whether our solidly Democratic, ostensibly progressive state leaders are either corrupt or incompetent regarding how they conduct oversight of our supposedly world-class health care sector. Given that our population is growing older, what can elders anticipate will occur if they eventually need institutional care?

Adding to the uncertainty are Immigration and Customs Enforcement’s targeting of immigrants, who provide much of the workforce in these facilities.

So, what now?

LINDA MOUSSOURIS
Cambridge

When elders seek care, they need to trust state has done its due diligence

It was absolutely terrifying to read about the apparent absence of accountability surrounding the oversight of Eli Mirlis, owner of RegalCare nursing homes, and the facilities responsible for providing rehabilitation and health care to vulnerable patients in Massachusetts. The lack of oversight is mind-boggling.

This is not a case where officials had to dig to uncover troubling information. The warning signs appear to have been right in front of them when decisions were being made about licensing these facilities. It is deeply disturbing that it took a whistleblower to bring these concerns to the attention of the general public and our public health officials.

As an older person, I find this frightening on a personal level. When the day comes that I need this kind of care, or someone I love does, I need to be able to trust that the Massachusetts Department of Public Health has done its due diligence and that our lives are not being put at risk by facilities that have failed to meet appropriate standards.

With the election just weeks away, Governor Maura Healey must address this issue publicly and immediately. Older Massachusetts residents and their families deserve reassurance that our state is doing everything necessary to protect us from unsafe or fraudulent care facilities and that those responsible for overseeing them will be held accountable.

JOANI GELTMAN
Holliston

Instead of an apology, Governor Healey offers only a hollow pledge

Apparently Governor Maura Healey cannot say the words, “I take full responsibility.” Her response to the Globe’s Spotlight report on nursing homes owned by RegalCare was pathetic (“Lawmakers demand nursing home details: Criticize Healey administration over lax enforcement, rubber-stamping deals,” Spotlight Follow-up, Page A1, Oct. 5).

Rather than own up to the fact that the Commonwealth did not properly vet the chain, all she offered was a hollow pledge, saying, “It’s really important to me that everyone who has a loved one in a nursing home ... has the assurance that their loved one is going to be well cared for.”

The governor needs to start backing up her words with actions. An apology for her administration approving an out-of-state operator that has lowered the quality for residents in need of care would be a good place to begin.

MARK RUKAVINA
Roslindale

Nursing home residents are among the most vulnerable care recipients

Thank you so much for the excellent but depressing Spotlight report about Eli Mirlis, CEO of RegalCare. It’s so important that his takeover, and ruin, of so many nursing homes is exposed. I am flabbergasted by the lack of oversight by the Department of Public Health. There is absolutely no excuse for this.

There was so much clear evidence that Mirlis should not have been allowed to purchase any more facilities after his initial purchases. The residents of nursing homes are among the most vulnerable and fragile of those of any facilities, and Mirlis’s apparent disregard for this fact is deeply disturbing.

I feel grateful that my 89-year-old mother, who has dementia, is living in a high-quality, caring facility. Thank goodness Mirlis didn’t buy it.

SUZANNE FARMAN
Brookline



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

A stone topper was missing on a pillar at the entrance to RegalCare in Taunton in September.

Opinion

BOSTONGLOBE.COM/OPINION

EDITORIAL

Israel needs a thorough investigation of Oct. 7

At a ceremony on Monday, Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu of Israel proclaimed that the work of avenging the brutal Oct. 7, 2023, Hamas invasion of Israel was not finished. “Everyone who was involved in the attack against us, everyone who held our hostages, is living on borrowed time,” he said, according The Times of Israel.

As the world knows too well, thousands of Hamas fighters poured into southern Israel three years ago today and killed at least 1,200 people, most of them civilians, most of them in cold blood. The militants took another 251 people hostage, holding them in tunnels beneath Gaza under excruciating conditions that killed many. The last group of

a copy of Hamas’s plan of attack. But for a range of reasons — including poor coordination between the armed forces and intelligence agencies and a belief that Hamas could not carry out such a massive assault — the intelligence fell between the bureaucratic cracks.

That finding was recently echoed by two newspapers: The Wall Street Journal, which reported that Egypt warned Netanyahu before Oct. 7 about a potential attack; and Haaretz, which reported that the United Arab Emirates warned Netanyahu that Hamas was planning the attack. Netanyahu has said both those reports are wrong.

The Shin Bet review also found that longstanding Israeli policies of relying on Hamas to keep Gaza

“quiet,” while also allowing money from Qatar to finance the arming of militant fighters and construction of tunnels, contributed to the attack’s bloody effectiveness. Netanyahu has also rejected that conclusion.

But if the prime minister wants to explain his policies and defend the integrity of his administration, an independent commission would help him make his case.

There is also a role for the US Congress to play in pressing for greater accountability. The United States contributes billions in aid to Israel annually and expends untold diplomatic capital in defending the country.

That aid is vital to Israel’s defense, but providing it with few or no strings at-

tached has not always served the United States’ — or, arguably, even Israel’s — interests. So it is not wrong for Congress to demand greater accountability for whatever security flaws might have contributed to the death toll of Oct. 7. A mere commission seems a small price to pay for continued US support.

There is a precedent for such a study: The bipartisan 9/11 Commission created by Congress in the wake of that horrific Al Qaeda attack 25 years ago. Though President George W. Bush initially opposed creation of the commission, Congress prevailed and the commission was created just one year after the attack. After many hearings and interviews and much classified document research, the commission released a book-length report that became essential reading for anyone wanting to understand what happened that day.

There were limitations to that report — it did not, for instance, hold anyone personally accountable for failures leading up to the attack. But a close reading of its text shows where individuals and agencies fell short. And among its many findings was this crucial one: that poor coordination among the nation’s national security and intelligence-gathering agencies made the country more vulnerable.

An independent commission to investigate Oct. 7 will probably not wrestle with the painfully complex questions about Palestinian rights and Israel’s control of the West Bank and Gaza. Nor will it point a clear path out of the seemingly endless conflict with Iran and its proxies — Hezbollah, Hamas, and the Houthis in Yemen — that has now embroiled the United States.

But if a commission helps explain what policies contributed to Israel’s vulnerability that horrible day — and which individuals should be held accountable for them — it will have done much.

Israelis have a right to know the truth, not just to address the trauma of the attack but also to fortify themselves against a future that could well be as dangerous today as it was on Oct. 6, 2023.



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Shoes of some of the 411 people murdered by Hamas terrorists at the Supernova Music Festival in Israel on Oct. 7, 2023, were on display at the traveling Nova Music Festival Exhibition called The Moment Music Stood Still. The exhibition was in South Boston from Sept. 26, 2025, through Oct. 21.

20 was released a year ago this week under a fragile cease-fire plan.

The invasion was an unprecedented act of terrorism, intended to touch off a regional conflagration that Hamas’s leaders hoped would bring down the state of Israel. So Netanyahu is right to pledge that those responsible for planning, financing, and carrying out the attack should be held accountable. But he has steadfastly opposed finding accountability in one important place: his own government.

Since the early days of the war in Gaza, many Israelis have been calling for an independent commission to investigate what went wrong with Israel’s preparation for and response to the invasion. What intelligence signals were missed? How was it possible for swarms of Hamas fighters to massacre so many defenseless Israelis? Why was the military’s response slow? And perhaps most important: Did Israel’s broader strategy to contain Hamas in the years before the invasion blind it to the very possibility of such a deadly attack?

Netanyahu has stonewalled the creation of an independent commission on the grounds that it would lead to a partisan witch hunt aimed at undermining his government in advance of parliamentary elections. In this, he has gotten his wish: If there is to be an independent review, it will not happen until after the elections on Oct. 27.

But the possibility of a commission post-election is very much on the ballot, as Netanyahu’s rivals have pledged to support its creation. And it is not just his partisan critics: The head of Shin Bet, Israel’s intelligence agency, last year called for a broad investigation into the attack that goes beyond the internal reviews his agency and the military have already conducted.

“The path to reparation, as is emphasized in the report, demands a broad process of clarity and truth,” Ronen Bar, the agency’s head, said in releasing Shin Bet’s internal review of Oct. 7. The report, parts of which remain classified, had many eye-opening findings, including that Israel had obtained

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JOHN WESSELS/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Children walked in the Israeli-occupied West Bank on Sept. 16.



ERIK MARMOR/GETTY

Israeli children attached white sheets to the frame of a temporary sukkah outside Kibbutz Nir-Am by the Israel-Gaza border on Sept. 27.

I lost my husband, my home, and my sense of safety. I still dream of a future for my daughter.

By **Manar Basim**

Manar Basim is a computer engineer from Gaza City.

Three years ago this week, Israel began its devastating war in Gaza, laying waste to most of the territory and forever changing my life and that of millions of other Palestinians. While the anniversary offers Israelis a chance to mourn those who died on Oct. 7, 2023, Palestinians are afforded no such opportunity — because we are still being killed almost every day, despite the supposed cease-fire.

When the war first started, I was living an ordinary life in Shuja'iyya in northern Gaza, with my husband and 5-month-old daughter, Aisha, and completing my degree in computer engineering. Although opportunities in Gaza were limited due to Israel's punishing decade-and-a-half-long siege, I had the hope and optimism of youth. That all changed in an instant.

As the bombing intensified, we fled in the darkness of night, with warplanes overhead and flames nearly consuming us from every direction, spending a night we thought would never end at a nearby school.

The Israeli military then ordered us to move south. I was separated from my husband and found myself alone with my daughter, living in a tent.

Those first days of the war were difficult. I lost all contact with my family in the north of the Strip. I was forced to be strong for Aisha, but fear was a constant companion.

I eventually completed my degree online in impossible circumstances — fleeing mass killings while nursing a baby and searching for food and shelter. I began to teach students in the camp as a way to keep myself distracted.

When the temporary cease-fire was announced in January last year, I went back to northern Gaza and was reunited with my brother and my husband. But the joy did not last. My husband was killed in an Israeli airstrike not long after our reunion, and Aisha lost her father, in the same way I lost mine as a child.

Aisha and I now live in a single damaged room in a shelter in Gaza City. Most of the walls are covered with plastic tarps. There

are no windows. When it rains, water pours down on us and floods our belongings. In summer, the heat is unbearable.

I spend my days striving to provide a dignified life for my daughter, homeschooling her, and working on developing my own skills. But without a basic income I can accomplish very little. There is no electricity or internet, and even finding a workspace where I can spend a few hours each day is prohibitively expensive.

Safety and peace of mind remain elusive, as Israel has killed over 1,400 Palestinians over the past year alone, including more than 300 children. I live in constant fear that our dreams and ambitions could come to an end and a single airstrike could wipe us all out.

My daughter is almost 4. But I'm too terrified to send her to preschool. The pace and frequency of Israeli attacks have not let up. Schools should be a safe haven. But even they were not spared — nearly all were either damaged or destroyed by Israel over the past three years.

I've lost my home, my neighborhood, and my city. I've lost my family and the love of my life. I've lost my sense of safety, self, and comfort.

I hope that Israel's killing and destruction in Gaza, which most international experts now label a genocide, comes to an end and that we are left alone, even if that means living on the rubble of our homes, with our dreams intact, near the remains of our loved ones. We have so much to offer and are capable of rebuilding our lives from scratch. It has become abundantly clear that Israel does not want us to live — but rather wishes to erase us from existence. Senior Israeli officials continue to speak openly of their plans to expel us from Gaza for good. But we will never leave.

I pray every day for this gross injustice to be lifted and to live to see better days; to build a dignified life for myself and Aisha, to continue my education and career, and to have a meaningful and tangible role in rebuilding Gaza once again.

I dream of raising Aisha in safety and security. I dream — and what a simple dream it is — of living in a home that can shelter me and my family. A home that is warm in the winter and cool in the summer. A safe home where we can go to sleep and wake up without fear of the unknown.

Three years after the attack, what are we teaching our children?

By **Michal Sella**

Michal Sella is the CEO of Givat Haviva, an educational center promoting a shared Jewish-Arab society in Israel.

On Oct. 7, 2023, when the most horrific massacre of Jews since the Holocaust took place, no one imagined that three years later the daily social, political, and security reality in Israel would still be revolving around the tragedy.

Oct. 7 was an unimaginably violent escalation of the Israeli-Palestinian conflict, and the horrible war in Gaza that followed proved it. Violence, hatred, and racism in our region have skyrocketed and may have changed the nature of this conflict forever.

At the same time, Israel must maintain a democracy in which Jewish and Arab citizens live together while also fighting a war. How can this happen when the reality in Israel becomes more extreme every day?

Here are just a few of the events that shaped the Jewish holiday of Sukkot celebrated last week.

An attempted hijacking of a plane flying from Dubai to Tel Aviv, which had mostly Israelis aboard, could have sparked another war if it had succeeded. Passengers managed to intervene, overcome the attacker, and land the plane safely.

Two days earlier, Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu warned of a serious external threat, while the security establishment assured the public that his announcement was politically motivated and not evidence of an imminent attack.

In the West Bank, terrorist settlers attacked a nonviolent Palestinian population, setting homes on fire and forcing families out. A tunnel was discovered near the city of Kfar Saba, triggering fears of another Oct. 7-style event, this time in central Israel.

The Israeli social atmosphere has become increasingly divisive and tense. A candidate from the right-wing Likud party wrote on social media to an 88-year-old former hostage whose husband was murdered on Oct. 7, saying he wished she could be returned to Hamas captivity due to her critiques of Netanyahu.

This was Sukkot 2026 in Israel. This is the context in which schools across Israel are marking the Oct. 7 anniversary.

sary. Israeli children live in an unstable security situation, never knowing if school will open the next day or whether a ballistic missile attack will begin. Their leaders can insult a former elderly hostage, ministers publicly support violence, and adults are divided on all topics related to the war. What do we expect Israeli children to think, say, or become?

While this violent version of Israel exists, another Israel is striving to face and shape reality. A substantial part of Israel's education system is working to educate Jewish and Arab children differently, for peace, understanding, and against racism. It is possible to rebuild and recover our values after Oct. 7 and the war.

At Givat Haviva, Israel's largest campus for Jewish-Arab shared society education, students from Jewish and Arab public schools are able to meet each other, talk, understand, argue, and explain themselves in a safe environment. They are even able to mark the Oct. 7 anniversary together.

These youths can do something adults in Israel do not even dream of. Through education, they can grasp each other's pain, rather than compete over who is the bigger victim. They are able to understand a complex story.

Most importantly, they are able to separate the suffering of the individual from the larger situation. To meet one person with a personal story, and try to suspend, even for a moment, the hatred and racism that is being fed to them from the adult world.

The weeks before the Oct. 27 elections are crucial. The level of polarization here is frightening. Many fear we will see extreme violence during the elections, something we have never witnessed in Israel before.

But it is also an opportunity for a new Israeli chapter. I work constantly with the younger generation. Our children are watching us. They are observing how we speak to each other, how we deal with fear, how we treat the other side, and how we behave when everything around us is falling apart.

We have a responsibility to show them that another reality is possible. The fourth anniversary of Oct. 7 will come. I hope that by then we will be able to look back and say that we did not allow that tragic day to define who we are forever.

We must choose to build a strong, peaceful, and equal country for our children.

RENÉE GRAHAM

Rahm Emanuel knows nothing about accountability

However deluded President Trump is about support for the US and Israel's quagmire against Iran or the high cost of gas and groceries, this he clearly understands:

If the Democrats win back control of the House, the president believes he will be impeached.

As the Republicans' midterm prospects appear to grow more dire, the possibility of impeachment seems to be weighing heavily on the president's mind.

"Pretend I'm running, please, because I am on the ballot," Trump told supporters at a rally in Oklahoma last week. "And if we don't win, they'll end up impeaching me."

From federal immigration officers who have continued to terrorize communities and kill with impunity to levels of corruption once unimaginable, Trump has given Democrats no shortage of reasons to impeach him or, for that matter, members of his Cabinet.

But during a recent appearance on NBC's "Meet the Press," Rahm Emanuel, a Democrat who served in the Obama and Biden administrations, offered his opinion on whether his party should hold impeachment hearings if November's vote swings their way.

"Short answer: No. It's not going anywhere, and it's going to be a food fight, and it's just going to be we return to the politics of fighting," Emanuel said. Instead, he proposed that Democrats should investigate Trump and pass a "comprehensive ethics package that uses the investigations to

then deliver change."

After the many traumas that the second Trump White House has inflicted on this nation, what Americans need are the politics of accountability. That can only be achieved by investigating and bringing articles of impeachment against multiple people in the Trump administration, including the president.

Despite his credentials as a former congress-

Despite his credentials as a former congressman, a former mayor, and a former ambassador, there's scant merit in Emanuel's political opinions.

man, a former mayor, and a former ambassador, there's scant merit in Emanuel's political opinions. In his memoir, "A Promised Land," former president Barack Obama recalled the opposition he faced when he chose Emanuel as his first chief of staff.

"Didn't he represent the same old triangulating, Davos-attending, Wall Street-coddling, Washington-focused, obsessively centrist version of the Democratic Party we had been running against?" Obama wrote, summarizing the anti-Emanuel sentiment. "How can you trust him?"

Short answer: You can't. For many, the dealbreaker is what Emanuel did

as Chicago mayor after the police murder of Laquan McDonald, a Black teenager who was shot 16 times in 2014.

For more than a year, Emanuel prevented the release of police dash-cam video that directly contradicted the official police report that claimed McDonald, armed with a knife, was walking toward officers when he was shot. He only released the video, which proved that the 17-year-old boy was shot while walking away from police, after a judge ordered him to do so.

(Jason Van Dyke, a former Chicago officer, was later charged and convicted of second-degree murder in McDonald's death.)

More than 50 years ago, former president Gerald Ford gave Richard Nixon a full pardon after the Watergate scandal consumed his presidency and led to his resignation. Ford thought his decision would serve as a salve and allow the nation to move on. It had the opposite effect and felt like the theft of justice. In a blistering editorial, The New York Times denounced Ford's actions as a failure to "provide courageous and impartial moral leadership."

Since Trump's return to the White House, the nation has been starved of moral and courageous leadership. Instead, we've been steeped in the politics of cruelty, incompetence, vengeance, and self-dealing. To do the bare minimum, which is the best one could say about Emanuel's proposal of an ethics package, would be akin to being an accessory after the fact.

Emanuel is not the first Democrat to reject impeaching Trump again if the party finds itself in a

position to do so come January. Senator Tammy Duckworth of Illinois and Representative James Clyburn of South Carolina have both said that the Democrats should have bigger priorities than impeachment.

But accountability should be near the top of the Democratic agenda to address what this current administration has done.

Though he's yet to confirm it, Emanuel seems like a man with his eyes set on returning to Washington, this time as president. In recent years, he's been a fixture on cable news and the Sunday talk shows, keeping his name and face in the presidential contender conversation.

But nothing Emanuel has said is meeting the urgency of this unmatched moment. To its own detriment, this nation has too often shunned accountability and consequences, which has only served to set the stage for the Next Great Constitutional Crisis. Ford blocking the law from having its way with Nixon, who should have gone to prison, has surely emboldened Trump. Could anyone survive what might follow Trump if punishment commensurate to his probable crimes is not rendered?

Emanuel remains the same man that Obama supporters warned against all those years ago. And given his own shameful behavior as a mayor, no one should listen to anything he has to say about how best to pursue justice and accountability.

Renée Graham is a Globe columnist. She can be reached at renee.graham@globe.com.

Mass. in the middle on joining ‘student scholarships’

►STUDENTS
Continued from Page A1

fees for extended day programs, tutoring, and additional special education services.

“To call it a voucher program is misleading,” said Andrea Silbert, president of the Eos Foundation, which works with school districts on various initiatives supporting low-income students, such as providing breakfast in the classroom. “This could really level the playing field.”

Under Trump’s initiative, the scholarships would be generated through donations from individual taxpayers, who can contribute up to \$1,700 to a “student scholarship organization” of their choosing — so long as it’s officially registered with a participating state.

Taxpayers can then apply that amount toward a new federal “Education Freedom Tax Credit” on their federal forms. Married couples could donate twice as much.

If Massachusetts opts into the program, it could generate millions of dollars in scholarships, according to advocates who have united as the Massachusetts Educational Opportunities Coalition. Contributions from 15 percent of state taxpayers could yield more than \$333 million annually for scholarships; if 30 percent of taxpayers donated, that amount could swell to more than \$667 million.

“It will blow the doors off of philanthropy in regards to educational services in Massachusetts,” said Katie Everett, executive director of the Lynch Foundation, which works with public and private schools. “I think it could be transformative.”

But as more taxpayers seek the tax credit, less tax revenue would be collected by the federal government.

Joining the program would represent a seismic shift for Massachusetts, which has long resisted offering vouchers or other financial incentives for students to attend private schools. State leaders and other education advocates have long argued that the state Constitution prohibits allocating state aid to private elementary and secondary schools.

Instead, Massachusetts has provided school choice within the public sector, such as offering opportunities to attend public charter, vocational, and virtual schools.



PHOTOS BY ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

The debate comes as student enrollment in public and private schools across Massachusetts has been declining and as the Trump administration has been slashing public education funding.

The cuts are adding to the fiscal woes of districts as they grapple with escalating costs and limited local revenue, which has caused many districts to raise program fees paid by families. That, in turn, is adding pressure on many families’ household budgets, forcing some to make difficult trade-offs.

So far, more than 30 states, nearly all of them led by Republican governors, have joined the program, including New Hampshire, Florida, and Texas, according to Ballotpedia. States have until Jan. 1 to opt in.

Proponents and opponents of the tax credit are increasingly attempting to woo Governor Maura Healey on their side, potentially putting her in an awkward tug-of-war as she runs for reelection. Healey has repeatedly criticized her Republican challenger, Mike Minogue, for supporting Trump.

The Healey administration is reviewing the proposed federal regulations issued last week as



While some kids practiced drums, others took to the water at the Edgerley Family South Boston Club, part of the Boys & Girls Clubs of Boston.

well as the previous temporary regulations, according to a statement Monday from the state Executive Office of Education.

On Monday, opponents brought their concerns directly to the State House, where they announced the formation of their new coalition, Protect Our Public Schools, which includes such organizations as AFT-MA, the Massachusetts Association of Teachers, the ACLU Massachusetts, and Massachusetts Budget and Policy Center.

Opponents warn the tax credit program will end up being a much bigger financial asset for

private schools, many of which have been highly successful in executing multimillion dollar fund-raising campaigns and have access to deep-pocket alumni and other donors.

The Massachusetts Association of School Superintendents, in issuing a position paper against the school choice scholarships last week, raised a similar point about the wide disparity in financial resources among the state’s public school districts.

“Affluent school districts will undoubtedly receive a far greater influx of private donations than poorer districts, further

widening the resource gaps,” according to its position paper.

The Trump administration has established generous eligibility guidelines for which students can secure scholarships, including those from households earning up to three times the area’s median income level.

That means Massachusetts students from households with incomes exceeding \$300,000 in Middlesex and Norfolk counties could potentially secure scholarships.

“Like any other priority that’s come out of the Trump administration, it favors the wealthy and

Info-swamped parents dream of old school

►PLATFORMS
Continued from Page A1

“We’ve gone so far into communication overload that we’ve come out on the other side and know nothing,” said the mother of a South Shore grade-schooler.

Her daughter’s school notified her in multiple ways about an upcoming concert — or tried to — but the “avalanche” of information made her eyes “glaze over,” she said, and she only learned of the event the morning of from a neighbor mom. “Thank god for Katy.”

In case you don’t have a kid in school, or are too busy contending with the apps for pet parents — Digitail and PetDesk among them — here’s where we are:

Each district maintains an average of 3,000 digital tools, according to the 2026 Edtech Top 40. That’s a roster that includes, for example, Canvas, Schoology, ClassDojo, Seesaw, and Gaggie.

The report notes that K-12 institutions are “moving away from technology accumulation and toward deliberate ecosystem building,” but for now at least, “tool sprawl” is real.

The global ed tech industry, clocking in at \$215 billion in 2026, is projected to hit \$589 billion by 2034, according to Fortune Business Insights.

Many parents are so overwhelmed they’ve gone into a defensive crouch.

“I just block it out because I can’t keep up,” said Heather McMullen, a nurse practitioner and mother of four in Newton.

The constant ding of notifications while she was at work made her so anxious that she started stashing her phone out of earshot.

When I asked if she had missed events or deadlines, she quickly said probably. “I haven’t been to a back-to-school night in two years.”

But, she added, “I also feel like my kids tell me important things. I know that’s so old-school.”

The scope of the digital onslaught has been captured in a viral tweet that reads like a satire (but almost isn’t) and in a 2025 report called “App Overload: How a Fragmented Digital Landscape is Failing K-12 Education.”

First the report: “[W]hile private school and district decision-makers . . . tend to view the app ecosystems they’ve created optimistically . . . the realities experienced by teachers and parents differ markedly,” the executive summary read.

“Parents . . . report significant challenges that translate into heightened frustration and time burdens,” it read. “Teachers, while recognizing the potential instructional benefits, express moderate dissatisfaction, largely due to the administrative work required to navigate multiple platforms.”

And now the tweet: “Your child’s assignment is in ParentVue. Have you checked Canvas? The homework is in EduSpot. The grades are available on Teacherly. I mentioned this in the WhatsApp group. It was literally sent to your Comcast dot net email address.”

The comments came fast and heartfelt. “8 year old was sick today,” read one popular response. “Called the office. They told me I had to submit the absence on ParentVue. Couldn’t figure it out and called again. Told me I had to wait for the push notification



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

Janelle Bruno, shown with her three kids, said she’s finding it impossible to keep up with their school notifications.

at 10am.”

“We’re sorry you were monitoring ParentVue, EduSpot, and Canvas for reading assignments,” read another, “but our class uses Moodle for paper submittals. I outlined this in the week 1 welcome email. We can’t make exceptions for late submittals.”

Like social media and the relentless reminders from the dermatologist’s office that your visit is coming up in one week, two days, one day, two hours, EdTech is not without its benefits.

But as Emily Silver, the co-founder of NAPS, a Boston-based support service for new moms and families, put it: “Parents are not lacking informa-

tion; they’re drowning in it.”

Phil Nichols, an associate professor at Baylor University’s Moody School of Education and coauthor of a paper on digital platforms and how they “subvert” the goals of public education, points to a dark side.

“There are some serious questions about data and privacy and security and surveillance,” he said.

“Every one of these platforms collects data — text that is entered, pictures that are shared, active-use time, clicks and swipes. All of this is valuable to platform companies who can use it to develop and market their products or sell it to third parties,” he said. “And because they store that data in-

definitely, it can be vulnerable in the case of a data breach.

And as hard as the parents have it, he added, the technology means more work for teachers, too. “There was a time when you’d send kids to school, and if something out of the ordinary was happening, you’d expect the teacher to contact you, and you might get a progress report.

“But now we’re asking teachers to teach and also curate a classroom feed so they can push out notifications.”

I didn’t hear back from the teachers’ groups I emailed, but when I posted a query about parents feeling overwhelmed in a mom-focused Facebook group, one poster responded that as a

favors sending public money back to the wealthy,” said Matt Bach, president of the Massachusetts Teachers Association. “It’s a craftier way to do the same thing the right has been trying to do with voucher programs.”

If the Trump administration wants to help low- and middle-income families, he said, the better approach would be to fully fund public education.

Various research has found that well-to-do families are more apt to utilize school choice scholarships than low-income families, who may be less aware of the opportunities. In states such as Florida and Arizona, which already have their own school choice scholarships, the majority of students taking advantage of it were already enrolled in private or home schools or resided in affluent neighborhoods, according to an analysis by the Associated Press.

In Massachusetts, less than 10 percent of the state’s 936,803 students in kindergarten through grade 12 attended private schools last year, according to state data.

That data point is giving tax credit supporters optimism that more scholarships will go to support students in public schools. More low-income students could also benefit too, they contend, with strategic campaigning and fund-raising particularly for programs geared toward serving that student population in public and private schools.

Organizations supporting the program include the Massachusetts Alliance of Boys and Girls Clubs, Latinos for Education, Big Brothers Big Sisters of Eastern Massachusetts, the Combined Jewish Philanthropies, and the Catholic Schools Foundation.

But supporters warn that if Massachusetts passes on the program, then taxpayers here can still donate to programs in other participating states and apply for the tax credit.

“It would be really sad if people instead sent their dollars to New Hampshire, New York, or Colorado,” said Ariella Hellman, director of government affairs for the Agudah of New England. “We want to keep those dollars here. . . . We want our children to benefit from this program.”

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Metro

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THE BOSTON GLOBE WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 7, 2026 | BOSTONGLOBE.COM/METRO

US, Harvard in fight over international students

University tells judges Trump’s ongoing bid to ban their enrollment would ‘open Pandora’s box’

By Michaela Towfighi
GLOBE STAFF

The Trump administration is likely to continue its attempts to ban all international students from enrolling at Harvard University, lawyers for the Department of Justice told federal judges on Tuesday.

Last year, President Trump attempted to invoke national security powers to ban students from obtaining visas to study at Harvard and has not backed down in his efforts since.

A hearing before the US First Circuit Court of Appeals in Boston provided the latest indication that the Trump admin-

istration would look to end international student enrollment as means to handicap the wealthiest university in the world.

“We can’t trust Harvard to monitor and discipline these international students,” said Tiberius Davis, an attorney for the Justice Department.

Paul Clement, outside counsel for Harvard, decried the effort, saying that allowing the administration to cherry-pick one institution would “open Pan-

► **Group of higher education leaders sue government over internships, B4**

dora’s box.”

“Today it’s Harvard, tomorrow it’s the whole Commonwealth of Massachusetts,” he said.

Gustavo A. Gelpi, a federal appellate court judge, said Trump’s attempts are the “first time that anything like this has been done,” and questioned the administration’s motives, which Justice

Department lawyers defended as efforts to curb antisemitism on campus and protect national security interests.

But now it is up to the panel of three judges — which also includes O. Rogieriee Thompson and Joshua D. Dunlap — to decide the administration’s ability to pick on Harvard by preventing international student enrollment.

At the end of the 2025 school year, the administration attempted to restrict

STUDENTS, Page B4



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

THE TREES THEY ARE A-CHANGIN’

A couple posed for a photo last week with the backdrop of the early fall foliage at Echo Lake in North Conway, N.H.

Protesters barricade road to Vt. ICE facility

‘Community garden’ designed to block traffic

By Paul Heintz
GLOBE STAFF

WILLISTON, Vt. — The garden-ing started early on Tuesday.

As the sun rose over a pair of federal immigration facilities here, around 40 protesters arrived by foot and truck and set about erecting planter boxes in the middle of a public road. They carried cinder blocks to reinforce the pallet-and-plywood structures and dumped bags of soil on top. Then came the flowers.

The resulting “Harvest Lane Community Garden” was designed to serve two purposes: block traffic to a key US Immigration and Customs Enforcement building and beautify the area.

“This is just a terrible use of this place,” said protest organizer Leif Taranta, 28, of Burlington, sporting



PAUL HEINTZ/GLOBE STAFF

“It’s called Harvest Lane, so we’ve decided to make it actually a harvest lane,” a protest organizer said in Williston, Vt., on Tuesday.

an oversized crocheted hat in the shape of a flower. “It’s called Harvest Lane, so we’ve decided to make it actually a harvest lane.”

For nearly a year, activists have

staged regular sit-ins at a nearby ICE surveillance center, often resulting in arrests. This week, they’ve invited protesters from around the country to join them in bringing attention to

the abundance of federal immigration facilities in northwest Vermont.

They’ve staged a mock funeral procession to honor those killed by immigration officers, and they’ve planned rallies, trainings, concerts, and potlucks — even a game of pick-up soccer, outside an ICE facility. According to organizers, a couple hundred people have attended the events so far, including some from France and Germany.

“We’re really, really hoping and encouraging people to take this back to wherever they came from,” said Abby Wannamaker, 23, of Burlington.

Law enforcement agencies have been preparing for the protests. They have intermittently closed roads near the ICE facilities and surrounded the properties with police tape and no-trespass signs.

When the gardeners arrived Tuesday morning, they were quickly met by Federal Protective Service vehicles, as well as local and state police.

PROTEST, Page B4

Selection of jury begins in Matthew Farwell trial

Ex-detective accused of killing Sandra Birchmore

By Sean Cotter and Laura Crimaldi
GLOBE STAFF

Jury selection began Tuesday in the trial of Matthew Farwell, the former Stoughton police detective accused of killing Sandra Birchmore and staging it to look like a suicide.

The first proceedings in the John J. Moakley US Courthouse were short, a rote start to a case that’s drawn heavy attention. On Tuesday morning, dozens of prospective jurors came to the federal courthouse in the Seaport to hear a brief overview of the case and fill out a questionnaire. A second round of potential jurors did the same after noon.

They left after they filled out the questionnaire, which Chief US District Judge Denise J. Casper and the attorneys for both sides will use to narrow the 411 potential jurors to a panel of 12 plus four alternates.

“The jury is central to the administration of justice,” Casper intoned to those assembled, stressing the importance of jury service. “Both parties have a right to a jury that is fair and impartial.”

Jury selection will play out this week in a more ponderous manner than Massachusetts residents would see in state court. The judge and lawyers will spend Tuesday night and Wednesday hashing out which jurors to dismiss offhand, based on their answers in the questionnaire. This might include people who answer questions in ways that suggest they couldn’t be impartial.

All of the prospective jurors are tasked with calling a certain phone line on Wednesday evening. There, they will be told via recorded message whether they are excused. Those who make the cut will be told to return at some point on Thursday. That’s when the judge will question them one by one in open court and decide whether they can sit on the jury.

It’s not clear exactly when opening statements will begin, but the judge has told the lawyers to be ready to give them as soon as Friday.

Farwell, 40, is accused of strangling a pregnant Birchmore, 23, at her Canton apartment on Feb. 1, 2021, and then staging the scene to

FARWELL, Page B2

INSIDE

‘Peeping Tom’ law

The state’s Supreme Judicial Court ruled that an Edgartown man did not violate the state’s “Peeping Tom” law when he sent a man he met on Grindr a still image of the two being intimate. **B3**

Rhode Island once had a network of trolleys. Can it bring back just one?

By Christopher Gavin
GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE — More than 100 years ago, a vast network of streetcars helped sculpt Rhode Island’s urban core. Neighborhoods were built around the convenience of rapid public transit.

Today, the tracks that once connected communities have long since been removed or paved over, but the trolley blueprint remains — and so does strong demand for ridership, according to Christopher Durand, CEO of the Rhode Island Public Transit Authority.

“We’ve got the density that really promotes better transit,” Du-

rand said in a recent interview. “And the Metro Connector is [our] dream of delivering on that.”

Over a half-century since its current bus system took hold, RIPTA is considering the possibility of building at least one light rail line — or, possibly a rapid bus line — to connect several of the state’s largest cities, including Central Falls, Pawtucket, Providence, and Cranston.

Four options are on the table in the Metro Connector Study, which is “exploring options for fast, frequent, and reliable transit service” along two corridors in greater Providence, RIPTA said.



PROVIDENCE PUBLIC LIBRARY

The Eddy Street-Edgewood trolley coming to the end of the line on Narragansett Boulevard in Cranston in 1935.

The approximately \$1.7 million study began in 2024 after the endeavor was recommended through Transit Forward RI 2040, the state’s Transit Master Plan. The public comment period for the study closed in September, and RIPTA is expected to move toward refining and selecting one of the proposals in 2027, according to Durand.

All the proposals are pricey: RIPTA anticipates a rapid bus line, which would also include Warwick, would cost \$322 million to \$365 million, while a light rail line would top \$1 billion — capital expenses that would require federal funding.

Still, transit advocates say such an addition to the state’s bus-only network would be transformative, especially for a system that saw historic service cutbacks over the past year to close a significant gap in its operating budget.

“We need to think big,” said Amy Glidden, chair of Rhode Island Transit Riders, an independent group dedicated to preserving, expanding, and improving public transportation around the state. “We believe Rhode Islanders deserve the same high-quality transit as we see in other cities.”

The project could also spur

RHODE ISLAND, Page B3

Revere awarded \$2.5m grant by FEMA to hire new firefighters

By Madyline Swearing
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

REVERE — Twelve new firefighters will join the department’s ranks beginning early next year, after the city was awarded \$2.5 million in federal staffing grants, officials announced Monday.

The new hires will serve as full-time personnel across the city’s five fire stations. They are all expected to start at the beginning of the year, but hiring may be staggered depending on fire academy placements, exam scores, and interviews, Revere Mayor Patrick Keefe told reporters at a press conference.

The \$2.5 million is part of the Staffing for Adequate Fire and Emergency Response, or SAFER, grant program. The program is designed to increase or maintain the number of trained firefighters at a local department, according to the Federal Emergency Management Agency.

“Currently, each of the fire stations in Revere are operating with three firefighters per shift,” Senator Ed Markey said at the press conference held at Station 1. “This new award, with 12 new firefighters, will enable the city to staff an additional firefighter at every sta-

tion.”

According to the National Fire Protection Association, a minimum of four on-duty members are needed to staff an engine.

The city has 123 uniformed firefighters, including the chief, as of Tuesday, according to the mayor’s office.

“Revere, and other communities across the Commonwealth, deserve to know that when they call 911, first responders can quickly [and] reliably come to their aid,” Markey said. “Those first responders deserve the basic dignity of knowing when they clock into

work that they will return home safely at the end of that shift.”

The federal investment in local services is critical, Markey added.

“Revere is a great community, but it’s not a super wealthy community. Revere needs help, and that’s what this is all about,” he said.

Separately, FEMA announced that the Barnstable Fire District was awarded a staffing grant — \$1.4 million toward hiring six new firefighters.

More than \$18 million has been awarded to fire depart-

ments and first responder stations across the state for protective gear, emergency vehicles, and wellness initiatives, the Globe reported last month.

“This funding is a true game changer for our department, directly translating into more firefighters on the job every day,” said Revere Fire Chief James Cullen.

Keefe said the city can typically only afford to hire one or two firefighters each year. The city has about 60,000 residents.

“With the growth of our community, we need to do a little bit more than that,” he said.

With the grant, that staffing

can be expedited, according to Keefe, without dipping into city funding.

“The fact that Revere got 20 percent of the federal funds is no surprise to me, because it’s also the fastest-growing city in the Commonwealth,” said State Senator Lydia Edwards.

Investing in the Revere Fire Department ensures mutual aid can be continued in communities like Winthrop, Chelsea, and East Boston, Edwards said.

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DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Media members stood outside the John Joseph Moakley Courthouse Tuesday as the covered the Matthew Farwell trial.

Farwell trial begins with jury selection

►**FARWELL**
Continued from Page B1

make it look like she killed herself.

Birchmore was eight to 10 weeks pregnant when she died and had told Farwell that he was the father. Federal prosecutors allege Farwell killed Birchmore to cover up that he had been sexually exploiting her beginning when she was 15 and he was 27, and other alleged crimes.

The FBI arrested Farwell on Aug. 28, 2024, and since then, he’s been held without bail at a Rhode Island detention facility.

Testimony is expected to cover disputes over whether Birchmore was killed or died by suicide, allegations of child sexual exploitation and police misconduct, and questions over whether the initial investigation into her death was adequate.

Farwell and Birchmore met some time after she enrolled in the Stoughton Police Department Explorers Program in 2010, the year she turned 13. Farwell participated in the program as a youth and stayed involved as a volunteer instructor.

Farwell is charged with killing a victim — Birchmore — and causing the death of her fetus. To secure a conviction in Birchmore’s death, prosecutors must prove that Farwell killed her to stop her from reporting that he committed a crime. Farwell

would face life in prison if convicted.

Farwell has pleaded not guilty, insisting Birchmore killed herself, citing the state medical examiner’s initial ruling that the cause of death was suicide. (In April, the medical examiner withdrew the suicide opinion and listed her manner of death as undetermined.) Farwell also argues that Birchmore had a history of suicide attempts and self-harm. DNA testing has excluded Farwell as the father.

This trial is expected to draw intense local coverage and, perhaps, national attention, both because of the severity of the allegations and how the investigation unfolded.

This is a case Norfolk District Attorney Michael Morrissey wouldn’t prosecute after state authorities deemed Birchmore’s death a suicide. For years, calls for “Justice for Sandra” were not met with criminal charges.

Then the feds got involved. It is unusual for federal authorities to bring charges in a murder case, but they did so here in 2024 after an expert they worked with said that her injuries were not consistent with suicide.

Now, these proceedings are the latest of a string of high-profile criminal trials over the past few years involving unusual and brutal allegations of domestic

violence killings in the communities south of Boston.

There were the two trials of Karen Read, the woman ultimately acquitted in the death of her boyfriend, Boston police Officer John O’Keefe, in Canton; allegations of corruption and coverup carried that into the national news. Then Brian Walshe, an art fraudster, was tried and convicted of murdering and dismembering his wife in Cohasset. And this summer, most high-profile of all, was the case of Lindsay Clancy, the Duxbury woman claiming what’s known as the insanity defense in the killings of her three young children. Her monthlong trial, which drew national attention, ended in a hung jury, and prosecutors are deciding whether to push for a second trial.

Public interest, and the social-media influencer infrastructure to feed it, have spun up over the course of those three trials. Some of the breathless online attention has latched onto Farwell’s case as it heads to trial.

This trial, slated to last about five weeks, will have clear logistical differences. It’s taking place in federal court, which has its own laws, rules, and procedures. Most significantly, there are no cameras allowed in the courthouse, and non-media members of the public aren’t allowed to bring electronics into

the courthouse. The widely available daily livestreams of the trials of Read, Walshe, and Clancy allowed the public to watch nearly every minute of those proceedings, building interest in them.

Here, no recordings will be available.

Still, heavy media attention — both among traditional media and the influencer variety — is expected.

Speaking to the jurors, Casper stressed that they now must avoid speaking about the case or hearing more about it. If they’ve heard or discussed the case in the past, that doesn’t necessarily mean they can’t sit as jurors, so long as they believe — and the judge agrees — that they can decide the case only on the evidence presented in court.

“A jury’s verdict must be free from outside influence,” Casper told them.

And, she said, they must be sure they can follow the rule that a defendant is innocent unless proven guilty: “This is not a mere technicality — it’s a principle of the utmost importance,” she said.

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Leominster restaurant owner sentenced to prison for SNAP fraud

By Tonya Alanez
GLOBE STAFF

The owner of a now-closed Leominster eatery has been sentenced to two years in federal prison for stealing IDs and using them to obtain food stamp benefits to buy food for the Caribbean restaurant, federal prosecutors said.

Raul Fernandez Vicioso, who operated the El Primo Restaurant, also fraudulently obtained pandemic unemployment benefits, court records show. In March, he pleaded guilty to defrauding Massachusetts and Rhode Island of a combined \$1.1 million worth of federal benefits, the Globe reported.

On Monday, Fernandez Vicioso, 38, who lives in Fitchburg, was sentenced in federal court in Worcester, according to US Attorney Leah B. Foley.

US District Judge Margaret R. Guzman sentenced Fernandez Vicioso to two years in prison, followed by three years of supervised release. Fernandez Vicioso also must pay \$1.1 million in restitution and forfeit \$1.1 million, Foley’s office said.

Fernandez Vicioso was charged in February along with three co-conspirators — his brother, an employee, and her partner.

Fernandez Vicioso’s brother, Joel Vicioso Fernandez, 42, of Fitchburg, is exploring a plea agreement, court filings show. Prosecutors have asked to have until Oct. 30 to work the case out.

Coralba Albarracin Siniva, 24, and Roman Vequiz Fernandez, 32, have fled Massachusetts, according to court documents.

The couple is from Venezuela but lived in Leominster. In June, they each pleaded guilty

and were set to be sentenced on Sept. 22, court filings show.

Their sentencing hearing was canceled, and prosecutors have asked to have until Nov. 19 to determine the whereabouts of Albarracin Siniva and Vequiz Fernandez, court records said.

Prosecutors allege that Fernandez Vicioso bought and stole personal identification of more than 100 people to apply for food assistance for low-income residents in Massachusetts and Rhode Island. The applications were for 24 supposed households that listed addresses for two apartments in Providence and El Primo Restaurant in Leominster.

Many of the IDs were stolen from Connecticut, Florida, Kentucky, New Jersey, New York, Pennsylvania, and Puerto Rico, prosecutors said.

Fernandez Vicioso fraudulently received more than \$440,000 from the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program, known as SNAP, which they spent at BJ’s Wholesale Club and various supermarkets, according to charging documents.

Prosecutors said Fernandez Vicioso and his co-conspirators used the SNAP benefits to buy large quantities of chicken, beef, pork, and other goods to stock the restaurant.

“With their supplies obtained for free through fraudulent SNAP benefits, they sold menu items at El Primo Restaurant at a complete profit,” Foley’s office said in a statement.

The proceeds of the fraud were wired to Venezuela and the Dominican Republic, prosecutors said.

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The Boston Globe

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Sunday single copy	\$6.00	6.00	6.00

Lottery

TUESDAY MIDDAY		7963
Payoffs (based on a \$1 bet)		
EXACT ORDER		
All 4 digits		\$4,445
First or last 3		\$622
Any 2 digits		\$53
Any 1 digit		\$5
ANY ORDER		
All 4 digits		\$185
First 3		\$104
Last 3		\$104
TUESDAY NIGHT		7057
Payoffs (based on a \$1 bet)		
EXACT ORDER		
All 4 digits		\$5,753
First or last 3		\$805
Any 2 digits		\$69
Any 1 digit		\$7
ANY ORDER		
All 4 digits		\$479
First 3		\$134
Last 3		\$134

MILLIONAIRE FOR LIFE		
Oct. 5	2-9-21-41-57	
Millionaire Ball 5		
Jackpot: \$1 million per year; no winners		
MASS CASH		
Oct. 6	1-6-17-19-21	
Jackpot: \$100,000		
MEGA MILLIONS		
Oct. 6	26-32-42-51-54	
Megaball 22		
Jackpot: \$345,000,000		
PREVIOUS DRAWINGS		
	Midday	Night
Monday	1324	2907
Sunday	6810	0978
Saturday	4974	5332
Friday	1640	3253
Thursday	2540	9965
TUESDAY NUMBERS AROUND NEW ENGLAND		
Maine, N.H., Vermont		
Day: 3-digit 174	4-digit 0400	
Eve: 3-digit 749	4-digit 8874	
Rhode Island	1763	

This day in history

Today is Wednesday, Oct. 7, the 280th day of 2026. There are 85 days left in the year.

Birthdays: Author Thomas Keaneally is 91. Singer John Mellen-camp is 75. Rock musician Tico Torres (Bon Jovi) is 73. Cellist Yo-Yo Ma is 71. TV personality Simon Cowell is 67. Singer-actor Toni Braxton is 59. Rock singer-musician Thom Yorke (Radiohead) is 58. Actor Nicole Ari Parker is 56. Singer Taylor Hicks is 50. Actor Omar Miller is 48. MLB player Mookie Betts is 34. Actor Lulu Wilson is 21.

►In 1765, the Stamp Act Congress convened in New York to draw up colonial grievances against England.

►In 1913, the first moving assembly line began operation at the Ford Motor Company factory in Highland Park, Mich.

►In 1916, in the most lopsided

victory in college football history, Georgia Tech defeated Cumberland University 222-0 in Atlanta.

►In 1985, Palestinian gunmen hijacked the Italian cruise ship Achille Lauro in the Mediterranean Sea. The hijackers shot and killed Leon Klinghoffer, a Jewish American tourist in a wheelchair, and pushed him overboard, before surrendering on Oct. 9.

►In 1992, trade representatives of the United States, Canada, and Mexico initialed the North American Free Trade Agreement during a ceremony in San Antonio in the presence of President George H.W. Bush, Canadian Prime Minister Brian Mulroney, and Mexican President Carlos Salinas de Gortari.

►In 1998, Matthew Shepard, a gay college student, was beaten

and left tied to a wooden fence post outside of Laramie, Wyo.; he died five days later. Russell Henderson and Aaron McKinney are serving life sentences for Shepard’s murder.

►In 2001, war in Afghanistan started as the United States and Britain launched air attacks against military targets and Osama bin Laden’s training camps in the wake of the Sept. 11 attacks. The US military completed its withdrawal from Afghanistan to end the 20-year war on Aug. 30, 2021.

►In 2003, California voters recalled Governor Gray Davis and elected Arnold Schwarzenegger their new governor.

►In 2006, Russian investigative journalist Anna Politkovskaya, who wrote stories critical of Kremlin policies in the early years of Vladimir Putin’s presi-

dency, was shot and killed in Moscow. The Kremlin denied any role in the death of Politkovskaya, who worked for an independent newspaper.

►In 2019, President Donald Trump ordered the withdrawal of US troops from northeastern Syria. Syria’s Kurds accused the United States of turning its back on its allies and risking gains made in the fight against the Islamic State group.

►In 2023, Hamas-led militants stormed into Israel from the Gaza Strip, killing nearly 1,200 people and taking more than 250 hostages. Israel’s retaliatory offensive and the ensuing Israel-Hamas war killed tens of thousands in Gaza, displaced about 90 percent of its population, and destroyed vast areas until major combat subsided with an October 2025 ceasefire agreement.

SJC rules sending photo wasn’t a crime

Says ‘Peeping Tom’ law applies to third party

By John R. Ellement
GLOBE STAFF

An Edgartown man did not violate the state’s “Peeping Tom” law when he sent a man he met on Grindr a still image of the two being intimate, the Supreme Judicial Court ruled Tuesday.

The SJC overturned Clerence H. Goncalves’ conviction for dissemination of a nude photo, concluding that it’s a crime only when the image is shared with a third party, not when it’s sent to the person who was photographed or videoed. The photo was taken by a home security camera.

“We hold that sending a [nude] photograph of a victim solely to the victim himself or herself does not” violate the “Peeping Tom” law, Justice Elizabeth N. Dewar wrote for a unanimous court.

On Dec. 6, 2021, Goncalves

chatted with a man on Grindr and the two eventually returned to his Edgartown apartment, where they were intimate, the ruling said.

Goncalves, who claimed on Grindr he did not tape his encounters, had a black security camera installed in a dark corner of his living room pointed at the couch, the court said. The other man did not notice it, and Goncalves did not tell him about it, the ruling said.

Later that month, the two texted each other and Goncalves included a nude image of him from their earlier encounter, infuriating the other man, the ruling said.

“Do you think that I’m ashamed enough that I won’t send these screenshots to the Edgartown PD?” the man texted Goncalves, who then blocked him.

The man did report it to Edgartown police, leading to Goncalves’ arrest and subsequent conviction, which he appealed.

The court concluded that while the 18-year-old law criminalized surreptitious “up skirt-

ing,” it did not define “dissemination,” the ruling stated.

After reviewing the definitions in several dictionaries, and noting that the law imposes its strongest punishment when images are shared with others, the court ruled that Goncalves’s action was not illegal.

“The plain meaning of [disseminate] thus involves spreading or dispersing material,” the court ruled. “Transmitting the image solely to the victim, while no doubt in many cases a source of intense distress to the victim, does not entail these same harms.”

Goncalves’ defense attorney, Committee for Public Counsel Services attorney Haylie Jacobson, welcomed the part of the ruling that threw out his conviction. “Mr. Goncalves has always maintained that he is not guilty of these offenses,” she said in a statement. “We are gratified that the SJC reversed his felony conviction and ordered a judgment of not guilty, and that the Court read the statute according to its plain meaning.”

The 28-page decision was not a complete victory for Goncalves. The court upheld a second charge of photographing an unsuspecting nude person, rejecting the defense’s argument that he mistakenly recorded the encounter.

“So I make porno,” he told Edgartown police while laughing, according to the SJC. “This is the last time I’ll be in the police station. I’ll go back to Brazil.”

Goncalves was convicted by an Edgartown District Court jury after a one-day trial. He was sentenced to 10 days in the Barnstable House of Correction, records show.

“The evidence of the failure to inform the victim of the camera’s existence or seek his consent during their encounter on the couch tends to prove the defendant’s intent to hide and keep secret the photographing of the victim,” the ruling stated.

John R. Ellement can be reached at john.ellement@globe.com. Follow him @JREbosglobe.



Arjun Aravind listened during his arraignment at Concord District Court in Concord on Aug. 13.

Acton teenager pleads not guilty in deaths of mother and brother

By John R. Ellement and Nick Stoico
GLOBE STAFF

WOBURN — An Acton teenager who allegedly discussed killing his family with ChatGPT was ordered held without bail Tuesday on charges of murdering his mother and younger brother.

Arjun Aravind, 17, was indicted on two counts of first-degree murder and other charges in connection with the deaths of his mother, Sudha Venkatesan, 45, and his 14-year-old brother, Siddharth Aravind, inside the family’s Acton home on Aug. 11.

During the nine-minute session in Middlesex Superior Court, Aravind was positioned by his lawyer, Debra D. DeWitt, in a part of the prisoner’s dock where he was not visible to the public.

But Aravind spoke with a loud and firm voice each time he was asked to respond to the charges he faces.

“Not guilty,” he said each time.

The arraignment was the second time Aravind has appeared in public since his arrest some 24 hours after his relatives were found dead by local police, who were conducting a well-being check at his father’s request.

Aravind was arrested in Wayland without incident. He was ordered held without bail during his district court arraignment in August and has been in the custody of the Department of Youth Services since then, court records show.

On Tuesday, Middlesex Assistant District Attorney Suzanne M. Wiseman said there was “obvious planning” that included asking ChatGPT about killing his mother just hours before he allegedly did so.

She said investigators have pieced together a timeline of Aravind’s movements before, during, and after the killings.

After the killings, Aravind went to the second floor of the home, showered, changed his clothes, loaded some items into his mother’s car, and drove off, she said.

Around 4 p.m., he went to a Stop & Shop where he worked and bought more than \$2,000 of cereal and energy bars, authorities have said.

Aravind loaded the cereal and energy bars into his mother’s car, along with “his bedding and workout equipment, including a scale, a weight bench, and weights,” Wiseman said.

Wiseman said the medical examiner concluded that both victims died from blunt and sharp force trauma along with “mechanical asphyxiation.” She did not explain those findings.

DeWitt, speaking to reporters outside the courthouse, said that Aravind is doing “as well as expected for a 17-year-old charged with homicide.”

She also said that Aravind and his father have been in contact with each other.

“They’ve had contact. I’m not going to comment any further on that, but they have [had] contact,” she said. “It’s a difficult situation for both of them.”

DeWitt said she is still waiting to obtain ChatGPT data from prosecutors, which she considers an essential part of the case for both sides.

“As you have heard, the Commonwealth I think is weighing very heavily on them, and we cannot respond to anything until we get to see them,” she said. “We can’t even direct our investigation until we get to see those.”

A scheduling conference is set for Oct. 27.

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HIROKO MASUIKE/NEW YORK TIMES

RIPTA is considering building at least one light rail line — or a rapid bus route — to connect several of R.I.’s largest cities.

R.I. transit agency weighs light rail

►RHODE ISLAND
Continued from Page B1

more housing along the transit route, as the region is in desperate need of new development, and open new economic opportunities for those served by the route, some advocates said.

“Everybody’s just so fired up about it,” said Dylan Giles, operations manager of the Providence Streets Coalition. “It’s almost like, why are we just now doing this when cities that are smaller than us or with less transit demand than us are either building or have built light rail systems?”

At the center of the study are four visions: two light rail lines and two rapid bus lines.

For rail, routes could begin in Central Falls, then move through Pawtucket and Providence before terminating at Park Avenue in Cranston, according to the study. Among the differences between the two rail plans are whether the line would run along Dexter Street or Broad Street in Central Falls; the route it would take through downtown Providence; and whether it would traverse to Broad Street or Elmwood Avenue in South Providence.

Bus routes could also start along Dexter or Broad streets in Central Falls and continue on through Pawtucket and Providence. One plan would run along Elmwood Avenue in Providence and Reservoir Avenue in Cranston before ending at the Community College of Rhode Island’s Warwick campus, while the other would traverse Eddy

‘We’ve got the density that really promotes better transit. And the Metro Connector is [our] dream of delivering on that.’

CHRISTOPHER DURAND, CEO of the Rhode Island Public Transit Authority

Street in Providence and would eventually turn onto Post Road to terminate at Rhode Island T.F. Green International Airport in Warwick, according to RIPTA.

Rail lines would end in Cranston rather than continue into Warwick, as there is lower density south of Park Avenue that’s not well-suited for light rail, according to RIPTA. A rapid bus route would have less frequent stops than existing bus service.

The agency will work toward having a final report and recommendation ready for its board of directors sometime in 2027, Durand said. But he added that with the anticipated slate of new leadership around Rhode Island coming in January — including a new governor and mayors of Providence and Pawtucket — there are plenty of considerations to be made.

“There’s still a lot of stakeholder engagement or discussions with the communities to say, like, ‘Hey, what are we missing the mark? Are we on it?’” Durand said.

While up-front capital expenses are higher for a rail line, the operational costs are lower than those for a rapid bus route, according to Durand. A rail line

would also serve more riders, with daily ridership projected to reach 17,000 to 19,000 passengers by 2035, while the bus proposals would serve 9,000 to 11,000 riders per day, according to RIPTA.

Durand said RIPTA would look to cover the projects through the Federal Transit Administration’s Capital Investment Grants program, which funds similar projects across the country. Funding through the program has stalled under the Trump administration, however, and Durand acknowledged a backlog of projects on hold.

Still, he said, the state has not previously tapped that funding source, and it remains a goal for RIPTA to secure it.

Giles, who also provides feedback on the study through its technical working group, said RIPTA has proven its ability to secure federal money working with the state’s congressional delegation, pointing to funds used to finance projects in recent years, such as the construction of the Pawtucket-Central Falls Transit Center and renovations of the East Side tunnel in Providence.

“But this would eclipse any

one of those many times over,” he said. The endeavor would be “a generational investment that we haven’t seen before.”

“It would take a huge lift that will take a lot of power, all kinds of pushing at the same time,” Giles said.

Peter Brassard, chair of the Rhode Island Association of Railroad Passengers, said that while the project proposals carry large price tags, the state regularly spends hefty sums on road infrastructure. He pointed to the project to replace the Washington Bridge’s western expanse on Interstate 195, estimated to cost about \$570 million.

“If it’s for cars, they’ll do it in a heartbeat,” said Brassard, who also serves on the study’s technical working group. “But when it comes to transit, it’s like suddenly, people look at it differently, but they really shouldn’t because we’re moving many more people.”

Asked if he considers the Metro Connector realistic for Rhode Island — whether the state can muster the political will to make it happen — Durand said he believes so. The demand “is fully there for light rail,” he said.

“You’re completely changing how a huge chunk of the state’s communities look, and ... that’s a big lift,” Durand said. “But, I think it’s our job to at least explore this and determine if this is feasible or not, and have that discussion.”

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Woman tests positive for West Nile virus, state’s 12th human case

By Madyline Swearing
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

A woman in her 60s is the 12th person this year to test positive for West Nile virus in Massachusetts, after she was likely exposed in Norfolk County, state public health officials said last week.

As a result, the risk of contracting the mosquito-borne virus has been raised to high in Milton and Quincy, the Department of Public Health said in a statement.

While most of the state remains at a moderate risk for contracting the virus, risk levels remain high in Boston, Brookline, Cambridge, Chelsea, Everett, Malden, Newton, Revere, Somerville, Watertown, and Winthrop, the statement said.

She is the first reported case out of Norfolk County. Most of the state’s 11 other human cases have occurred in Middlesex and Suffolk counties, according to the DPH.

Previously, three men were exposed in Suffolk County — a man in his 50s and two men in their 70s. Three other men were exposed in Middlesex County: a man in his 60s, a man in his 80s, and a man in his 90s. Another woman, in her 30s, was also exposed in Middlesex County. A man in his 60s was exposed in Worcester

County, the state said.

No further information was released about when or where they were exposed to the virus.

No animal cases have been reported.

Since the first West Nile-positive mosquito samples were announced June 16, an additional 340 samples have tested positive for the virus, the statement said.

Positive samples have been detected in every Massachusetts county besides Nantucket, according to the DPH.

While there have been no reported human or animal cases of eastern equine encephalitis, the virus has been detected in 27 mosquito samples this year, officials said.

West Nile virus and eastern equine encephalitis risk levels across the state are updated daily on the DPH website.

Public health officials urge residents to wear long-sleeved clothing and insect repellent with DEET or lemon eucalyptus oil while outdoors.

To help slow mosquito breeding, water collected in kiddie pools, birdbaths, flowerpots, and gutters should be regularly drained, the statement said.

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HEATHER DIEHL FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE/FILE 2025

Harvard University reported that international students comprised 27 percent of the student body last year.

US pushes effort to ban some students

►STUDENTS
Continued from Page B1

all international student enrollment at Harvard. First, Kristi Noem, the Homeland Security secretary at the time, sent a letter to the school revoking it’s Student and Exchange Visitor Program. But after a judge blocked that move, the president tried to sidestep the court and invoke national security powers with a formal proclamation.

The proclamation looked to restrict international enrollment for six months — from June to December 2025 — which would have barred Harvard from not only enrolling international students for the fall semester, but require that all current visa holders transfer.

Later that month, US District Court Judge Allison Burroughs blocked this attempt, too, issuing an injunction which the Trump administration appealed.

The case has remained stalled since.

International students have continued to study at the university — with Harvard reporting that they comprised 27 percent of the student body last year— while the president’s proclama-

‘While this is in effect, anybody from China, Cuba, Malaysia, Iceland, can’t come to Harvard. Including any person from Israel.’

GUSTAVO A. GELPÍ, *federal appellate court judge, questioning the federal government’s ban efforts*

tion lapsed. Still, the appeals hearing has loomed.

Noem’s letter said Harvard had perpetuated an “unsafe campus environment that is hostile to Jewish students, promotes pro-Hamas sympathies.” And in the president’s proclamation, he alleged that China was “exploiting the student visa program.”

But Gelpí questioned how the administration’s actions would help, particularly knowing that preventing students from Israel from enrolling, for example, could shrink the Jewish student body on campus, all while the administration has said it wants to curb antisemitism.

“While this is in effect, anybody from China, Cuba, Malay-

sia, Iceland, can’t come to Harvard,” he said. “Including any person from Israel.”

In briefs before the hearing, the federal government argued the appeal was necessary because Burroughs’s decision had undermined the president’s authority to exercise judgment in “critical contexts” with foreign affairs, immigration, and national security.

The government also argued the president should have the “broad discretion to suspend the entry of aliens whenever he finds their admission detrimental to the interests of the United States.” It also said that Harvard had threatened the country’s national security interests with its management of its student-visa system because the university

had refused to provide data on current student visa holders and failed to monitor discipline incidents and “undue foreign influence.”

Clement, Harvard’s outside counsel, said that if the court overturned Burroughs’s, decision, it would set a “hugely dangerous precedent” for the administration to be able to restrict where visas are valid in the United States and single out specific institutions.

Last year, Harvard president Alan Garber immediately cast the administration’s moves as a “series of government actions to retaliate against Harvard,” in a letter to the community.

In court Tuesday, Davis, the Justice Department lawyer, said the university had repeated that refrain now for too long, characterizing the administration’s efforts as a retaliatory campaign.

“This is a never ending get-out-of-jail-free card for Harvard,” he said.

Michaela Towfighi can be reached at michaela.towfighi@globe.com. Follow her on X @michaelatowfighi.

Higher ed leaders sue government over internships

Allege program change would affect access, talent

By Chloe Craft
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

A coalition of higher education leaders filed a lawsuit Monday in Boston challenging the federal government’s recent interpretation of an internship program for international students, which plaintiffs say will limit student access to work experience and weaken America’s edge in talent recruitment.

The lawsuit comes in response to messages US Immigration and Customs Enforcement emailed to university administrators in August that abruptly changed the requirements for Curricular Practical Training (CPT), a program that allows international students to participate in internships, co-ops, and other temporary work programs related to their studies.

The messages declared that students will only be eligible for CPT if the work opportunity is a graduation requirement for all students in a particular degree program, regardless of citizenship.

“This action is yet another attempt by the [Trump] administration to dissuade talented international students from continuing their education in America,” Rob McCarron, president of the Association of Independent Colleges and Universities in Massachusetts, one of the plaintiffs in the case, said in a statement.

When contacted by The Boston Globe, an ICE spokesperson said the agency does not comment on pending litigation.

According to statistics from ICE, 130,586 foreign students obtained work authorization through CPT in 2024. The top employers of CPT Participants in that year included Amazon, Tesla, and Google.

Some universities have already limited CPT authorizations ahead of the fall 2026 semester; Harvard University, Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Boston University, Tufts University, and Suffolk University are among the Massachusetts schools that have all temporarily paused most new and pending CPT authorization requests. All five schools are members of AICUM.

Several schools in the University of California system,

such as the University of California Berkeley, have paused their course-credit work experiences altogether.

The Presidents’ Alliance on Higher Education and Immigration, another plaintiff in the new case, claimed that some students have already lost work positions they secured months prior as a result of these institutional changes.

McCarron, president of the independent colleges group, said the ICE messages have caused “substantial disruptions” on campuses across Massachusetts as schools were forced to abruptly readapt longstanding processes surrounding student work experiences.

In the messages sent Aug. 12 and 24, ICE claims that the Student and Exchange Visitor Program has observed a rise in schools issuing CPT authorizations that violate the requirement that work experience to be an “integral part of an established curriculum.” While the text of the regulatory requirements for CPT has not changed, it seems ICE’s interpretation of the word “integral” has shifted.

The ICE messages warned that any institution found in violation could be investigated and lose certification to enroll international students.

The plaintiffs said the new interpretation of CPT requirements has left longstanding campus practices like co-op programs in limbo without allowing adequate time for schools to respond or take public comment.

The lawsuit also alleges that the communications were sent directly to campus university designated school officials — the employees in charge of advising international students and ensuring the university’s compliance with law — and threatened them with institutional penalties and personal liability for allowing previous CPT practices to continue.

The lawsuit includes a motion for a preliminary injunction to force the government to stop any changes to CPT immediately, and as long as the case is active.

The Presidents’ Alliance and several other plaintiffs in the case previously sued the Department of Homeland Security over limits on how long international students can stay on certain visas — a case that is ongoing.

Chloe Craft can be reached at chloe.craft@globe.com.

Protesters barricade road to Vt. ICE facility with ‘garden’

►PROTEST
Continued from Page B1

Officers moved temporary barriers across Harvest Lane, on either side of the federal facilities, blocking access to the buildings and their parking lots.

Moving quickly, the protesters assembled the planter boxes beside both sets of barriers. Theirs, however, were designed to be at least somewhat more permanent: They used heavy-duty construction adhesive to affix the boxes to the road.

Then they danced. And sang. And colored with sidewalk chalk. One man flew a rainbow kite.

After the initial flurry of activity, law enforcement generally stood down. Most police vehicles departed, leaving just a few to stand sentry.

The buildings blocked by the protesters included a US Citizenship and Immigration Services facility on one side of the road and ICE’s Law Enforcement Support Center on the other. The latter partners with police agencies around the world to identify “noncitizens suspected, arrested, or convicted of criminal activity,” according to ICE documents.

“I think what most people don’t realize nationally and locally is just how important the ICE infrastructure here is to ICE’s national operations,” pro-

tester Elliott Hungerford said. “So the ICE violence that we see nationwide — that I think everyone around the world is seeing — in a big way starts right here in Williston, Vt.”

It wasn’t clear how much Tuesday’s protest disrupted operations. The parking lots of both buildings were largely empty, which is unusual for a week-day. According to protest organizers, tenants in another complex housing an ICE office were instructed to work from home this week in anticipation of the planned actions.

ICE did not respond to questions about such preparations but issued a statement attributed to an unnamed Department of Homeland Security spokesperson saying it would not tolerate “rioting, assault, and destruction.”

“We remind the public that obstructing law enforcement is a federal crime and assaulting law enforcement is a felony,” the department said. “Under President Trump and Secretary [of Homeland Security Mark] Mullin, if you break the law, you will face the consequences. Illegal aliens are not welcome in the US.”

Federal and state officials have recently taken a harder line against Vermont’s anti-ICE protesters. Last week, the US Attorney’s Office for the District of



PAUL HEINTZ/GLOBE STAFF

Public works department employees removed “community gardens” made by anti-ICE protesters in Williston on Tuesday.

Vermont announced that it would charge five people with obstructing access to a federal facility during protests at ICE facilities in February, May, and July.

A week before that, Vermont Attorney General Charity Clark charged a dozen people with trespassing at the July protest. Previously, a local prosecutor had declined to bring charges.

Activists said Tuesday that the timing of the prosecutions

suggested that officials were trying to scare off protesters ahead of the week of action.

“I think that this attempt at repression has backfired and just encouraged more people to stand up,” Taranta said.

For much of the day, protesters stood vigil at the gardens, waving to motorists forced to turn around and take a different route through Williston’s commercial center. Some drivers honked in support. Others made

use of a middle finger. Still more appeared confused by the obstructions.

A little after noon, Darryl Bloom arrived with a container of zinnias to contribute to the cause. The 80-year-old Winooski resident had seen a social media post that morning with photos of the protest and wanted to support it, florally.

“I said, ‘Fantastic! What can I do?’” she said. “And I looked in my yard, and I said, ‘Oh, I can

take those.”

By 2 p.m., the protesters had dispersed, off to host a punk rock show in the parking lot of another ICE facility. A few hours after that, a bucket loader and two dump trucks from the Williston Public Works Department showed up and quickly destroyed the planter boxes.

Paul Heintz can be reached at paul.heintz@globe.com. Follow him on X @paulheintz.



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& more

LEGAL NOTICES

Legal Notice: Rt. 79, Davol Street Corridor Fall River, MA

The Massachusetts Department of Transportation (MassDOT) invites all interested parties to bid on approximately 20 acres of land located along Rt. 79 Davol Street Corridor, Fall River, MA.

To obtain a copy of the invitation to bid (ITB) and become a registered bidder, visit www.massdotrealty.com or contact MassDOT's designated representative:

Greystone Real Estate Advisory Group
20 Park Plaza, Suite 1120
Boston, Massachusetts 02116
Attention: Tom Cox
procurement@massdotrealty.com

Bids are due no later than **12:00 p.m. on October 21, 2026** at:

Office of Real Estate and Economic Development
Massachusetts Department of Transportation
State Transportation Building
Ten Park Plaza, Suite 2310
Boston, MA 02116
Attention: MassDOT Fall River Land Sale Bid

MassDOT reserves the right to reject any and all bids.

LEGAL NOTICES

**BOSTON HOUSING AUTHORITY
INVITATION FOR BID**

**Accessibility and Compliance at Lower Mills
BHA Job # 2373-02**

Lower Mills Housing Corporation (the "Owner"), which is an instrumentality of the Boston Housing Authority ("BHA"), invites sealed bids for **Accessibility and Compliance at Lower Mills, BHA Job # 2373-02**, prepared by KMA Architecture + Accessibility. **The work is estimated at \$585,000.** Bids will be received and publicly opened at the BHA's Procurement Department, 52 Chauncy Street, 6th floor, Boston, MA, 02111. If bidders are to hand-deliver bids, please drop off bids at the Bids/Proposals Drop-Off Box in the lobby of 52 Chauncy Street.

Bids not received by the following times will be rejected: **General bid opening (in-person and virtual): 11:00 AM on Wednesday, October 28, 2026.** <https://tinyurl.com/2373-02bid>

The general bid must be DCAMM certified in General Building Construction, provides its DCAMM Update Statement, and include a 5% bid deposit. The successful general bidder must furnish 100% Performance and Payment Bonds.

Wages are subject to minimum wage rates set by the US Department of Labor and the Massachusetts Department of Labor Standards. General bidders should assume the higher of Federal Davis Bacon or State Prevailing wages. General bidders must follow the BHA's Minority and Women Participation Provision and Resident Employment Provision.

This invitation for Bid is issued pursuant to Chapter 268 of the Acts of 2022, which enables alternative procurement methodology for public housing redevelopment. This project does not require filed sub-bidding. General bidders must solicit participation of qualified subcontractors, subject to final approval by the Owner.

Bid package is available to download via <https://www.bostonhousing.org/en/Bid-Opportunities/Current-Bid-Opportunities.aspx>; email queries regarding BHA bids may be directed to bids@bostonhousing.org.

Bidders may attend the optional site visit at 10:00 AM on October 14, 2026, at Lower Mills, 2262 Dorchester Ave., Dorchester, MA; technical questions may be directed to Tejpal Mhatre, Email tmhatre@kmacess.com. The latest date for the AE to receive questions will be October 16, 2026. The BHA reserves the right to waive any informalities or to reject any or all bids, if it be in the public interest to do so.

**COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS
LAND COURT
DEPARTMENT OF THE TRIAL COURT
Docket No. 26 SM 003183
ORDER OF NOTICE**

TO: Annmarie Condon a/k/a Annmarie Condon Teta

and to all persons entitled to the benefit of the Servicemembers Civil Relief Act, 50 U.S.C. c. 50 §3901 (et seq):

Citibank, N.A. as Indenture Trustee for American Home Mortgage Investment Trust 2004-3

claiming to have an interest in a Mortgage covering real property in Norwood, numbered 3-9 Endicott Street, Unit No. 9-2, of the Endicott Village Condominium, given by Annmarie Condon to American Home Mortgage Acceptance, Inc., dated June 29, 2004, and recorded in Norfolk County Registry of Deeds in Book 21226, Page 28, and now held by the Plaintiff by assignment, has/have filed with this court a complaint for determination of Defendant's/Defendants' Servicemembers status.

If you now are, or recently have been, in the active military service of the United States of America, then you may be entitled to the benefits of the Servicemembers Civil Relief Act. If you object to a foreclosure of the above-mentioned property on that basis, then you or your attorney must file a written appearance and answer in this court at Three Pemberton Square, Boston, MA 02108 on or before 11/16/2026 or you may lose the opportunity to challenge the foreclosure on the ground of noncompliance with the Act.

Witness, GORDON H. PIPER Chief Justice of this Court on 10/1/2026.
Attest: Deborah J. Patterson, Recorder

Boston Housing Authority
Public Notice (Re-Advertisement)

Designers registered in Massachusetts are advised that applications are available for preparation of plans and specifications and construction administration for at the Boston Housing Authority. The firm must provide full basic services including investigation and initial design through preparation of contract documents, bidding and construction contract administration. The project manager or person charged with handling this project must be an Engineer or an Architect registered in Massachusetts.

Phase I fee is \$95k. Phase II scope and fee will be negotiated with the selected Designer and incorporated through a contract amendment.

Applications and brochure requirements can be obtained by logging on to the Designer Selection Network at <https://dsb.formverse5.com/FORMVERSESERVER-DSB/webApp/Login.aspx> and selecting the Boston Housing Authority and 035556. A copy of the completed application must be submitted into the Designer Selection Network by **10/28/2026 at 2:00 p.m.**

PROJECT: EOHLC # 035536, BHA # 2421-01, Modernization of the 202 units at the BHA's Fairmount Apartments.

SCOPE: provide professional master planning, design and construction administration services in two phases for the BHA's 202-unit Fairmount Apartments state public housing development ("Fairmount") in the Hyde Park neighborhood of Boston, Massachusetts.

BRIEFING SESSION: None.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION: Direct questions about the Designer Selection Network to the EOHLC Designer Selection Coordinator at EOHLCDesignerSelectionCoordinator@mass.gov.

**COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS
LAND COURT
DEPARTMENT OF THE TRIAL COURT
Docket No. 26 SM 003155
ORDER OF NOTICE**

TO: Alex Sainlaire and Hannah Mathes

and to all persons entitled to the benefit of the Servicemembers Civil Relief Act, 50 U.S.C. c. 50 §3901 (et seq):

CrossCountry Mortgage, LLC

claiming to have an interest in a Mortgage covering real property in Billerica, numbered 186 River Street, given by Alex Sainlaire and Hannah Mathes to Mortgage Electronic Registration Systems, Inc., as mortgagee, as nominee for Guaranteed Rate, Inc., its successors and assigns, dated December 1, 2020, and recorded in Middlesex County (Northern District) Registry of Deeds in Book 34995, Page 1, and now held by the Plaintiff by assignment, has/have filed with this court a complaint for determination of Defendant's/Defendants' Servicemembers status.

If you now are, or recently have been, in the active military service of the United States of America, then you may be entitled to the benefits of the Servicemembers Civil Relief Act. If you object to a foreclosure of the above-mentioned property on that basis, then you or your attorney must file a written appearance and answer in this court at Three Pemberton Square, Boston, MA 02108 on or before 11/16/2026 or you may lose the opportunity to challenge the foreclosure on the ground of noncompliance with the Act.

Witness, GORDON H. PIPER Chief Justice of this Court on 9/29/2026.
Attest: Deborah J. Patterson, Recorder

**COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS
LAND COURT
DEPARTMENT OF THE TRIAL COURT
Docket No. 26 SM 003147
ORDER OF NOTICE**

TO: Touria Ghoubaché and Adil Essebbbar

and to all persons entitled to the benefit of the Servicemembers Civil Relief Act, 50 U.S.C. c. 50 §3901 (et seq):

U.S. Bank Trust National Association, not in its individual capacity, but solely as Owner Trustee for Citigroup Mortgage Loan Trust 2024-RP4

claiming to have an interest in a Mortgage covering real property in East Boston, numbered 241 Leyden Street, given by Adil Essebbbar and Touria Ghoubaché to Mortgage Electronic Registration Systems, Inc., as mortgagee, as nominee for National Mortgage LLC D/B/A Mr. Cooper, its successors and assigns, dated March 13, 2019, and recorded in Suffolk County Registry of Deeds in Book 60858, Page 81, and now held by the Plaintiff by assignment, has/have filed with this court a complaint for determination of Defendant's/Defendants' Servicemembers status.

If you now are, or recently have been, in the active military service of the United States of America, then you may be entitled to the benefits of the Servicemembers Civil Relief Act. If you object to a foreclosure of the above-mentioned property on that basis, then you or your attorney must file a written appearance and answer in this court at Three Pemberton Square, Boston, MA 02108 on or before 11/16/2026 or you may lose the opportunity to challenge the foreclosure on the ground of noncompliance with the Act.

Witness, GORDON H. PIPER Chief Justice of this Court on 9/29/2026.
Attest: Deborah J. Patterson, Recorder

**COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS
LAND COURT
DEPARTMENT OF THE TRIAL COURT
Docket No. 26 SM 003176
ORDER OF NOTICE**

TO: Jennifer R. Robinson

and to all persons entitled to the benefit of the Servicemembers Civil Relief Act, 50 U.S.C. c. 50 §3901 (et seq):

U.S. Bank Trust, National Association, not in its Individual Capacity but solely as Trustee for PL Pretium Trust

claiming to have an interest in a Mortgage covering real property in Littleton, numbered 38 Roxbury Drive, given by Jennifer R. Robinson to Mortgage Electronic Registration Systems, Inc., as mortgagee, as nominee for Principal Residential Mortgage, Inc., its successors and assigns, dated February 20, 2002, and recorded in Middlesex County (Southern District) Registry of Deeds in Book 42102, Page 330, as affected by a Loan Modification Agreement dated March 17, 2016, and recorded at said Registry of Deeds in Book 67104, Page 153, and now held by the Plaintiff by assignment, has/have filed with this court a complaint for determination of Defendant's/Defendants' Servicemembers status.

If you now are, or recently have been, in the active military service of the United States of America, then you may be entitled to the benefits of the Servicemembers Civil Relief Act. If you object to a foreclosure of the above-mentioned property on that basis, then you or your attorney must file a written appearance and answer in this court at Three Pemberton Square, Boston, MA 02108 on or before 11/16/2026 or you may lose the opportunity to challenge the foreclosure on the ground of noncompliance with the Act.

Witness, GORDON H. PIPER Chief Justice of this Court on 9/30/2026.
Attest: Deborah J. Patterson, Recorder

108 Stitches



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Business

HubSpot to lay off more than 600 employees in restructuring

CEO says job cuts were not driven by ‘AI-related efficiencies’

By Dana Gerber
GLOBE STAFF

Cambridge tech firm HubSpot announced Tuesday that it is laying off nearly 660 employees, or about 7 percent of its workforce.

The job cuts come amid a stock slump for HubSpot, which aims to help businesses improve operations through marketing automation, customer service, and sales software. It has recently doubled down on its focus on artificial intelligence — a pivot that chief executive Yamini Rangan said played a part in

the restructuring.

“That shift is transforming product, pricing and how we serve our customers. But we also need to fundamentally change the way we are organized to compete and win,” Rangan wrote in a note to employees announcing the job cuts. “We need to move faster, stay closer to our customers and focus our resources on our highest priorities to set ourselves up for success in this next chapter. That requires difficult choices about how we are organized.”

Rangan emphasized that the job cuts

were not being driven by “AI-related efficiencies,” as has been a prevailing fear across the tech industry, nor were they “simply a cost-cutting exercise.” Instead, she said, the layoffs are part of the company’s efforts to build “a flatter organization,” cutting down on “management layers and [moving] decisions closer to the people doing the work.”

A HubSpot spokesperson declined to clarify to the Globe how many of the affected employees are based in Massachusetts or how many Mass.-based em-

LAYOFFS, Page B9



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

HubSpot aims to help businesses improve operations through marketing automation, customer service, and sales software.



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF/FILE/2023

The Vicksburg Square complex at Devens, a 400,000-square-foot-plus barracks complex, would need \$44 million in environmental remediation before being converted to apartments.

An old Army barracks for housing

Towns around Devens moving forward to get more residences

It’s the kind of field trip that would be fun for an architect, or maybe a historian.

The nearly century-old buildings that comprise Vicksburg Square drew a different kind of visitor last month: government officials from the towns of Harvard, Ayer, and Shirley. They came to get a closer look at this impressive but weather-beaten brick campus, and to dream aloud about how to fill it up again.

The 400,000-square-foot-plus barracks complex, empty now for three decades, straddles the Ayer and Harvard town line while actually sitting in the jurisdiction of a quasi-public state entity, MassDevelopment. Their tour guide was Michael Sweeney, MassDevelopment’s relatively new appointee to oversee all the former Devens base properties, spanning some 4,400 acres across the three towns.

The bad news: It will cost \$44 million for environmental remediation in Vicksburg’s four main

JON CHESTO
CHESTO MEANS BUSINESS



buildings to get them ready to be converted to apartments. The good news: MassDevelopment seems more eager than it has in a long time to make such a conversion happen.

The 90-acre innovation and technology district where Vicksburg is located at Devens still needs to be rezoned for housing. Toward that end, MassDevelopment is drawing up a rezoning proposal that would go to all three towns for their approval in the spring of next year.

It’s all part of a broader effort by the Healey administration to turn unused state parcels into residences, to address the state’s pressing need for more housing construction.

Although repurposing state land has been done under previous administrations, these projects seem to be gaining momentum lately. Consider the groundbreaking by Vivmark (formerly AvalonBay)

CHESTO, Page B10

Brigham nurses urge investigation

Union alleges hospital parent MGB may have violated state, US laws

By Jonathan Saltzman
GLOBE STAFF

The union that represents about 4,000 Brigham and Women’s Hospital nurses who plan to go on strike next Wednesday has asked state Attorney General Andrea Joy Campbell to investigate the hospital’s corporate parent for potential violations of federal and state laws.

In a significant escalation of tensions between the Massachusetts Nurses Association and Brigham, the union sent Campbell’s office a letter Tuesday questioning whether Mass General Brigham has violated laws that regulate nonprofit health care systems and charitable institutions. The union says MGB has, among other

things, allowed members of its board of trustees to enrich their own corporations through contracts those companies have with the health system.

Jessica Pastore, an MGB spokesperson, described the letter as without merit, saying, “We are confident that Mass General Brigham’s actions are fully consistent with our obligations as a nonprofit charitable organization.”

Among the trustees whom the union focused on are John Fish, chief executive of Suffolk Construction, Jonathan Kraft, president of the Kraft Group, and Phillip Ragon, founder and chief executive of the technology company InterSystems. Those companies received a combined \$59.4

million in construction, leasing, and technology contracts, respectively, from MGB in fiscal 2024, the union said, citing IRS filings.

The union also asked Campbell to review the decision by MGB’s board to pay the health system’s chief executive, Dr. Anne Klibanski, nearly \$9.2 million in 2024, a roughly 9 percent increase from the year prior. She is the top-paid health system executive in Massachusetts.

“MNA requests an assessment of whether the identified conduct is consistent with MGB’s obligations as a public charity and whether corrective action is necessary,” said the letter from Peter J.

NURSES, Page B8



PAT GREENHOUSE/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Brigham and Women’s Hospital nurses staged a one-day strike in July. Next Wednesday’s walkout is slated to be indefinite.

Uber in \$2.3b deal to acquire ezCater

Purchase expected to help expand food order operations

By Yogev Toby
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

The ride-share giant Uber said Tuesday that it’s acquiring Boston-based ezCater, one of the top office catering companies in the country, for \$2.3 billion.

The deal marks a quick exit for a promising local tech company that had plans to go public on its own just a few years ago. It comes a day after PTC, a leading local software company, said it is being acquired by French conglomerate Schneider Electric. And many in Boston remember that it was Uber that bought liquor delivery service Drizly for \$1 billion in 2021 only to shutter the brand three years later.

San Francisco-based Uber said the ezCater acquisition will expand its existing Uber Eats and Uber for Business operations, allowing restaurants it works with to increase their order size and customer base.

“Catering is a big business, and can be a huge revenue stream for restaurants,” Dara Khosrowshahi, Uber’s chief executive, said in a statement. “With Uber’s reach, we can bring that experience to millions more customers and help restaurants win more of these valuable orders.”

ezCater, located in the Financial District, was founded in 2007 as an online tech platform to help businesses and offices buy large food orders from local eateries. It has since grown into a national leader in the catering world, boasting more than 140,000 restaurant partners across the country and valued at more than \$1.6 billion, according to the announcement and past disclosures.

“We’re thrilled to be joining forces with Uber,” said Nihad Rahman, ezCater’s chief executive, in a statement. “Our team is proud of what we’ve built. The leading platform for workplace catering, and a major growth channel for our restaurant partners.”

During the COVID pandemic, ezCater nearly saw its demise, as offices transitioned to work-from-home and fewer people relied on catered lunch breaks. Sales dropped 85 percent and the company laid off 420 workers. It rebounded after shifting to a business model that steered away from white-collar offices

UBER , Page B8

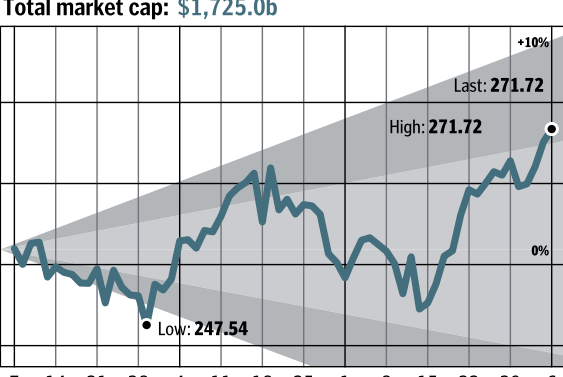
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25

Index of publicly traded companies in Massachusetts

Globe 25 index

Total market cap: \$1,725.0b



Yesterday 271.72 ▲ 1.60 ▲ 0.6% ▲ YTD 12.2%

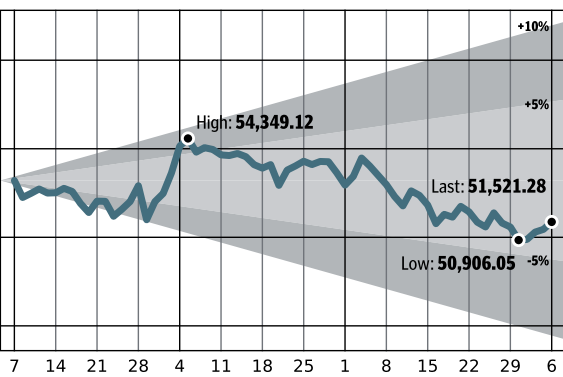
	Price	Chg	% chg	Market cap (bil.)
GE VERNOVA INC (GEV)	1,029.21	+39.21	+4.0	274.1
THERMO FISHER (TMO)	656.58	-20.18	-3.0	242.8
ANALOG DEVICES (ADI)	420.55	+1.45	+0.3	203.8
TJX COS INC (TJX)	137.03	+2.62	+1.9	150.7
VERTEX PHARM (VRTX)	502.31	-1.19	-0.2	127.3
AMERICAN TOWER C (AMT)	164.78	+2.52	+1.6	76.8
MODERNA INC (MRNA)	187.46	-15.75	-7.8	74.8
TERADYNE INC (TER)	430.32	-14.21	-3.2	67.3
BOSTON SCIENTIFC (BSX)	42.19	-0.21	-0.5	61.1
STATE ST CORP (STT)	175.75	-0.62	-0.4	48.3
WATERS CORP (WAT)	436.43	-3.69	-0.8	42.9
KEURIG DR PEPPER (KDP)	31.13	+0.24	+0.8	42.4
IRON MOUNTAIN (IRM)	116.50	+4.17	+3.7	34.7
BIOGEN INC (BIIB)	222.89	-0.70	-0.3	32.9
ALNYLAM PHARMACE (ALNY)	223.94	+4.05	+1.8	30.0
MACOM TECHNOLOGY (MTSI)	350.67	+22.37	+6.8	26.8
SYMBOTIC INC (SYM)	44.15	+1.28	+3.0	26.7
ENTEGRIS INC (ENTG)	166.89	-0.03	-0.0	25.5
EVERSOURCE ENERG (ES)	65.26	+0.57	+0.9	24.6
VERALTO CORP (VLTO)	96.45	-0.12	-0.1	23.5
MKS INC (MKS)	281.41	+0.91	+0.3	19.0
DYNATRACE INC (DT)	61.05	+0.84	+1.4	17.6
TOAST INC-A (TOST)	30.25	+0.21	+0.7	17.5
REVVITY INC (RVTY)	153.30	-4.06	-2.6	17.1
CLEAN HARBORS (CLH)	318.06	-4.31	-1.3	16.8

Markets

New heights despite many risks

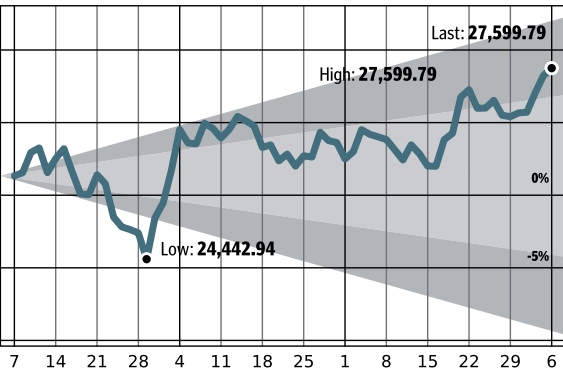
The US stock market has never been higher, even as the list of challenges chipping away at it keeps growing. The record-high stock prices are helping investors feel better about their finances, or at least less bad, when Americans are generally feeling discouraged about keeping up with the fast-rising cost of living. Many of the fears that sent the US stock market to its bottom in March have indeed come true. Oil prices are high because of the war with Iran, which has made inflation worse. Yields have cranked higher in the bond market, which threatens to slow the economy by making it more expensive for everyone to borrow money. And Americans broadly say they're feeling more pessimistic about the economy and where it's heading. But one vital source of support has remained resolute for the US stock market throughout: the relentless ability for companies to make more money. Lamb Weston, which sells frozen fries and other potato products, said on Tuesday that its profit and revenue during its latest quarter topped its projections, for example. The results also beat analysts' expectations, and its stock rallied 7.5 percent. — ASSOCIATED PRESS

DOW JONES industrial average



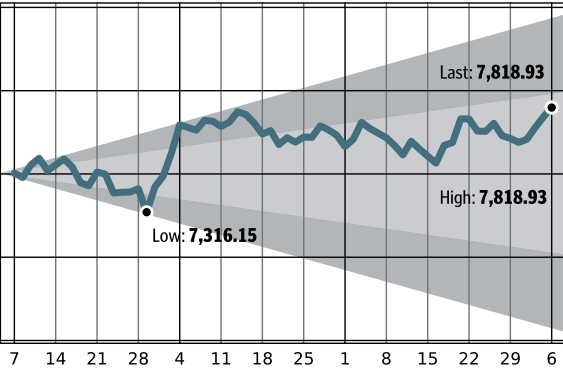
Yesterday 51,521.28 ▲ 253.38 ▲ 0.5% ▲ YTD 7.2%

NASDAQ Composite index



Yesterday 27,599.79 ▲ 122.48 ▲ 0.4% ▲ YTD 18.7%

S&P 500 index



Yesterday 7,818.93 ▲ 44.98 ▲ 0.6% ▲ YTD 14.2%

SOURCE: Bloomberg News

Paramount closes mega-merger

Aquires Warner Bros. Discovery

By Benjamin Mullin

NEW YORK TIMES

Paramount closed its deal to acquire Warner Bros. Discovery on Tuesday, putting tech scion David Ellison in control of a vast media empire that oversees many of Hollywood's most valuable properties. The deal immediately catapults the combined company, now called Skydance, to the front rank of competitors alongside streaming titans like Netflix and YouTube, just behind giants like Disney and Amazon.

"Today is a historic day, not just for Skydance but for our entire industry," Ellison said in a statement Tuesday. "We couldn't be more excited to get to work," he added.

There were signs that Ellison was moving at lightning speed to take control of his new empire. Warner Bros. employees who opened their laptops Tuesday morning saw them suddenly emblazoned with the new company's logo over a field of stars. A link to a "global town hall" meeting, scheduled for 1 p.m., popped up. And an 1,705-word memo titled "Day 1" from Ellison and his co-CEO, Ynon Kreiz, landed in their inboxes.

"We're proud to write this next chapter with you," they wrote. "Now the real work begins. Let's go!"

The new company is a hard-fought prize. Ellison wrested Warner Bros. Discovery from a rival bidder, Netflix, after a



Skydance CEO David Ellison pledged to not interfere with news coverage of CNN.

monthslong tug-of-war that prompted him to make nine offers for the company.

A coalition of state attorneys general sued to block the deal on antitrust grounds but settled after extracting a series of concessions, including the establishment of an editorial independence board to safeguard the integrity of CNN and a promise from Ellison to spend an additional \$1.5 billion on movies over the next five years.

Hundreds of Hollywood insiders said the deal would sharply consolidate corporate power, leading to job losses and further stagnation in Hollywood. Skydance has argued the merger is a necessary counterweight to Big Tech.

The new company, which owns two major movie studios in Warner Bros. and Paramount Pictures, news networks including CNN and CBS News, and streaming services HBO Max and Paramount+, is making its

debut in an industry navigating profound change.

Cable television, one of the biggest cash cows in media, is still profitable but in terminal decline. Streaming still hasn't replaced those profits. Trust in the news business is in the basement. And tech companies like Amazon and Apple are muscling in on movies, TV shows, and sports rights, driving up content costs.

Those challenges will pose a major test for Ellison, 43, who until last year had never run a public media company. He and his team must convince Wall Street that the new company can manage those challenges while it pays down \$82 billion in debt, a staggering sum for a traditional media company. He must also rally tens of thousands of employees at Warner Bros. and Paramount; both companies have undergone nearly annual layoffs in recent years.

There were some signs of early turbulence on the horizon. On Tuesday, ratings agency Fitch said it was downgrading the combined company to reflect increased debt as well as "significant execution and integration risks."

And Ellison and Kreiz alluded to the prospect of looming layoffs in their memo. They must deliver \$6 billion in cost-cutting over the next three years — a target they are likely to hit, in part by eliminating thousands of jobs.

Elsewhere at the company, corporate leaders sought to reassure employees amid the uncertainty caused by the deal. Bari Weiss, editor-in-chief of CBS News, reminded journalists on a call Tuesday morning that they had become accustomed to carrying out their duties despite "a lot of things going on in the press."

"Nothing right now is going to change," Weiss said. "This is a process that's going to unfold under time."

Further complicating the situation is Ellison's relationship with President Trump, which has unsettled some employees at CNN. This spring, Ellison held a dinner "honoring the Trump White House" before the annual White House Correspondents' Association dinner and later joined Trump at an Ultimate Fighting Championship bout at the White House.

Ellison has assuaged some of those concerns by retaining Mark Thompson as chair of CNN. In a memo to employees Monday, Thompson said he had spoken to Ellison and came away convinced that executives at Skydance would support the "independent news that CNN has always stood for."

Ellison further addressed the anxieties about CNN's independence during a town hall meeting Tuesday, where he and Kreiz were interviewed by CNN anchor Anderson Cooper.

"We believe in complete editorial independence," Ellison said. "We trust Mark, we trust the team."

"You're pledging not to interfere with news coverage of CNN?" Cooper interjected.

"Correct," Ellison said. "We've been very clear."

Uber to acquire ezCater for \$2.3b

► **UBER**
Continued from Page B7

and instead appealed to factories and hospitals — which needed people working in person.

Company founder and former chief executive Stefania Mallett stepped down in 2023, saying in a past interview that it was her time to “quit while you’re ahead.”

Former Amazon and Lyft executive Ashwin Raj took over as chief executive, only to abruptly leave in January of last year, 18 months after assuming the role.

At the time, ezCater was expected to cruise toward an IPO and go public, especially after Rahman left JPMorgan Chase and joined as chief financial officer in 2022.

Still, Uber said on Tuesday

ezCater is profitable, excluding some expenses.

Catering orders average \$400, and the company has kept its workforce steady at roughly 900 employees, with 300 in Boston.

The deal helps Uber diversify its revenue and further widen its reach, said Peter Cohan, professor of business strategy and entrepreneurship at Babson College. While the exit came as a surprise to Cohan and other business analysts, he said it's a good fit for Uber's ambitions.

“One of the things that might have been slowing down the growth of ezCater was the sales process,” he said. “The question is whether Uber will . . . be able to do this selling more efficiently.”

Being efficient, he added,



JAMES ARTHUR GEKIERE/BELGA MAG/BELGA/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

The acquisition of Boston's ezCater is expected to help Uber diversify its revenue and further widen its reach.

could mean relocating the company's headquarters to San Francisco, laying off financial and human resources workers, and replicating ezCater's business model outside the United States, using Uber's global partnerships.

“The pressure is really on the people in Boston now to prove

Brigham nurses ask state to investigate parent

► **NURSES**
Continued from Page B7

Duffy, a Boston lawyer hired by the union. Depending on the attorney general's findings, Duffy wrote, the appropriate action might include “recovery of improperly diverted funds.”

Pastore said MGB has a rigorous conflict-of-interest policy that requires board members to disclose potential conflicts and recuse themselves from any matter in which they have a personal or business interest.

Projects such as the construction that Suffolk has done for the health system are put out to competitive bidding, she added.

“Overall, Suffolk Construction has been awarded 5 percent of capital projects at Mass General Brigham's hospitals since 2018,” she said.

As for Klibanski's salary, Pastore said, the chief executive's total compensation of \$8.4 million in 2023 ranked well below the chief executives of rival health systems in the country, including Charlotte, N.C.-based Advocate Health (\$30.9 million), New York Presbyterian (\$26.3 million), and NYU Langone (\$20.7 million). She added that when compared with peer institutions, Klibanski's compensation consistently falls in the bottom third of the market.

Spokespersons for Fish, Kraft, and Ragon did not respond to requests for comment. Campbell's office also did not provide a comment beyond confirming it received the letter.

Through the years, Suffolk Construction has had numerous multimillion-dollar contracts with MGB, including for serving as general contractor for the health care system's 900,000-square-foot Assembly Row administrative campus in Somerville, says the union.

In 2024, Suffolk received nearly \$49 million from MGB for construction services, according to the IRS filing cited by the union.

Kraft has had contracts, including for leasing property at Patriot Place in Foxborough to MGB, the union says, although Kraft joined the board in 2010, after the deal was signed. In 2024, Kraft companies received \$9.7 million for a lease and for marketing, IRS documents indicate.

Ragon's company, InterSystems, has provided technology products and services to MGB. The company received \$709,000 in 2024 from MGB, according to IRS documents.

Matthew McCoy, an associate professor of medical ethics and health policy at the University of Pennsylvania, reviewed the letter the nurses union sent to the attorney general. He said the union “makes a pretty compelling case” that the three trustees have conflicts of interest as executives and trustees.

That doesn't preclude them from serving on MGB's board, McCoy emphasized, but the health care organization must take precautions to avoid self-

dealing. That includes: prohibiting board members from voting on contracts that could benefit their companies; soliciting multiple bids for projects that might involve trustees' businesses; and providing transparency about any contracts MGB signs.

The lawyer for the nurses union wrote to Campbell's office as a major strike by the nurses looms at Brigham. After a bitter months-long stalemate with hospital management, the union said Friday that Brigham's nurses will walk out starting next Wednesday.

In contrast to the one-day strike by the nurses union at Brigham on July 8, this walkout is slated to be indefinite. That would make it far more disruptive to patients, the hospital, and nurses, who expect to forgo paychecks and lose Brigham's contribution to their health insurance premiums.

The dispute is largely over wages, though the union said it is also demanding the new contract provide more affordable health insurance options and limit the hospital's use of temporary nurses.

The union wants a 3 percent raise for the first six months of the contract and a 4 percent raise for the next 12 months. The hospital isn't offering any new across-the-board raise, but notes nurses already receive a 5 percent step increase on the yearly anniversary of their hiring until they reach two decades of service.

Brigham nurses start at \$86,700 annually, and those with two decades of service earn at least \$220,000, according to documents shared by MGB. Nearly one-third of the local, or 1,322 nurses, earn that maximum amount, MGB said, making them among the highest paid in the state.

Over the past five fiscal years, Brigham said Friday, nurses' base wages have increased by an average of 55 percent.

Brigham nurses say the across-the-board raise is crucial because of inflation, the high cost of living in Greater Boston, and to retain highly trained employees.

“We have repeatedly tried to get MGB to negotiate and avoid a second strike, but the billionaires who run MGB have shut the door on us,” Kelly Morgan, a Brigham labor and delivery charge nurse who heads the union bargaining unit, said last week.

MGB contends the union's wage demands are financially unsustainable.

A long-lasting strike could wreak havoc at Brigham, a Harvard-affiliated teaching hospital that attracts patients from around the world, and force MGB to shell out millions of dollars for fill-in nurses.

Marin Wolf of the Globe staff contributed to this report. Jonathan Saltzman can be reached at jonathan.saltzman@globe.com.

TALKING POINTS

MEDIA

ABC, TRUMP’S FCC BATTLE IN FEDERAL COURT OVER ISSUES OF FREE SPEECH, JURISDICTION



A lawyer for ABC on Tuesday asked a federal judge to prevent the Trump administration from conducting an unusual, early review of its broadcast licenses, likening it to a looming execution by guillotine that was already chilling the network’s editorial decisions just weeks before the US midterm elections. US District Judge Loren AliKhan did not immediately rule on ABC’s request for a preliminary injunction prohibiting the Federal Communications Commission from conducting its early review, which it said was unconstitutional, a violation of free speech, and a retaliation for content President Trump dislikes. A government attorney argued that, as a procedural matter, the court doesn’t have jurisdiction over ABC’s case because it belongs in a different venue. The government also challenged the network’s First Amendment arguments, and said ABC had failed to show it suffered irreparable harm. A ruling was not expected until at least mid-October. The judge asked the two sides to submit brief additional arguments by Friday, for the government, and Wednesday, for ABC. ABC and its parent company, Disney, sued the FCC and FCC Commissioner Brendan Carr (left) in August, several months after the commission ordered eight ABC-owned stations to submit renewal applications for their broadcast licenses years ahead of schedule. ABC had asked the judge to temporarily prohibit the FCC from taking any further action related to its license renewal proceedings. ABC also sought to prohibit the commission from trying to coerce or threaten the network to alter its “exercise of editorial discretion.” Carr, a Trump ally, ordered the early review of the stations’ licenses in April — just after a joke by ABC’s late-night host Jimmy Kimmel infuriated Trump, who called for the comedian’s firing.

— ASSOCIATED PRESS

AFFORDABILITY

HEALTH CARE COSTS BEAT HOUSING AS TOP VOTER MIDTERM CONCERN



Health care costs are tied with gas prices as voters’ top economic concern in the midterm election, according to a KFF poll released Tuesday. Six in 10 voters said they were “very” or “somewhat” worried about affording health care, outranking concerns over food, utilities, and housing, said KFF, a nonpartisan health policy research group. “With about a month to go before Election Day, our latest poll finds that health care costs are weighing heavily on voters’ minds and is driving home that this recent election is all about affordability,” said Shannon Schumacher, a senior survey analyst at KFF and one of the poll’s authors. Voters across the aisle overwhelmingly said an overhaul of the US health care system is needed. Nearly half of the voters surveyed said it was “extremely important” that political candidates talk about health care costs, and most said they want to hear plans on how they will lower prices. Republicans have historically polled better than Democrats on issues around the economy, per Schumacher. But KFF’s results found that voters, including independents, currently trust Democrats more on health care and living costs. Of the voters surveyed, 42 percent said they trusted Democrats to do a better job of handling health care costs, while 22 percent chose Republicans. The poll sampled 1,328 US adults in mid-September. Two-thirds of respondents supported a national health plan, or “Medicare-for-All”, the highest percentage since KFF began polling on the topic in 2016. Opinions continue to be split along party lines, with 84 percent of Democrats and 72 percent of independents in favor and 66 percent of Republicans opposed.

— BLOOMBERG NEWS

BEVERAGE

A LAWSUIT ACCUSES STARBUCKS OF MISLABELING 8 ‘SUGAR-FREE’ PROTEIN DRINKS



Starbucks is facing a consumer lawsuit over claims that the protein drinks labeled “sugar-free” on its cafe menus may actually contain more sugar than a Reese’s peanut butter cup. The federal lawsuit filed late Friday in Seattle alleges that eight protein beverages Starbucks sells in the US contain varying amounts of sugar even though the company lists them as sugarless. On Monday, the menu on Starbucks’s US website listed a 16-ounce Sugar-Free Caramel Protein Matcha with 16 grams of sugar and a 20-ounce version of the same drink with 21 grams of sugar. By comparison, one Reese’s cup has 11 grams of sugar. Hagens Berman, a law firm that specializes in class action cases, filed the suit on behalf of three individual consumers who bought Starbucks’s sugar-free protein drinks in California, New York, and Washington. “Consumers avoid sugar for various reasons, whether that be general health, diabetes, and blood glucose levels or other factors, and for many, a staunch mislabeling like this is significant,” said Steve Berman, a cofounder and managing partner of the Seattle-headquartered firm. The plaintiffs contend that Starbucks’s naming and marketing of sugar-free products is “false, deceptive, and unlawful” and that the company violated federal labeling regulations. Seattle-based Starbucks said the sugar in its protein drinks comes from the protein-boosted milk it uses. The company said it doesn’t add sugar to the drinks and it uses sugar-free syrup for flavoring. On Starbucks’ website Monday, the drinks were marketed as “sugar-free,” but the company also clearly stated the amount of sugar in each beverage and that they were made without added sugar. “We believe these claims have no merit,” a Starbucks spokesperson said Monday. “Starbucks has consistently and clearly provided information about its protein beverages, sugar-free options, customization choices, and nutritional content across product announcements, menus, marketing materials, Starbucks.com, and the Starbucks app, and we intend to vigorously defend ourselves in this matter.”

— ASSOCIATED PRESS

STREAMING

EMMYS LEAVE THEIR BROADCAST HOME FOR AMAZON



The biggest showcase for the television industry is leaving broadcast television. Amazon Prime Video won the distribution rights to the Emmy Awards, the Television Academy announced Tuesday, putting the industry’s signature event exclusively on a streaming service. The Emmys telecast, which rotated among the four broadcast networks for decades, will start streaming on Amazon in September 2027 as part of a six-year deal. The Emmys will stream for free and not require a Prime Video subscription, the academy said. Amazon will also make the event available all over the world. It’s the second major awards show that will soon be available only over the internet. In 2029, the Oscars will leave their longtime home, ABC, and head over to YouTube. The Emmys’ move to streaming is, of course, symbolic of broader trends in the industry. In July, 49 percent of all television viewing in the United States was on a streaming service, according to Nielsen, dwarfing broadcast’s 19.5 percent. Cris Abrego, the chair of the Television Academy, acknowledged in an interview that the Emmys’s move off broadcast for the first time since their inception in 1949 was “a pretty big step.” “Obviously, television in itself is evolving in real time,” he continued. “But I actually think the distinction between broadcast and streaming is becoming less meaningful every year. Most of our longtime broadcast partners themselves are part of companies with major streaming platforms.” For the last three decades, the Emmys telecast alternated among ABC, CBS, Fox, and NBC. Twenty years ago, the ceremony drew 16 million viewers. A decade ago it was 11 million. This year, the Emmys had lower viewership (6.8 million viewers on NBC) than the Oscars on ABC (17.9 million), and the Grammys on CBS (14.4 million). Even the Video Music Awards, which appeared on CBS and MTV last month, had more viewers (9 million). Emmy voters’ taste has drifted decidedly away from network television as well. During the primetime ceremony last month, 18 of the 19 awards handed out went to a streaming or cable program. CBS claimed the only win for broadcast, and that was for a show (“The Late Show With Stephen Colbert”) no longer on the air because the network canceled it. Mike Hopkins, the head of Prime Video, said in an interview that he believed Amazon could help “energize it and age the audience down and grow it over time.” Abrego said having one outlet dedicated to the Emmys would only help. In recent years, the four broadcast networks collectively paid the academy roughly \$9.5 million for the annual rights, according to public filings. Abrego would not disclose how much Amazon was paying but said the amount was a “meaningful investment across the board.” The Emmys will proceed normally next year with its usual September date, but Abrego suggested that could change in future years.

— NEW YORK TIMES

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SOPHIE PARK/NEW YORK TIMES

The Department of Education extended its deadline through the end of the year to enroll in autopay for more savings.

Students have more time to reduce their loan interest rate

By **Adriana Morga**
ASSOCIATED PRESS

NEW YORK — Student loan borrowers now have until the end of 2026 to enroll in autopay and have their interest rate reduced by 1 percent.

The original deadline was Sept. 30, but the US Department of Education extended it to give borrowers more time to enroll. The rate reduction will last through June 2028.

Borrowers who currently use autopay already receive an interest-rate discount of 0.25 percent, so the new reduction takes off just 0.75 percent.

This temporary benefit is meant to support borrowers, along with those who are returning to repayment, and ensure they can stay on top of the new Repayment Assistance Plan that requires on-time payments, according to the Education Department.

The interest reduction can benefit borrowers who have large balances and are on fixed payments, said Lesley J. Turner, associate professor of public policy at the University of Chicago.

“For a limited time, borrowers are now able to get a full percentage point reduction in their interest rate if they sign up for autopay,” Turner said. “So this is a quadrupling of the earlier benefit. It’s a pretty big benefit, especially for borrowers who have large balances.”

Since the interest reduction was announced this summer, nearly 2 million borrowers have enrolled in autopay.

Around 9 million Americans are in default on their federal student loans as of June, according to the Education Department. Hundreds of thousands more are behind on loan payments and at risk of default this year.

If you’re looking to enroll your student loans in autopay, here’s what you need to know:

If you’re new to autopay, enroll by the end of the year

In order to get the 1 percent interest reduction, you must enroll in autopay by Dec. 31.

First, log in to your student loan servicer account and select autopay. You’ll need to enter

your bank information to automatically withdraw the monthly payment from your checking or savings account.

Even without the rate reduction, autopay is a good way to stay on top of your student loans, Turner said.

“We all know life gets busy and if you have to log in every month and manually make your payment there may be a chance that you forget and then you end up having your loans go delinquent,” she said.

If you’re already enrolled, you already have the reduction

Borrowers who were enrolled in autopay before the announcement in July have had their interest rate automatically reduced by 1 percent, according to the Education Department.

If you’re currently in default, consolidate your loans

If your student loans are in default, you must log in to studentaid.gov and consolidate your eligible loans in order to sign up for autopay.

Involuntary collections on federal student loans remain on hold. The Trump administration announced earlier this year that it is delaying plans to withhold pay from student loan borrowers who default on their payments. Borrowers are considered in default when they are at least 270 days behind on payments.

The online application for loan consolidation is available at studentaid.gov/loan-consolidation. If you have multiple federal student loans, you can combine them into a single loan with a fixed interest rate and a single monthly payment. The consolidation process typically takes around 60 days to complete. You can only consolidate your loans once.

If your student loans are in default, you can also contact your loan holder to apply for a loan rehabilitation program. Through this program, borrowers are enrolled in a reduced payment plan and, after five successful payments, wage garnishment ends.

HubSpot to lay off over 600 employees

► **LAYOFFS**
Continued from Page B7

ployees there were before the cuts. The company had 8,882 full-time workers at the end of 2025, with 5,724 in the Americas, according to HubSpot’s latest annual report filed with the Securities and Exchange Commission.

HubSpot’s stock ticked down about 1.6 percent in Tuesday trading, closing at \$217.09 a share. That’s down about 46 percent year to date.

In a Tuesday filing with the SEC, HubSpot said it expected to incur about \$65 million to \$75 million in costs related to the restructuring and anticipates the job cuts will be “substantially

complete by the end of the first quarter of fiscal year 2027.”

Rangan said in her note that affected employees would receive at least 20 weeks of base pay as severance, the ability to keep their HubSpot laptops, and help navigating the job search, among other transition assistance.

HubSpot reported \$911.7 million in total revenue for the second quarter of 2026, up about 20 percent from the same period a year earlier. The firm also forecast total revenue for 2026 to be around \$3.7 billion, up about 18 percent from 2025.

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Ice cream shop rips rude patrons

In viral post, defends young staff members

By Travis Andersen
GLOBE STAFF

The owners of a Blackstone ice cream shop say their good humor is melting away, telling customers via social media to quit yelling at young employees.

In a Sunday Facebook post that has since gone viral, Coldstuff Ice Cream even invoked the almighty as it urged patrons to chill out.

“I swear to God,” the post read. “STOP YELLING AT MY [EXPLETIVE] EMPLOYEES. They are children. This job, for most of them is their first. They are going to make mistakes. They aren’t in charge of anything. This can all be fixed with a smile and a polite attitude. It’s ice cream for crying out loud. Grow up and act your age.”

Coldstuff Ice Cream, located on Main Street in the Worcester County town, was incorporated in Massachusetts in June, according to state records.

Kevin Miller, who owns the ice cream parlor with his brother, David Forgit, said the angry episodes are regular occurrences.

“It happens two or three times a day, it’s mind-blowing to me,” said Miller, 38. He said the incident that prompted the post involved a wom-

an who “lost it” after her order came out to 15 cents more than it should have due to a mix-up.

“Lost it on a 16-year-old child, someone who still needs time off from work for school sports,” Miller said. “It’s shocking how many people it happens to.”

The Facebook post clearly struck a chord, earning more than 232,000 likes as of Tuesday afternoon and generating more than 18,000 comments, many of them supportive of the business and its besieged team of employees.

“And NOBODY gives a [expletive] if you don’t come back,” Coldstuff said in the comment thread of the initial post. “We’d prefer it that way.”

A bit later in the thread, however, the business seemed to extend an olive branch to one group of customers: boomers.

“This post wasn’t intended to bash boomers and i didn’t intended [sic] to lump everyone together,” the business wrote. “The vast majority of the elderly folks we encounter are fabulous. And i meant no [ill] intent towards the age group as a whole. You know who you are, and you know who we are.

“But seriously,” the post continued, “let’s check ourselves around working [kids]. It’s one group who feels border line aggressive when something is wrong. It’s a mistake not an insult. There’s no need. It’s ice cream.”

Hundreds of people have left comments supporting Coldstuff and recounting their own rough experiences working in customer service.

“I was 15 working at McDonald’s,” one woman replied in the comments. “My first day at my first ever job. I rang a lady up for a sausage egg biscuit instead of a sausage biscuit. She berated me so bad I cried. I still think about her 18 years later. The manager refunded the difference. It was \$1.”

One man suggested the formative experiences of a first job can shape a young person for life, as he gave the shop’s owners props for standing up for their crew.

“To whom it may concern: I wish I had a boss that had my back when I was a screw up of a teenager at my first job,” the man wrote. “I wish they would have given me the respect I so badly wanted. i (maybe) wouldn’t be the angry short tempered [expletive] I am today.”

Later Tuesday morning, Forgit posted a video clip to the business’s Facebook page, letting visitors know that his family also owns Goodstuff Smokehouse and Brewery across the way from the scoop spot.

“This ice cream stand kind of fell in our lap,” Forgit said. “We opened Aug. 1, and we’re still kind of feeling it out here. We’ve got an amazing staff of just wonderful, wonderful young people here.”

He thanked the public for supporting Coldstuff amid the social media drizzle.

“I don’t think anybody could have thought it would go this crazy,” he said.

It’s not the first time a Massachusetts ice cream shop has taken to social media to shame rude customers.

In May 2020, at the height of pandemic-era social distancing requirements, Polar Cave Ice Cream Parlour in Mashpee posted “STOP ORDERING” on Facebook and unplugged the phone after dealing with a tide of testy customers spewing profanity at staff and overwhelming the small team.

Restaurants and diners have seen such drama unfold as well.

In June 2021, Apt Cape Cod, a farm-to-table operation in Brewster, closed for part of a day to give workers a “day of kindness,” after a man berated an employee for telling him they couldn’t take his breakfast order because the restaurant hadn’t opened yet. It was the latest in a series of indignities that had left some workers in tears, the New York Times reported at the time.

Then came a Boston brouhaha in August 2021, when staff at Mike’s City Diner in the South End enlisted police to deal with two separate disorderly customer incidents within an hour of each other.

Meanwhile at Coldstuff, the



DARIO LOPEZ-MILLS/ASSOCIATED PRESS

scoops will apparently endure into the winter — cooler temperatures and the occasional frosty patron notwithstanding.

“We’re going until the calendar ends folks,” Coldstuff said in a Facebook post on Sunday afternoon, hours before the scolding post about rude customers went viral. “We got walls on the tent to keep those fall winds in check. Do you have a different favorite in the winter? Let us know in the comments.”

In his phone interview Tuesday, Miller said his family hasn’t had similar customer issues at the smokehouse, where the staff tends to be older with more experience.

“You hear all the horror stories: ‘These kids don’t want to work anymore,’” Miller said. “Considering what they’re up against, it’s mind-blowing to me that anybody wants to get up and go to work.”

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Coldstuff Ice Cream, on Main Street in Blackstone, was incorporated in Massachusetts in June.

‘STOP YELLING AT MY [EXPLETIVE] EMPLOYEES. They are children.’

COLDSTUFF ICE CREAM

Trump’s tariffs doing little to help trade deficit

Hits a 17-month high as it grew to \$105.6b in August

By Ana Swanson
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — After 20 months in office and with the mid-term elections approaching, President Trump is at pains to demonstrate his administration’s economic wins. But one metric he has identified as an important measuring stick for his policies has been moving steadily in the wrong direction.

The US trade deficit — a measure of the difference between what the country imports and what it exports — rose sharply in August to hit a 17-month high, after also rising significantly in July, data from the Commerce Department showed Tuesday.

The trade deficit grew to \$105.6 billion in August, a 13.7 percent increase from July, driven by an increase in imports of petroleum, gold, and chips used for artificial intelligence. It was the largest monthly total since before Trump imposed his global tariffs in April 2025, and larger than any monthly trade deficit in the last year of the Biden administration.

The widening trade deficit stemmed from rising imports, which outpaced the growth in exports. US imports hit a record \$420.8 billion in August, climbing 4.3 percent from July. Exports grew 1.4 percent compared with July, hitting \$315.2 billion.

Christopher Rupkey, chief economist at FWDONDS, said there was simply “no good alternative” to foreign imports. The cost of American labor was simply too high to produce goods cheap enough for many Americans to consider purchasing, he said, and even if manufacturers were willing, factories could not be built fast enough.

“Despite the administration’s economic policies which have jacked up the tariff-related costs of many imported goods, America is just as dependent as ever on foreign-produced goods,” he said.

The trade deficit has tended to



KENA BETANCUR/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

The Trump administration has viewed the trade deficit as a sign US manufacturing is weak.

increase over time as the US economy grows. But the Trump administration has viewed the metric as a sign of weakness in America’s manufacturing sector. Officials have tried to reduce the trade deficit by imposing hefty tariffs on everything from toys and steel to drones and auto parts made outside the United States.

The lack of success in lowering the trade deficit is clearly partly a result of the AI boom. To construct new data centers, companies are importing far more computer chips, most of which are made in Asia. The United States imported more than \$90 billion worth of semiconductors in the first eight months of this year, the data showed, almost double the amount in the same period last year.

There’s also a bigger economic question about how much tariffs by themselves can reduce the trade deficit, particularly at a time when the US economy is expanding, government deficits are growing, and consumers are continuing to spend on foreign goods.

Some economists agree that the trade deficit is a worrying sign of imbalances in global manufacturing.

But many argue that tariffs are not a great tool for reducing it. Some believe that much of the US trade deficit is fueled by fiscal deficits, and that Trump’s tax cuts and spending on the war in Iran will increase it.

Others argue that tariffs do discourage people from buying foreign goods, but by adding costs that have proved unpopular with American households.

Trump officials have blamed the disruptions to their tariff plan for the increase in the trade deficit. The Supreme Court struck down many of Trump’s tariffs in February, saying he had misused an emergency law to impose them. Since then, the administration has put a lower tariff of 10 percent to 12.5 percent in effect on many products.

Officials are still working to recreate a scheme of higher tariffs, and could issue new levies in the coming weeks and months. In July, the administration put a new round of tariffs on more than 80 countries, and it is planning to impose another round of tariffs that could apply to more than 40 countries.

Since Trump came into office for a second time, the average monthly

trade deficit has been \$74.5 billion. That’s just slightly above the monthly average for the last year of the Biden presidency, at \$73.8 billion.

But drastic changes in tariff policy have caused monthly trade deficits to jump around during the president’s second term, spiking and plummeting as new tariffs have been introduced, removed, and replaced.

After Trump was elected, importers raced to bring in more inventory ahead of tariffs, causing the trade deficit to soar to new levels in the first few months of Trump’s term. Then, after the president introduced global tariffs on his so-called Liberation Day last year, imports and the trade deficit fell back.

Grace Zwemmer, US economist at Oxford Economics, said in a note Tuesday that the trade figures were “on track to pose a sizable drag” on economic growth numbers in the third quarter.

Imports would remain solid in the near-term because of AI demand and the need for other businesses to restock their inventories, while US oil exports would not do as much to lower the trade deficit as in the second quarter, she said.

Senators press insurers over claims closed with no payout

By Shawna Kwan
BLOOMBERG

US Senators Elizabeth Warren and Josh Hawley are questioning six insurers, including State Farm Mutual Automobile Insurance Co. and Allstate Corp., over concerns about a growing number of claims that are closed without payment to policyholders.

Warren, Democrat of Massachusetts, and Hawley, Republican of Missouri, wrote to State Farm, Allstate, USAA Capital Corp., Farmers Insurance Group, Liberty Mutual Insurance Co., and American Family Mutual Insurance Co. on Friday, raising concerns about an increasing share of homeowner and auto to insurance claims being closed without payment. The senators asked for figures on unsuccessful claims for homeowners and personal auto insurance, the factors affecting those claims, and any material change to claims-handling policies.

“The growing share of both homeowners and auto insurance claims resulting in no payment raises serious questions about whether consumers can trust their insurance companies to hold up their end of the bargain when disasters or emergencies occur and affect their most basic essentials: their home and car,” Warren, ranking member of the Senate Banking Committee, and Hawley wrote in the letters.

Meanwhile, record profits of insurance companies lead to concerns about “whether increasingly aggressive claims-handling practices, including tactics to delay payments, are contributing to higher margins,” they added.

State Farm said in a statement that each claim is evaluated by the firm based on the “facts and the coverage purchased, and when a loss is covered.” The firm added that claims can close without a payment for several reasons, including when the amount is below the customer’s deductible or if the customer withdraws the claim.

The rising cost of homeowners insurance, coupled with the lower likelihood of payouts, is causing some homeowners to opt out of insurance entirely, the senators said.



Warren



Hawley

Towns eye former barracks at Devens as possible housing solution

►CHESTO
Continued from Page B7

for nearly 500 apartments on Friday, or Trinity Financial’s plan to finally launch on a similar complex at the old Medfield State Hospital, hopefully later this year.

Last month, the Healey administration put out a call for developers interested in building several hundred units at a former reform school in Lancaster. That followed the decision to work with Concord officials to reimagine the foreboding, shuttered prison that butts up against Route 2 as a new neighborhood.

Perhaps nowhere on state-controlled land is there more potential for new housing than at Devens.

Thirty years after the Army base closed, Devens is now a booming indus-

trial park with nearly 100 employers, ranging from drugmaker Bristol Myers Squibb to metals manufacturer VulcanForms, collectively drawing more than 7,500 workers.

Getting housing built in Devens has been a much trickier proposition. Until the Legislature interceded in 2024, a strict cap in state law essentially kept development at fewer than 300 units. Now that the cap has been lifted, MassDevelopment is seeking developers for the remaining residential land. It just designated Metro West Collaborative Development to build on a 6.6-acre parcel, though it still hasn’t awarded the bigger prize: rights for 63 acres along Grant Road.

More potential awaits in the “innovation district” area of Devens that in-

cludes Vicksburg Square, if MassDevelopment can finally succeed with a rezoning. To pull it off, a majority of voters in each of the three base towns of Shirley, Ayer, and Harvard need to approve at simultaneous town meetings — the so-called super town meeting. In 2012, Shirley went along with a plan by Trinity Financial to convert Vicksburg into apartments, while Harvard and Ayer voters did not.

To streamline this quirky system, Governor Maura Healey included language in her newest economic development bill that would have combined these votes into one town meeting, to be held at Devens, and open to all three towns’ voters. That didn’t go over well with the towns, so state lawmakers kept this provision out of more recent ver-

sions of that legislation — a controversy that’s now apparently in the rearview.

SusanMary Redinger, Harvard’s Select Board chair, says officials in her town are encouraged by MassDevelopment’s reengagement on Vicksburg, as well as broader jurisdictional questions around Devens that need to be answered in the coming years. Redinger says Sweeney and Navjeet Bal, MassDevelopment’s chief executive, have shown they want to work collaboratively with the towns to resolve both of these hot-button issues.

Likewise, state Senator Jamie Eldridge, whose district includes much of Devens, says he’s cautiously optimistic that Vicksburg can be reborn now that MassDevelopment under Bal’s leadership is reestablishing good relation-

ships with the communities. But he is not sure if enough state and federal funds can be found to remediate the old Army barracks, given that \$44 million price tag.

Now, it’s up to MassDevelopment to craft zoning changes that are palatable to all three communities and also allow for enough development to make home construction in and around Vicksburg financially feasible.

It will take far more than a fun field trip to pull that off. However, as Redinger put it after returning home, the Vicksburg visit was a good start to what will be a long process.

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TV HIGHLIGHTS

MLB playoffs: Guardians-White Sox, 4 p.m., TBS
MLB playoffs: Dodgers-Braves, 6 p.m., FS1
WNBA playoffs: Liberty-Dream, 7:30 p.m., ESPN
MLB playoffs: Rays-Yankees, 8 p.m., TBS
WNBA playoffs: Aces-Valkyries, 9:30 p.m., NBCSN
Listings, C6

Sports

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THE BOSTON GLOBE WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 7, 2026 | BOSTONGLOBE.COM/SPORTS

CHRISTOPHER L. GASPER

Breslow yet to prove anything

Offseason starts with Duquette-esque talk



We'll always have 27-3 . . . That should be the epitaph for the 2026 Red Sox, who held their season sign-off news conference at reliably available in October Fenway Park on Monday.

Here's the state of the Red Sox after another blink-and-you-missed-it post-season cameo that ended with Boston getting obliterated, 18-2, by the Yankees in the best-of-three American League Wild Card Series: The team's best starting pitcher, Sonny Gray, isn't granted enough leeway. The chief baseball officer, Craig Breslow, receives unlimited latitude and gratitude, even though he hasn't delivered yet on any of the stated goals of the Sox during his three-season tenure: a deep playoff run, earnestly contending for the AL East title, and winning 90-plus games.

Rarely have baseball bosses been afforded so much credit for underdelivering on performance pledges. Breslow boasts more option years picked up on his contract (two, 2029 and '30) than playoff series wins (zero) as Sox CBO. Yet, he's a home run hire in the eyes of ownership, the Golden Child. Bres has constructed playoff teams each of the last two seasons. But Breslow is the Roman Anthony of baseball executives. He possesses enviable potential and promise and has displayed flashes of brilliance on the job. But he hasn't proven it yet.

Breslow's Sox remain stuck in a liminal state between playoff field seat-filler and genuine World Series contention. They've finished third in the AL East all three years of the Breslow era. Like the postseason, they've failed to advance.

Breslow sounded downright Dan Duquette-esque ("More days in first place. . .) while attempting to ambivalently own another abbreviated post-season. He utters all the appropriate

GASPER, Page C4



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Willson Contreras (27 HRs, 81 RBIs, .516 slugging percentage) was solid in the middle of the lineup, but the Red Sox slipped in key power categories.

HIT THE SWITCH

After not adding enough power to lineup last offseason, Sox' numbers declined in 2026

By Alex Speier
GLOBE STAFF

Craig Breslow surveyed the playoff field and reached an obvious conclusion about a path for improving the Red Sox.

"It would be fair to look at some of those other teams to say that they hit the ball out of the park a little bit more than we do," said the Sox' chief baseball officer. "It doesn't really matter how you score, but in the postseason, a lot of runs come via the home run because the pitching is so dominant. So I think that's a consideration."

The assessment certainly would have been appropriate at the Red Sox'

end-of-season news conference at Fenway Park on Monday, five days after the team got bounced from the playoffs in two games by the Yankees while managing a total of two runs. But Breslow's observation was actually offered one year earlier, in the days after the Sox were knocked out of the 2025 Wild Card Series by the Yankees.

Despite identifying power as a priority entering last offseason, the Red Sox' lineup took a step backward. In 2025, the Sox hit 186 homers (15th in MLB), had a .324 on-base percentage (eighth), and a .421 slugging percentage (ninth). This year, the Red Sox hit 163 homers (26th), had a .319 OBP (12th), and

slugged .398 (20th).

Caveats are in order. The loss of Trevor Story and Roman Anthony for the majority of the year removed two batters capable of driving the ball out of the park. One of the players brought in to offset their absences, Curtis Mead, made just two plate appearances following a July trade with the Nationals before suffering a broken wrist when getting hit by a pitch.

Even with those losses, the Sox' power deficiency was subject to exaggeration. Fenway Park played as a graveyard for power for much of the year. On the road, the Sox hit 87 homers — tied for 21st in the big leagues and well ahead

of the bottom-ranked team in that category, the best-in-baseball Brewers (63). From July 1, the Sox ranked roughly in the middle of the pack in slugging and homers per game.

Still, the Sox didn't have the depth of power to reliably outslug opponents — especially against playoff-caliber power pitching. They went deep just 26 times against 95-plus-mile-per-hour pitches, tied for fourth fewest in the big leagues.

On Monday, Breslow — while identifying strengths in the rotation and bullpen, as well as infield and outfield defense — didn't pretend otherwise.

"Our offense was inconsistent,"
RED SOX, Page C4

Maye, Chism on the rise after Patriots' upset of the Bills

By Nicole Yang
GLOBE STAFF

FOXBOROUGH — After the Patriots left Buffalo with a potentially season-saving win, let's take a look at who's up, who's down, and whom to watch against the Raiders in Week 5 . . .

Three up

Quarterback Drake Maye: The performance wasn't perfect, but Maye undoubtedly took a huge step forward Sunday. He threw for three touchdowns, including the winner in the final minutes. The audible exhale Maye let out in his postgame news conference was telling, as he called the game "relieving." Given how much Maye struggled through the first three weeks, his bounceback in a hostile road envi-



NFL WEEK 5
RAIDERS AT PATRIOTS
Sunday, 1 p.m., CBS

►Refs flag NFL for suspensions. C3
►Eagles veteran Johnson retires. C3

ronment was impressive and much-needed. He still turned the ball over twice, on a fumble that exhibited poor decision-making and on an unlucky interception, but Maye did not let the mistakes snowball.

Wide receiver Efton Chism: Chism's one-handed touchdown grab was, in the words of Romeo Doubs, the "snag

of the year." Chism's teammates and coaches piled on the praise after the game, applauding him for his work ethic. Chism encapsulated the "next man up" mentality. After being inactive in Week 1, he played 10 snaps in Week 2, 16 in Week 3, and 34 on Sunday. Not only did he catch the winning touchdown pass, he also hauled in a crucial 19-yard reception earlier on that drive. He's made the most of his limited reps. Coach Mike Vrabel indicated Monday that it's possible Chism's role grows moving forward.

Linebacker Robert Spillane: Spillane didn't miss a snap and was all over the field Sunday. With the Bills driving at the end of the first half, he helped punch the ball free from Khalil Shakir to force a fumble in Patriots territory.

Spillane finished with a team-high seven tackles and also managed to log a pressure against Josh Allen. He played an important role in containing tight end Dalton Kincaid, too, with Vrabel highlighting his awareness.

Three down

Cornerback Charles Woods: With star cornerback Christian Gonzalez (shoulder) out, Woods earned significant run on the boundary opposite Carlton Davis. The results weren't all that encouraging. Woods missed a tackle when D.J. Moore hurdled over him for a first down in the first quarter. He had another miscue in the second on Shakir's 50-yard catch-and-run play. Then, in the fourth quarter, he was in coverage on Keon Coleman's go-ahead touch-

down. Woods tied with the Colts' Sauce Gardner for the highest passer rating (158.3) allowed by a cornerback in Week 4, according to Pro Football Focus. The Patriots managed to weather Gonzalez's absence, but they shouldn't feel confident about how Woods played.

Left tackle Will Campbell: Sunday was the first dud for Campbell, who was off to a strong start. Campbell allowed a team-high six pressures, including a quarterback hit, according to PFF. He also committed two penalties, a costly hold on third down and a false start. Bills edge rushers Greg Rousseau and Bradley Chubb certainly got the better of Campbell on multiple occasions. It will be worth watching how
PATRIOTS, Page C3

Rush of flag football reaches Roxbury CC

Commitment to new Olympic sport leads to state's first varsity program

By Avery Hill
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

In the World Games 2025, women's flag football was the most-watched discipline with 64,043 live views. In May, the NCAA Committee on Access, Opportunity, and Impact recommended Division 1, 2, and 3 programs add a flag championship by spring 2028.

In June, the National Junior College Athletic Association elevated the women's sport to championship status starting in the 2027-28 academic year. Flag football is an Olympic sport for

the first time in 2028.

The message is clear: Women's flag football is on the rise. Locally, Roxbury Community College became the first varsity women's program in Massachusetts and one of the only ones in the region.

"Everything that we do, from academics to athletics, is oriented around opening doors for our students, who may not otherwise have those," RCC president Jonathan Jefferson said. "And women's flag football is another expression of that commitment."

FLAG FOOTBALL, Page C5



COURTESY OF NATHAN GOMEZ

Flag football caught on at Roxbury Community College and will be a NJCAA championship sport next year.

Celtics to push stars to limit, not beyond

By Gary Washburn
GLOBE STAFF

CHARLESTON, S.C. — Joe Mazzulla must acknowledge a balance when it comes to playing time and workload for several of his primary players.

While the Celtics are comfortable with their roster, which includes newcomers Paul George and Mitchell Robinson along with Jayson Tatum, who is approaching 100 percent after missing the first 62 games last season with a ruptured Achilles, all three will require monitoring of games logged and minutes played.

George is 36 and was limited to 78 games the past two years in Philadelphia due to injuries,

tanking and a 25-game suspension. Robinson has battled injuries most of the past four seasons and has played 70-plus games just once in his career.

Of course, Mazzulla's passion and philosophy motivate him to challenge his players to push their limits, to overcome fatigue and complacency to reach unprecedented heights.

But modern NBA medical technology research has encouraged teams to ration playing time and games played. The days of players logging 82-game seasons are becoming as rare as complete games in baseball. It's a load management generation and Mazzulla has to accept that
CELTICS, Page C5



DAMIEN EAGERS/PA VIA AP

US captain Jim Furyk (left) and European counterpart Luke Donald met up in Ireland.

RYDER CUP

Furyk would welcome Reed on US squad

By Doug Ferguson
ASSOCIATED PRESS

US captain Jim Furyk said Tuesday it would be “great” if Patrick Reed were among the 12 best Americans for the Ryder Cup next year in Ireland, even though Reed criticized Furyk’s first captaincy after the 2018 loss in Paris.

Reed hasn’t been on a Ryder Cup team since those 2018 matches, another debacle for the US team that ended with Reed telling The New York Times he should have been partners with Jordan Spieth and Furyk should not have benched him twice that week.

Reed, among the first to defect to LIV Golf in 2022, chose not to renew his LIV contract this year and leads the European tour points list, assuring him a return to the PGA Tour next year.

“We are going to put the best 12 guys, the best team of 12, on this team,” Furyk said from Adare Manor during a news conference with European captain Luke Donald to mark the matches being one year away. “If Patrick Reed is one of those, that’s great. It’s been a long time since he’s been in our team room.”

Steve Stricker left Reed off the team for the 2021 Ryder Cup the Americans won at Whistling Straits. He was not seriously considered for the Rome matches in 2023 or the Bethpage Black matches in 2025, even though he had top-5 finishes at the Masters both those years.

Furyk already has changed US qualifying for Adare Manor so that no one begins earning points until the 2027 season.

Reed, who is No. 29 in the world ranking as he closes out his European tour schedule, could be eligible for signature events if he’s in the top 30 at the time of those events.

His last time in the US team room was at Royal Melbourne in 2019 for the Presidents Cup, where he was heckled by the Australian gallery a week after he was penalized in the Bahamas for improving his lie in a sandy waste area.

Six players qualify and Furyk will have six captain’s picks for the Sept. 17-19 matches.

“Patrick and I will have that conversation,” Furyk said. “And I’m looking forward to welcoming our best team of 12.”

Furyk’s more immediate concern was finding a solution for the recent trend of abysmal US play in foursomes. The Americans have been outgained 26-8 in foursomes in the last two Ryder Cups and Presidents Cups. The deficit is 13-3 to Europe in the Ryder Cup.

They have been blanked in three sessions — the opening session at Marco Simone in 2023, and each of the last two times in the Presidents Cup.

“I know those numbers very, very well. I’ve lived them the last four,” Furyk said. “It’s not an anomaly. There’s some issues — we understand that. I plan on making some changes.

“And I promise you, we will be prepared,” he said. “I’m going to ask this team to do more than any other United States team has in the past. We’ll be prepared. We’ll be ready to go in that format, and hopefully we can showcase our talent. We have too much depth to have that poor record in alternate shot.”

Furyk said he will ask prospective players to go to Adare Manor next summer around the two-week stretch of the Scottish Open and British Open.

He was in a tough spot as 2018 captain for the Ryder Cup at Le Golf National. The course was set up tight with deep rough.

Some players suited for the course were not in great form. Tiger Woods had just won the Tour Championship and Bryson DeChambeau won two playoff events. They combined to go 0-7-0 for the week.

Bruins’ top guns miss their mark

By Kevin Paul Dupont
GLOBE STAFF

Less than a week after opening their new season with a sound shutout win on home ice, the Bruins returned to the Garden on Monday night with a parade — an unremitting display of poor play, weak effort, and all-around boobos in which they gift-wrapped the visiting Senators a 4-1 victory.

Leading the parade of Black and Gold horrors: a power play, or an alleged power play, that led to a pair of Tim Stützle goals in the first period. The first Stützle strike was shorthanded. The second came seconds after the power play expired, but it was generated off a two-on-one break while the Bruins were on the power play.

Senators up, 2-0, on five shots, and the night was young.

By the 5:19 mark of the second period — after Michael Amadio bumped the Senators’ lead to 4-0 — Bruins coach Marco Sturm called a 30-second timeout and addressed his bedraggled, drained charges as the hometown crowd (announced attendance: 17,850) sat there nearly as stupefied as the players on the Boston bench.

“Try to go back to the basics,” said Sturm, asked what he had to say during the timeout — what was clearly, and deservedly, an animated one-way conversation. “We touched on it between periods, and then we go out and pretty much play the same style again.”

Sturm’s “guess,” he said, “was that they didn’t hear it clear enough.”

So much of hockey, one member of the media pack noted to Sturm, is effort, emotion, and execution. Was he happy with any of it?

Senators 4, Bruins 1

Monday night game
At TD Garden, Boston

FIRST PERIOD

Penalty — Ottawa, Foegele (interference) 7:19
Ottawa 1 Boston 0 — Stuetzle 1 (Amadio) 7:39
Ottawa 2 Boston 0 — Stuetzle 2 9:22
Penalty — Ottawa, Hodgson (hooking) 13:33
Penalty — Boston, Hagens (slashing) 15:15
Penalty — Boston, Poitras (tripping) 15:22

SECOND PERIOD

Ottawa 3 Boston 0 — Batherson 1 (Stuetzle) 1:06
Ottawa 4 Boston 0 — Amadio 2 (Pinto, Cousins) 5:19

THIRD PERIOD

Ottawa 4 Boston 1 — Hagens 2 3:30
Penalty — Ottawa, Cousins (misconduct) 19:56
Penalty — Boston, Zadorov (misconduct) 19:56
Penalty — Boston, Zadorov (interference) 19:56
Penalty — Boston, Jeannot (misconduct) 19:56

SCORE BY PERIOD

Ottawa 2 2 0 — 4
Boston 0 0 1 — 1

SHOTS BY PERIOD

Ottawa 7 6 11 — 24
Boston 5 9 9 — 19

Power plays — Ottawa 0 of 4; Boston 0 of 4.

Goalies — Ottawa, Ersson 0-0-0 (9 shots-8 saves), Boston, Ullmark 2-0-0 (10 shots-10 saves), Boston, Swayman 2-1-0 (24 shots-20 saves).

Referees — Corey Sykes, Frederick L'Ecuyer. Linesmen — Kilian McKelvie, Tyson

Attendance — 17,850 (17,565). Time — 2:35.



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

Jeremy Swayman, who posted a shutout in the opener, made 20 saves in a loss vs. Ottawa.

shut out since.

Other observations following one of the more listless home efforts in recent memory:

Sway comes up short: Jeremy Swayman faced only 24 shots. While the loss cannot be pinned on him, he is the No. 1 goalie and he did not make big stops when needed, particularly in the early going.

Stützle scored those first two goals on two-on-one break-ins. Had he snuffed out one — particularly on No. 2, initially muffed by Stützle — the night could have been far different.

Geekie is off to another slow start: They need him to score, which the track record shows he can do in bunches. He entered the night with zero goals and only two shots on net through three games. He landed three on net Monday, but he needs to deliver more.

Inside ice is still an issue: In the first two games, it looked like the

ongoing bugaboo of the past few seasons might have been addressed. The Bruins did a better job of getting to prime shooting spots. Not so Saturday in Minnesota, and not so Monday, as well.

To his credit, Geekie stormed in on a breakaway at 4:46 of the first, the game scoreless, and sizzled in a 29-foot wrister. It clanged off the post and out. They needed him to bury it.

Too slow to summon emotion: Sturm shares in this, too. He waited until the score was 4-0 before calling the timeout. He should have called it after the sleepwalking power play led to the 2-0 Ottawa lead.

It wasn’t until Sturm turned his lines inside out and upside down late in the second period that the roster showed some spark. Big hitter Nikita Zadorov combined for four hits in back-to-back shifts. On a night when they totaled only 19 shots on net, the Bruins needed to summon some nasty much earlier.

“I think we’ve just got to get back to our identity,” said Zadorov, who also noted there remain 80 games to go. “I think our identity is to play real good defense, structured hockey. We’re not an offensive team. We’re not a skilled team. We’ve been talking about this for two years.”

It’s a mistake, noted Zadorov, to look to make plays “through five sticks.”

“We’re a simple team,” he said. “We’re going to get pucks deep, get on the forecheck, and wear teams down, and we’ll get our opportunities.”

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NHL

EASTERN CONFERENCE

ATLANTIC	GP	W	L	OL	Pts.	ROW	GF	GA
Ottawa	3	2	1	0	4	2	10	8
Tampa Bay	3	2	1	0	4	2	8	7
Buffalo	3	2	1	0	4	2	10	11
*Florida	3	1	0	2	4	1	6	7
Toronto	4	2	2	0	4	2	11	11
Boston	4	2	2	0	4	2	9	11
Montreal	3	1	1	1	3	1	12	14
Detroit	3	1	2	0	2	1	7	8

METROPOLITAN	GP	W	L	OL	Pts.	ROW	GF	GA
NY Rangers	5	4	1	0	8	4	16	8
Carolina	4	2	1	1	5	2	11	12
Pittsburgh	3	2	1	0	4	2	15	8
Washington	2	1	1	0	2	1	6	5
Columbus	2	1	1	0	2	1	7	7
NY Islanders	3	1	2	0	2	1	9	7
New Jersey	3	1	2	0	2	1	6	13
Philadelphia	4	0	2	2	2	0	5	17

WESTERN CONFERENCE

CENTRAL	GP	W	L	OL	Pts.	ROW	GF	GA
Utah	4	3	1	0	6	3	17	8
Minnesota	3	2	0	1	5	2	9	5
Winnipeg	3	2	0	1	5	2	9	8
Colorado	2	2	0	0	4	2	14	5
Nashville	3	1	1	1	3	1	7	9
Dallas	3	1	2	0	2	1	6	6
St. Louis	3	1	2	0	2	1	7	10
Chicago	4	1	3	0	2	1	9	17

PACIFIC	GP	W	L	OL	Pts.	ROW	GF	GA
Edmonton	3	2	0	1	5	2	17	14
Anaheim	2	2	0	0	4	2	7	5
*Seattle	3	2	1	0	4	2	13	5
*Vegas	3	2	1	0	4	2	11	8
San Jose	3	2	1	0	4	2	9	12
Vancouver	4	2	2	0	4	2	19	18
*Los Angeles	2	0	1	1	1	0	8	13
Calgary	3	0	3	0	0	0	3	16

* — Not including late game; ROW — Regulation plus overtime wins

TUESDAY'S RESULTS

Carolina 6	at Montreal 4	At NY Rangers 5	NY Islanders 2
Utah 5	at New Jersey 3	At Chicago 4	St. Louis 2
At Detroit 5	Ottawa 3	Vegas	at Seattle
At Toronto 5	Nashville 4 (OT)	Florida	at Los Angeles
At Buffalo 3	Minnesota 2 (OT)		

WEDNESDAY'S GAMES

Pittsburgh at Washington	7:30	Edmonton at Anaheim	10
Colorado at Winnipeg	7:30		

MONDAY'S RESULTS

Ottawa 4	at Boston 1	Winnipeg 3	at Pittsburgh 2
At Tampa Bay 4	Philadelphia 1	At Dallas 5	San Jose 0

RED WINGS 5, SENATORS 3

Ottawa	1	1	1	—	3
Detroit	2	2	1	—	5
First period — 1. Ottawa, Stuetzle 3 (Batherson, Greig), 2:44. 2. Detroit, DeBrincat 1 (Danielson, Mazur), 3:16. 3. Detroit, Larkin 1 (Arvidsson, DeBrincat), 13:14. Penalties — Seider, DET (hooking), 7:18. Cousins, OTT (holding stick), 11:01. Copp, DET (hi stick), 14:15.					
Second period — 4. Detroit, Arvidsson 2 (Larkin, Raymond), 2:01 (pp), 5. Detroit, Faulk 1 (Wallinder, Raymond), 4:30. 6. Ottawa, Batherson 2 (Eklund, Yakemchuk), 6:08 (pp). Penalties — Matinpalo, OTT (holding), 0:48. Anjohansson, DET (holding), 5:55. Batherson, OTT (holding), 15:51. DeBrincat, DET, double minor (roughing), 20:00. Larkin, DET (roughing), 20:00. Greig, OTT, double minor (roughing), 20:00. Chiarot, DET, double minor (roughing), 20:00. Pinto, OTT, double minor (roughing), 20:00.					
Third period — 7. Ottawa, Eklund 1 (Zetterlund, Stuetzle), 10:30. 8. Detroit, DeBrincat 2 (Raymond, Faulk), 19:10 (pp) (en). Penalties — Greig, OTT (slashing), 6:20. Kolesar, DET (tripping), 15:37. Batherson, OTT (interference), 18:17.					
Shots on goal — Ottawa 2-14-9 — 25. Detroit 13-12-11 — 36.					
Power plays — Ottawa 1-5; Detroit 2-5.					
Goalies — Ottawa, Ersson 0-1-0 (35 shots-31 saves). Detroit, Gibson 1-2-0 (25 shots-22 saves).					
Referees — Cody Beach, Jean Hebert. Linesmen — Anthony Lapointe, David Brisebois. A — 17,583 (20,000). T — 2:33.					

MAPLE LEAFS 5, PREDATORS 4

Nashville	2	2	0	0	—	4
Toronto	3	1	1	—	5	
First period — 1. Nashville, Stamkos 2 (Wood, Josi), 7:13 (pp), 2. Nashville, Hoglander 2 (Wilsby, Forsberg), 9:08. Penalties — Rielly, TOR (tripping), 5:31. Marchessault, NSH (tripping), 19:47.						
Second period — 3. Nashville, Hoglander 3 (Forsberg, Bourque), 3:03. 4. Toronto, Tavares 1 (McKenna, Stolarz), 4:56. 5. Toronto, Nylander 3 (Matthews, Marchenko), 6:58 (pp). 6. Nashville, Stamkos 3 (O'Reilly, Skjei), 13:30. 7. Toronto, McKenna 1 (Matthews, Roslovic), 14:31. Penalties — Drury, NSH (hooking), 5:31. Colton, NSH (cross check), 15:06.						
Third period — 8. Toronto, Roslovic 1 (Matthews, Nylander), 8:54. Penalties — None.						
Overtime — 9. Toronto, Matthews 2 (Nylander), 4:46. Penalties — None.						
Shots on goal — Nashville 11-7-6-1 — 25. Toronto 8-13-12-5 — 38.						
Power plays — Nashville 1-1; Toronto 1-3.						
Goalies — Nashville, Saros 1-1-1 (38 shots-33 saves). Toronto, Stolarz 2-0-0 (25 shots-31 saves).						
Referees — Justin Kea, Pierre Lambert. Linesmen — Bevan Mills, Scott Cherrey.						
A — 18,792 (18,819). T — 2:37.						

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7:28.	
7:28.	
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Shot	
Power	
0-2.	
Goal	
shots-13	
Referees	
yer, Lin	
Grillo,	

BLACKHAWKS 4, BLUES 2

BLACKHAWKS 4, BLUES 1

St. Louis	1	0	1	—	2
Chicago	0	2	2	—	4

First period — 1. St. Louis, McTavish 2 (McMichael), 15:38. Penalties — Berggren, STL (tripping), 1:23. Kane, CHI (interference), 5:48.

Second period — 2. Chicago, Rinzel 1 (Naz-Laris), 5:40 (pp). 3. Chicago, Rinzel 1 (Leshunvoh, Teravainin), 7:40. Penalties — Johnston, STL (interference), 3:40.

Third period — 4. Chicago, Smith 1, 18:51 (en). 5. St. Louis, McMichael 1 (Broberg, Bu-

chnevich	1	0	1	—	2
(Bertz)	0	2	2	—	4
Kantsers	1	0	1	—	2
Shots	1	0	1	—	2
Power	0	2	2	—	4
Goals	1	0	1	—	2
17 save	0	2	2	—	4
saves).	1	0	1	—	2
Referee	1	0	1	—	2
Marko	0	2	2	—	4
Tommy	1	0	1	—	2
A ,	0	2	2	—	4

chnevich	1	0	1	—	2
(Bertz)	0	2	2	—	4
Kantsers	1	0	1	—	2
Shots	1	0	1	—	2
Power	0	2	2	—	4
Goals	1	0	1	—	2
17 save	0	2	2	—	4
saves).	1	0	1	—	2
Referee	1	0	1	—	2
Marko	0	2	2	—	4
Tommy	1	0	1	—	2
A ,	0	2	2	—	4



GERALD HERBERT/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Falcons' QB Michael Penix Jr. threw for 223 yards and a touchdown in a rout of the Saints.

NFL NOTEBOOK

Eagles' OT Johnson retires after 14 seasons

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Eagles All-Pro offensive lineman **Lane Johnson** announced his retirement from the NFL after 14 seasons.

"I have given it my all for 14 years," Johnson said Tuesday in a statement, "season after season pushing my body to the max and tirelessly working my craft to not only live up to the legacy of the guys that came before me, but to set a new standard of success for the best franchise in all of sports."

Johnson had been a late scratch for last week's game against the Rams for personal reasons. He said Tuesday despite wanting to finish the season, his "personal and family priorities in my life have changed."

Johnson missed time in training camp for personal reasons before saying that this season would probably be his last.

The 36-year-old Johnson was a first-round pick in 2013 and was a first-team All-Pro in 2017 and 2022. He earned second-team honors in 2021, 2023 and 2024. Johnson has been a pillar at right tackle and won a pair of Super Bowls with the Eagles.

Johnson took a leave of absence during the 2021 season as he battled anxiety and depression and has since shared his story at mental health clinics in the area.

Johnson, a six-time Pro Bowl selection, said earlier this year his potential retirement came in to focus last season after conversations with his family and an injury-filled season. He missed the Eagles' final seven regular-season games and the wild-card playoff loss to the 49ers.

"Right now, it is critical that I focus on my mental health," Johnson said. "I owe it to my teammates, coaches, the organization and the fans to have my head and heart 100 percent in the game. And right now my heart is telling me that it's time to say goodbye to football."

Robinsons, Penix spark Falcons

The Falcons' running game has taken the pressure off quarterback **Michael Penix Jr.** in his return to the starting offense.

Bijan Robinson (19 carries, 145 yards, 2 TDs) and **Brian Robinson** combined to rush for 207

yards and five touchdowns as the Falcons' offense continued their dramatic turnaround with Penix as the starter in a 45-24 win over the Saints on "Monday Night Football" in New Orleans.

The Falcons have gone from the lowest-scoring team in the league to the highest with the return of Penix, who has led his team to 80 points in the two weeks he's been back. In the season's opening two weeks, with reserve **Cooper Rush** at the controls, the Falcons scored just 16 combined points in losses to the Steelers and Panthers.

Penix was efficient and avoided mistakes against the Saints. He completed 15 of 20 passes for 223 yards with one touchdown and no interceptions. He spread the ball around, threw a deep 31-yard touchdown pass and led a mistake-free performance that produced six offensive touchdowns and the most points the Falcons have scored in a game since 2016.

The Falcons' dominant win over the Saints came on the heels of a 35-14 blowout at Green Bay on Sept. 24. A team that was booed off its home field after a 34-3 loss to the Panthers is now tied for first place in the NFC South after four games.

"What do I think I've proven? That I'm healthy. That's it," said Penix, who tore his left ACL last November. "I feel like we still got a lot of work to do. I'm not going to sit here and say I'm satisfied. You know we still got a long season."

Giants put WR/KR Berrios on IR

The Giants will place wide receiver/returner **Braxton Berrios** on injured reserve. Berrios announced his status on social media on his 31st birthday, saying he was having season-ending surgery for the foot injury that knocked him out of New York's 36-24 victory Sunday over the Cardinals. . . . Cowboys left guard **Tyler Smith** has a chance to return against the Buccaneers on Thursday after missing the minimum of four games while on injured reserve with a left thumb injury. . . **Patrick Surtain II** and **Pat Bryant's** ankle injuries are less serious than first feared. Both sprained an ankle during the Broncos' 24-14 loss at San Francisco. Either or both could end up on short-term injured reserve, but the Broncos have yet to make a move.

Official misconduct flagged

NFL Referees Association to challenge severity of bans

By Arnie Stapleton
ASSOCIATED PRESS

NFL players have to show sportsmanship or they can draw flags and/or fines and now officiating crews are on notice that they, too, must display appropriate behavior in the heat of the moment.

The NFL flagged two officials Monday, suspending line judge Jeff Seeman and referee Adrian Hill for their actions during a wild Week 4 marked by profane flare-ups that included Aaron Rodgers and Mike McCarthy cursing at each other and Dre Greenlaw displaying the kind of fiery spirit toward Sean Payton that the Broncos coach wished had shown up last season in Denver.

Seeman was banned two games for swearing at Trey McBride after the Cardinals' star tight end argued for a pass interference call when he was hit by a defender before the ball arrived. Hill received a one-game suspension for unprofessional conduct for yelling at Eric Wilson and pointing for him to get away after the Vikings linebacker tried to help him to his feet after a collision knocked him over.

The NFL Referees Association said in a statement Tuesday the suspensions were excessive and inconsistent with past precedent and it plans to challenge the severity.

"NFL officials have a responsibility to conduct themselves professionally on the field, and the actions in these incidents fell short of that standard," NFLRA executive director Scott Green said. "Accountability matters, but that should not result in discipline that is excessive or inconsistent with established precedent."

Greenlaw, who rejoined the 49ers last offseason, forced a fumble and collected a dozen tackles in the 49ers' 24-14 win over the Broncos on Sunday.

After just about every one of his stops, he pointed and hollered at Payton, assuredly still stinging over his departure from Denver in which he said his agent had to inform him the Broncos were moving on just one year into his three-year, \$31.5 million deal.

As Payton was walking across the field to shake Kyle Shanahan's hand after the game, Greenlaw confronted the Broncos coach and took one more verbal shot at his old coach as fellow linebacker Fred Warner redirect-



CALEB BOWLIN/GETTY IMAGES

NFL line judge Jeff Seeman (right) was suspended two games Monday for swearing at Cardinals tight end Trey McBride.

ed him toward the 49ers' tunnel.

Payton didn't engage with Greenlaw, who told the San Francisco Chronicle, "I told him to get the [expletive] off the field. That's it: 'Get the [expletive] off the field.'"

Asked if he had any issue with Greenlaw getting in his face Sunday, Payton said, "No, and I said this to Kyle afterwards, I think the world of him. I really love everything about him and he plays with that emotion. So, it's all good."

Maybe it's all good in Pittsburgh, too.

McCarthy expressed regret for profanity he used toward Rodgers that was caught on the Thursday night broadcast of the Steelers' 27-24 loss to the Browns in Cleveland.

Midway through the first quarter, a flustered Rodgers was shown looking at Pittsburgh's sideline and yelling, "What the [expletive]? Call it!" The camera then cut to McCarthy, who muttered a profanity in response.

"Communication sometimes is not the best choice of words, but everybody's competing on the field," McCarthy said. "I think what's said on the field, the way I grew up in this game, usually stays on the field. That's not the case today. I understand that. But any negative communication on my part, I wish I wouldn't use those words."

Players yelling at the sidelines — even their own — is nothing new.

Neither are heated exchanges between players and officials.

But these four stood out, especially because they were caught on camera and quickly raced across social media, not the kind of viral moments the NFL prefers.

McBride knew Seeman's vulgarity was being broadcast — he pointed toward the camera that caught the line judge's obscenities.

"Obviously, you hate to see it, for obvious reasons," said Cardinals coach Mike LaFleur. "I do want to give the man a little bit of grace, too. I know Jeff. He's a good man. It's unfortunate it happened. It can't happen, obviously, and I'll leave it at that."

The incident drew the ire of players union leader JC Tretter, a retired offensive lineman who played eight seasons in the NFL: "This kind of behavior from an official towards a player is unacceptable," Tretter, the NFL Players Association's executive director, posted on social media along with a video clip of the incident.

Vikings coach Kevin O'Connell lamented the official's reaction where Wilson was only trying to help Hill to his feet after he got knocked into the referee, who fell down.

"I just think it's one of those situations in kind of a high-energy moment there," O'Connell said. "I think stuff like that can happen sometimes, but I don't have any major concerns, and I think Adrian's a really good official and does a really good job. I think that was just kind of fast moment that happened, and we can put it behind us, hopefully."

Patriots' Maye, Chism on rise

►PATRIOTS

Continued from Page C1

Campbell fares on Sunday, with premier talent Maxx Crosby on deck.

Wide receiver Kyle Williams: After the Patriots traded Kayshon Boutte, the thought was that Williams, their first of two 2025 third-round picks, could earn more opportunities. After A.J. Brown suffered a high ankle sprain in the season opener, the thought gained more steam. But nothing changed for Williams. He maintained a minimal offensive role. Then, on Sunday, Mack Hollins left the game in the third quarter with a calf injury — and Williams still did not log a catch. Maye could not con-

nect with him on his one target. The fact that Williams hasn't been able to earn a larger role, despite seemingly multiple openings, is concerning.

Three to watch

Wide receiver Mack Hollins: Vrabel said Monday that he wasn't sure if Hollins would be able to practice "for a couple days." With Brown sidelined for at least one more game, the Patriots may need to turn to the practice squad (Chandler Brayboy, Kyle Dixon, Cameron Dorner) or elsewhere to fill out their receiver depth.

Special teamer Brenden Schooler: After missing training camp and starting the season on

the non-football injury list, Schooler returned to practice last week. The Patriots, who have two open roster spots, can activate him for Sunday.

Right guard: The Patriots have tried Greg Van Roten, Walter Rouse, and Ben Brown to fill the void left by starter Mike Owenu (ankle). With Van Roten (thigh) also on injured reserve, the team is down to Rouse and Brown. Neither has been impressive enough to earn the job outright, so perhaps the Patriots will consider newly signed Matt Pryor.

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Shiffrin to shift focus from slalom to giant slalom, super-G

By Pat Graham
ASSOCIATED PRESS

Two-time Olympic slalom champion Mikaela Shiffrin will shift her focus from that discipline this season to turn more of her attention toward training for giant slalom and super-G events.

The former New Hampshire resident and Burke Mountain Academy alum announced her strategy Tuesday in what she describes as a season of "exploration." It's part of her plan to push herself coming off a season where she won her second Olympic gold in slalom at the Milan Cortina Games and earned her ninth World Cup season title in the discipline.

The season kicks off on Oct. 24 with a giant slalom race in Soelden, Austria. Shiffrin said her first slalom race is expected

to be in Killington, Vt., over Thanksgiving weekend and she will proceed from there.

"I'm not trying to do less because I care less. I'm trying to do something different because I still care SO much," the 31-year-old Shiffrin said in a statement. "The joy for me has never been about medals or records.

"This season is an exploration. We're calling it the exploration season."

Shiffrin won her sixth overall World Cup title by 87 points over Emma Aicher of Germany. Shiffrin also won the crystal globe in the slalom by beating Camille Rast of Switzerland.

In the giant slalom standings Shiffrin was fourth, while winding up outside the top 30 in the super-G. Her last World Cup win in the super-G, an event that blends the speed of a downhill

with the turns of a GS, was in December 2022. She won a downhill event in 2023.

"Racing slalom underprepared would be like jumping into a giant blender and just trying to avoid the blades," Shiffrin said. "I'm trying a little bit more to live in the gratitude of it and ski because I want to ski. ... I'm not looking for less commitment. I'm not looking for actually even less effort."

She added: "I feel ambitious. I still feel competitive. I feel like I have a desire to ski fast. I feel like those things haven't changed. I'm really just giving myself permission to be curious about where that takes me, and that's the exploration."

Shiffrin also plans to continue to work on her podcast, "What's the Point with Mikaela Shiffrin."



FILE/MARCO TROVATI/ASSOCIATED PRESS

American Mikaela Shiffrin won her ninth World Cup crystal globe in the slalom last March.

Baseball



MIKE STEWART/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Yoshinobu Yamamoto allowed one run on four hits and a walk, with 10 strikeouts, over seven innings in the Dodgers’ win over the Braves to lower his career postseason ERA to 2.14 in 11 appearances (10 starts).

NOTEBOOK

Yamamoto helps Dodgers dominate Braves in NLDS

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Yoshinobu Yamamoto struck out 10 in seven brilliant innings, **Kiké Hernández** hit a two-run homer, and the Dodgers beat the Braves, 3-1, on Tuesday night in Atlanta to take a 2-1 lead in their National League Division Series.

Yamamoto dominated the much-anticipated matchup with Braves ace **Chris Sale**, who allowed three runs and seven hits in five innings. The MVP of the 2025 World Series, Yamamoto permitted only four hits with one walk while improving to 8-1 with a 2.14 ERA in 11 career postseason outings, including 10 starts.

His 10 strikeouts were a post-season high for the righthander. “I’d like to continue living up to the highest expectation,” Yamamoto said through a translator. “I was confident and able to control all my pitches today.”

The Dodgers can win the best-of-five series and take another step in their attempt to become the first NL team to claim three consecutive World Series titles by winning again Wednesday in Game 4.

Atlanta hoped giving Sale extra rest would be a winning formula in the pivotal third game. Instead, after stranding six runners in the first three innings, he gave up the two-run homer to Hernández and a solo shot to former Braves star **Freddie Freeman** in the fourth.

Ozzie Albies opened the Braves’ ninth inning with a double off the right-center field wall against **Edwin Díaz** and moved to third on **Michael Harris II**’s groundout. Díaz stranded the runner when **Mauricio Dubón** fouled out to right field and **Mike Yastrzemski** grounded out to shortstop **Mookie Betts**.

Dubón made a leaping catch over the left-field wall to rob Freeman of a homer in the third.

Earlier Tuesday, the Dodgers announced **Fred Claire**, who parlayed early jobs as a sports writer and editor into a 30-year career with the team in public relations and as a

WEDNESDAY'S GAMES												
		2026		Team		2026 vs. opp		Last 3 starts				
	Odds	W-L	ERA	rec.	W-L	IP	ERA	W-L	IP	ERA		
CLEVELAND AT CHI. WHITE SOX, 4 p.m.												
Espino (R)	+100	0-0	4.11	2-1	0-0	2.0	4.50	0-0	4.0	6.75		
Newcomb (L)	-120	2-5	3.09	5-1	0-1	8.1	3.24	0-0	4.1	2.08		
LA DODGERS AT ATLANTA, 6 p.m.												
Glasnow (R)	-145	5-2	3.53	9-4	0-0	5.0	5.40	1-2	16.1	4.96		
Mahle (R)	+125	7-10	3.99	12-16	1-0	7.0	0.00	1-0	18.0	3.50		
TAMPA BAY AT NY YANKEES, 8 p.m.												
Martínez (R)	+140	15-6	3.10	22-9	0-1	16.2	2.16	1-2	13.2	5.27		
Fried (L)	-165	5-5	2.80	12-9	0-1	14.2	4.30	2-1	19.2	2.75		
MILWAUKEE AT SAN DIEGO, 10 p.m.												
TBA	Off	—	—	0-0	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-0	0.0	—		
TBA	Off	—	—	0-0	0-0	0.0	0.00	0-0	0.0	—		
Team rec. — Record in games started by pitcher this season												

World Series-winning general manager, died. Claire died Monday, on his 91st birthday, in Pasadena, Calif. Obituary, C8.

‘Pride’ of Yankees on line

Max Fried’s words were as sharp as the break on some of his pitches. “It’s important to have a little bit of pride and to be able to say: ‘That’s not us and we’re going to prove it,’” the Yankees pitcher said.

After making four errors in a dismal Game 2 defeat Monday, New York’s players and staff arrived home about 5 a.m. Tuesday in a 2-0 American League Division Series deficit for the second straight year; this time against the Rays. The best-of-five matchup resumes Wednesday at Yankee Stadium with Fried starting opposite Tampa Bay’s **Nick Martínez**.

With one more loss, the World Series title drought for Major League Baseball’s winningest team would extend to a 17th season — matching the most since Babe Ruth led New York to its first championship in 1923. The Yankees haven’t advanced past a higher-seeded team in a postseason series since 2020.

“This group has done a really good job all year of bouncing back through a tough game, through some tough moments in the season and handled it all very well. So that’s my expectation this time. It has to be,” said manager **Aaron Boone**, who spoke with players individually rather than give a rah-rah speech.

The Rays could party at Yankee Stadium for the second time in two weeks, after clinching the AL East there on Sept. 22.

Seeking their first World Series title, the Rays are nearing an AL Championship Series against the White Sox or Guardians. Chicago also is up 2-0 as it gets set to host Cleveland for Game 3 on Wednesday.

Padres without Miller

Padres closer **Mason Miller** went on the postseason paternity list with San Diego facing elimination in the NL Division Series. The intimidating All-Star reliever will miss at least one game, the Padres announced about 45 minutes before the first pitch of Game 3 against the Brewers. Lefthanded reliever **Wandy Peralta** replaced Miller on the roster.

Miller also blew the save in the ninth inning of the Padres’ 4-3 loss to the Brewers on Sunday after coming on in the eighth inning, putting San Diego in an 0-2 hole.

McDowell dead at 86

Sam McDowell, a six-time All Star who led the AL in strikeouts four times before becoming a counselor for athletes suffering from addiction issues and depression, died Monday at home in Florida. He was 84.

The lefthander’s baseball career and post-career sobriety served as the inspiration for the **Sam Malone** character from the iconic, Boston-based television sitcom “Cheers.”

Breslow talk harkens back to Duquette

►GASPER

Continued from Page C1

words but can’t resist garnishing them with justifications, rationalizations, and qualifiers.

The clearest sign of that is how Breslow characterized the 32-5 stretch, highlighted by the outrageous fortune of a 27-3 run, that saved our summer and the Red Sox’ season. After that hardball deliverance, the Sox went 23-26, including the postseason, and averaged a major league-low 3.55 runs per game.

He was asked if such an anomalous sample of overperformance complicated evaluating the team.

“I think I’d also maybe push back a bit on this was kind of 35-ish games of excellence and 127 games of mediocrity,” said Breslow. “When you think about or look at the overall totality of the record from July 1 on, it was three months of playing at I think like a 104-kind-of-win pace. Even [in] September, we certainly didn’t play as well as we did in August and July — we had a bunch of guys on the [injured list] — we were .500.

“Is that good enough? No, but I think really good teams, they go 32-5 over a stretch, and teams that are mired in mediocrity over the course of the other 125, they don’t. So, I think this was more than just a run. I think it showed some true underlying talent. But we obviously have a lot of work to get where we want to go heading into 2027.”

There are 10 teams since 1900, the ’26 Resurrection Red Sox being one of three since the advent of divisional play in 1969, that have reeled off a 27-3 run. An organization that prides itself on dispassionate data-based evaluations should view it as the outlier of all outliers.

Instead, they keep leaning into the sugar rush of confirming their own team-building prowess. The Sox have pegged the future of their organization on the Midsummer Mirage when assorted Seiglers, Sogards, Chengs, and Joneses couldn’t lose if they tried, and Andruw Monasterio channeled Nomar Garciaparra to erase a 32-46 start. Then, the contender carriage turned back into a Run Prevention 2.0 pumpkin.

At this same year-end news conference in 2024, Breslow said, “It’s time to deliver the team that is capable of winning the AL East [and] making a deep playoff run.” Last year, he offered, “This window of contention is upon us.”

This time, Breslow offered Duquette-esque explanations.

■ He said the Sox “own the struggles that we had in the postseason” but mentioned that both games of the Wild Card Series with the Yankees were “very, very close for the first five innings or so before they got away late.” Sure, and the Celtics would’ve beaten the 76ers if they stopped the series after 4½ games.

■ Breslow acknowledged that “our offense was inconsistent” but that it was important to “call out” seven players set career highs in home runs, a list that presumably includes Mickey Gasper (10), Monasterio (6), Sogard (5), and Seigler (3).

■ He pointed to sweeps of the Yankees and Rays during the 32-5 run as partial proof that the 87-75 Sox were on par with their AL East rivals.

■ He referenced missing ace Garrett Crochet from late April until a bumpy relief appearance in Game 2, and Anthony’s recurring ring finger/wrist malady while discussing win-total projections. Neither of those players was available during the 32-5 midsummer dream he championed.

Perhaps the Sox are correct. Breslow is a visionary who will build the Next Great Red Sox Team. However, such confidence seems — like the de facto extension they handed him — premature.

At spring training in February, Breslow said, “2026 is a really important season for us, for our fans. They deserve kind of more.”

When is more coming instead of the Sox settling for more of the same and labeling it success?

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SCOTT MARSHALL/ASSOCIATED PRESS

The Red Sox got a jump on the trade deadline by adding Curtis Mead, but lost him immediately to injury.

Division Series

American League	
CHI. WHITE SOX VS. CLEVELAND	
White Sox lead series, 2-0	
Saturday, Oct. 3	
Chi. White Sox 3.....	at Cleveland 0
Monday, Oct. 5	
Chi. White Sox 4.....	at Cleveland 3
Schedule	
Wed., Oct. 7 at Chi. White Sox.....	4
*Thu., Oct. 8 at Chi. White Sox.....	5
*Sat., Oct. 10 at Cleveland.....	5
NY YANKEES VS. TAMPA BAY	
Rays lead series, 2-0	
Saturday, Oct. 3	
At Tampa Bay 1.....	NY Yankees 0
Monday, Oct. 5	
At Tampa Bay 5.....	NY Yankees 2
Schedule	
Wed., Oct. 7 at NY Yankees.....	8
*Thu., Oct. 8 at NY Yankees.....	8
*Sat., Oct. 10 at Tampa Bay.....	8
National League	
ATLANTA VS. LA DODGERS	
Dodgers lead series, 2-1	
Saturday, Oct. 3	
At LA Dodgers 5.....	Atlanta 3
Sunday, Oct. 4	
Atlanta 3.....	at LA Dodgers 2
Tuesday, Oct. 6	
LA Dodgers 3.....	at Atlanta 1
Schedule	
Wed., Oct. 7 at Atlanta.....	6
*Fri., Oct. 9 at LA Dodgers.....	8
SAN DIEGO VS. MILWAUKEE	
Brewers lead series, 2-0	
Saturday, Oct. 3	
At Milwaukee 3.....	San Diego 2
Sunday, Oct. 4	
At Milwaukee 4.....	San Diego 3
Tuesday, Oct. 6	
Milwaukee.....	at San Diego 0
Schedule	
*Wed., Oct. 7 at San Diego.....	10
*Fri., Oct. 9 at Milwaukee.....	4:30
* If necessary	

Box scores

DODGERS 3, BRAVES 1												
LA DODGERS	AB	R	H	BI	BB	SO	Avg.					
Betts ss	5	0	2	0	0	1	.300					
Freeman 1b	4	1	1	1	1	1	.364					
Therán 2b	4	0	0	0	0	0	.167					
Muncy ph-3b	1	0	0	0	0	1	.250					
WillSmith c	4	0	1	0	0	3	.083					
Ohtani dh	2	0	0	0	1	1	.200					
Rojas 2b	3	0	0	0	0	1	.250					
Edman ph-2b	1	0	0	0	0	0	.000					
Pages cf	4	1	2	0	0	1	.182					
Tucker rf	4	0	1	0	0	1	.333					
KHernández 3b-1f	4	1	1	2	0	2	.250					
Totals	36	3	8	3	2	12						
ATLANTA												
Baldwin c	4	0	0	1	0	2	.100					
Acuña Jr. dh	3	0	0	0	1	1	.167					
Olson 1b	4	0	1	0	0	2	.167					
Albies 2b	4	0	1	0	0	2	.182					
Harris II cf	4	0	1	0	0	0	.308					
Dubón II-ss	4	1	1	0	0	0	.200					
LaneThomas rf	3	0	1	0	0	2	.167					
Yastrzemski ph	1	0	0	0	0	0	.000					
Riley 3b	3	0	0	0	0	2	.000					
Hakim ss	1	0	0	0	0	1	.000					
Tellez ph	0	0	0	0	1	0	.000					
Hicklen pr-1f	1	0	0	0	0	1	.000					
Totals	32	1	5	1	2	12						
LA Dodgers.....					000	300	000	—	3	8	0	
Atlanta.....					000	010	000	—	1	5	2	
E—Baldwin (1), Hakim (1). LOB—LA Dodgers 9, Atlanta 6.												
2B—Albies (1). HR—Freeman (2), off Sale, KHernández (1), off Sale. SB—Tucker (2).												
LA Dodgers												
Yamamoto W 1-0	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA					
Scott	7	4	1	1	1	10	1.29					
Díaz 5-1	1	0	0	0	1	2	10.80					
	1	1	0	0	0	0	0.00					
Atlanta												
Sale 1-0-1	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO	ERA					
Dodd	5	7	3	3	0	7	5.40					
Lea	1	1	0	0	0	2	.000					
Suter	1	0	0	0	1	0	0.00					
Iglesias	1	0	0	0	1	2	0.00					
Catchers interference—Baldwin. NP—Yamamoto 98, Scott 19, Díaz 19, Sale 95, Dodd 17, Lee 9, Suter 21, Iglesias 22. Umpires—Home, James Hoyer; First, Tripp Gibson; Second, Jim Wolf; Third, Mike Estabrook; Left, Roberto Ortiz; Right, Chris Guccione. T—2:56. A—42,420 (40,819).												

RAYS 5, YANKEES 2	
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TONY AVELAR/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Golden State forward Gabby Williams puts up a 3-pointer against Las Vegas on Sunday. Williams had 19 points in the game.

Williams a postseason hero

‘Big-shot Gabby’ hits new heights in WNBA

By Julian Benbow
GLOBE STAFF

The Golden State Valkyries were designed for the whole to be greater than the sum of their parts. No one on the roster averaged more than 15 points during the regular season, but the Valkyries finished with the WNBA’s second-best record.

So watching Gabby Williams score 17 second-half points and will the Valkyries out of a 16-point deficit to a Game 3 win that sealed their first-round series over the Dallas Wings wasn’t a surprise to her teammates.

They knew her game could reach another level once the playoffs arrived, even if the rest of the league didn’t.

“Big-shot Gabby,” Tiffany Hayes said. “She’s our dog, she’s our leader, she’s the one we go to. And she showed you exactly why she is who she is. So, we’ll do it again and again, over and over. And we believe in her. It’s Gabby [expletive] Williams. What you talking about?”

Through four playoff games, Williams is tied for third in postseason scoring at 25 points per game. The jump she’s made from her regular-season output (14.4) to the playoffs is the second-largest in the league.

Williams’s 19-point Game 3 performance — as timely as it was — was also her most modest scoring night of the postseason. She scored 20 points in Game 1 against the Wings, then 36 in Game 2. In the semifinal opener against the Las Vegas Aces, she put up 25.

“I think she’s now continuing, game to game, to show she’s one of the best players in the world,” Valkyries coach Natalie Nakase said.

Williams is on her third WNBA roster in eight seasons. In Golden State, she’s found a place that’s allowed her to elevate.

“I came just because I wanted someone to believe in me, that’s really it — in the league at least,” she said. “I think I’ve had these moments with [Turkish club Fenerbahce], with my national team, but I never quite got that belief in the W from a staff or from teammates.”

Several of the players who elevated their scoring most also helped push their teams into the next round.

After giving the Atlanta Dream 11.6 points per game in the regular season, Jordyn Canada is averaging 18 in the playoffs, scoring 19 in Atlanta’s closeout Game 2 against the Washington Mystics, then dropping 25 in the semifinal opener against the New York Liberty.

The Dream also have gotten a lift from veteran DeWanna Bonner, who left the Phoenix Mercury in late August to join Atlanta. After averaging 10.4 points during the regular season, she’s given the Dream a post-season boost with 14.3 points per game, including 23 in Game 1 against the Liberty.

A’ja Wilson was already the league’s gold standard for scoring, but she has upped her production from 26.2 points per game in the regular season to 30 in the playoffs.

The largest postseason leap belonged to Wings guard Arike Ogunbowale, who spiked from 15.3 points in the regular season to 28.3 in the playoffs, setting a postseason scoring record with 45 points, including the tying 3-pointer in Game 2. She just happened to run into Williams and the Valkyries.

At the other end of the spectrum, Olivia Miles spent the season weaving wonders as a rookie for a Minnesota Lynx team that lived at the top of the standings.

Her 19.8 points, 6.0 assists, and 4.7 rebounds per game made her a genuine MVP candidate.

But the playoffs proved to be a different animal. The Lynx were swept by the eighth-seeded Liberty, a team that was hard for Miles to solve in the regular season.

Miles averaged just 8 points in the playoffs, the largest postseason dropoff in the league.

“It was an interesting year,” she said in her exit interview. “We started off with weird expectations and then we got really good. And then it was like, well, OK, you guys should win. And it then felt like if we didn’t win it was like dead to the world almost. So it was just navigating all those expectations.”

“I also started off as a rookie who no one really thought would do what I did. Now I’m in MVP conversations and now I have to play at that level. It was just a roller coaster of expectations and emotions all year.”

Miles wasn’t the only player whose regular-season production dipped sharply in the postseason.

After giving the Lynx 14.8 points per game during the regular season, Natasha Howard averaged just 5 in the playoffs.

Jessica Shepard, who had a career year, putting up 14.5 points per game in Dallas, averaged just 5.3 in the playoffs. Paige Bueckers went from scoring 20.9 per game in the regular season to 16.

The Mystics saw their young stars go through both extremes. Sonia Citron piled up 25 points per game in the playoffs after averaging 16.8 in the regular season, but Shakira Austin dipped from 17 points in the regular season to 10.5.

For her part, Miles acknowledged that, as a rookie, there was no way to know how different playoff basketball would be.

“I just didn’t know what to expect,” she said. “I’m not going to sit here and beat myself up about that, but it was more of a scarcity mind-set going into the playoffs. Like, ‘Oh my gosh, what if this doesn’t happen.’ And just changing that mind-set and just going out there and leaving it all out there and not caring what the result may be.”

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Celtics to push stars to limit, not beyond

►CELTICS
Continued from Page C1

— and he has.

Derrick White, Payton Pritchard and Mike Conley are the only players on the Celtics’ roster who have played 82 games in a season. But no one in that trio has done it more than once.

“Regardless of who it is, the standard and expectation of playing all 82 isn’t realistic,” Mazzulla said this week before practice at The Citadel. “So I don’t know that anyone on our roster, I think one or two guys have played 82. Eighty-two [games] is not the standard or the expectation. Making sure we get the best out of them for the entire year, however long that year lasts. That’s for everybody.”

Mazzulla wouldn’t say who will play in Thursday’s pre-season opener against the Cavaliers or how much he plans to use his first unit. But he does have to determine workload schedules for the likes of Tatum, George and Mitchell. Will they play in back-to-backs? Will they get scheduled rest days or will it depend on the condition of their body?

“It’s not like we come in and tell guys they have to play 82 games or make that the standard,” Mazzulla said. “One thing since I’ve been here, we’ve always trusted the competitive character of our guys. If guys can play they’re going to play, even if they feel like they can’t, they’re going to still going to try the best they can to play. As long as we keep that standard of we do everything we can to put ourselves out there every single night, that to me is more important than anything else.”

As for Tatum, Mazzulla said he trusts his superstar and the Celtics medical team to determine the right plan. Tatum has been reluctant to miss games over the years because of rest.

“It starts with do everything you possibly can to be out there every single night, and then we go from there,” Mazzulla said of the approach with Tatum. “And then we trust him. We trust our

sports and science team. That’s why we have 10 of them. We trust his trainer and they do a hell of a job.

“We want the expectation that you are going to do anything and everything and we can to rely on you throughout every single night. We trust those guys and their preparation for what makes sense going forward.”

Mitchell Robinson wasn’t familiar with several of his new Celtics teammates before joining the club, but he did have one interesting connection.

He was roommates with Pritchard during the under-19 Team USA training camp in 2017. Pritchard made the team. Robinson did not.

“I’ve been knowing him for a little minute now,” Robinson said. “But now that we’re teammates in the NBA, it’s a crazy ride, a journey. You see so many familiar faces and then you meet some new people. I didn’t know much about Tatum but now learning him. It’s been amazing.”

Robinson said there was one aspect of Pritchard’s style that hasn’t changed in nine years.

“His work ethic is crazy,” Robinson said. “It’s through the roof. The way he handled the ball. I’m pretty sure you’ve seen the videos but to actually see that in person, that’s next level.”

The Celtics completed their three-day session in South Carolina with a practice Tuesday before heading to Cleveland. Persistent rain dampened plans for team golf outings, but Tatum said he was able to play nine holes Monday. Many Celtics players have bonded during golf outings, with Pritchard and Conley developing a rivalry on the course . . . The team made it through training camp with no injuries although Tatum described the camp as tough.

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MELECK ELDAHSHOURY FOR THE GLOBE

Celtics coach Joe Mazzulla said it wasn’t a realistic standard to expect his team’s star players to go the 82-game distance.

Roxbury CC boasts first varsity flag football team in Bay State

►FLAG FOOTBALL

Continued from Page C1

The program’s origin dates to last October, when Jefferson received an email from the NJCAA that offered a grant to start a varsity women’s flag football team.

Jefferson quickly forwarded the email to athletic director Albert Hayle, but he’d already seen it. They worked quickly, securing the \$5,000 grant and forming a team that would play its first game just five months later.

“This was a big part of [Jefferson’s] passion and dream, getting women’s flag football as a part of our athletic program just because of where the sport is going,” Hayle said. “It’s at the forefront right now for women’s sport because of the opportunity it’s creating, the platform it’s opening up for young women.”

Finding a coach

Randy Phillips knows a little something about flag football.

Last year, he was a girls’ flag coach at Johnston High School in Rhode Island. He also was the cofounder and assistant director for the girls’ high school flag league — which got sanctioned by the Rhode Island Interscholastic League in

August.

But he’s from Roxbury. This was an opportunity right in his backyard.

“When Roxbury Community College pops up and I saw it, I said, ‘Let’s give it a shot, who know what’s going to happen?’” Phillips said. “I didn’t see this coming at all.”

Phillips interviewed and received offers from various Division 1 and 3 programs, but the chance to give back to his community meant the world to him because the job was bigger than football. It was his purpose.

That mind-set helped make him a “perfect candidate” to Hayle.

“Just because of his qualifications,” Hayle said. “But most importantly, his love for the game. And everything that he’s already done for the game and growing the game. It felt like he was the right person to help take our program to the next level.”

For Year 1, Hayle and the athletic department just wanted Phillips to “lay a foundation.”

He was ready for that.

“They understood that this was going to be a process,” Phillips said. “They weren’t telling me or casting me with the responsibility to bring in championships, and, ‘We want X players, we want

Z players.’”

Phillips was officially hired in November. The NJCAA had 15 teams last season, so Roxbury played programs of all levels and finished 2-7. It also competed in the league’s invitational championship.

“It was some bumps and bruises, but we ultimately made it through,” Phillips said. “So, at the end of the day these girls are pioneers.”

Furthering the mission

Jefferson had a goal when he was hired in 2024.

Triple the size of the athletic department.

He cited increased enrollment, a clear mission of the college as it celebrated its largest graduating class in recent history in May. He also factored in the success rate of student-athletes and the school’s mantra of being “the high-way for economic mobility.”

That means more sports are coming. Dance, cheer, and e-sports are the latest few.

But the aim to grow women’s sports specifically comes as the ratio of women to men at the school is nearly 2-1, according to RCC’s website.

The program has been well received

by the Roxbury College community. Hayle, who’s also the men’s basketball coach, made sure his team was there for games. The rest of the campus followed suit, showing up and out in the first home game.

“It was one of those moments where if you looked around, you would’ve thought it was a tailgate party,” Phillips said. “That’s a community, and that’s a family of people where no matter what the weather was and what the situation was, they came out and said they supported women’s flag football.”

The program’s value to the school is clear.

“There was just a buzz and a high degree of accomplishment felt by everyone here at the college,” Jefferson said.

Getting the bigger picture

Post University in Waterbury, Conn., debuted flag last spring. In 2027, St. Joseph’s College of Maine, Dean College, Massasoit Community College, UMass Dartmouth, and Westfield State University will add a varsity program. Harvard, UConn, and Sacred Heart have club teams.

Overall, there are 48 teams set to begin in the coming years, according to collegiateflagfootball.com, a women’s

flag publication owned by Matthew Dixon.

“I’ve seen it grow very fast in the last year or so,” Dixon said. “And it’s been faster than I anticipated. And I don’t think that’ll stop.”

There are also 39 NJCAA schools set to compete on the varsity level next season, but only Roxbury represents New England. The Southeast, along with California, has long been a pipeline for flag talent. But recently, talent has started to stretch across the country.

It’s a growth that Dixon credits to NFL Flag, a partner for the NJCAA’s grant program.

“They’ve really tried to fill out the whole pipeline,” Dixon said. “And then the Olympics have helped build that final piece along with the professional leagues.”

Roxbury is not just satisfied with making history. It’s hoping to become a pipeline and force to be reckoned with in athletics for years to come.

“This is a big deal for us,” Jefferson said. “RCC used to be an athletic powerhouse, and we would like to regain that status.”

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HIGH SCHOOL FIELD HOCKEY NOTEBOOK

Unbeaten Milton reaching potential

By Kat Cornetta
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

What's the secret to starting your field hockey season undefeated?

At Milton High, it just may be a frozen treat.

"It's not every practice," said Milton junior tri-captain **Addie Phaneuf**. "But my favorite thing is after a lot of our practices, we go and get ice cream or frozen yogurt. I think it's just a great way our team bonds. I think it translates on the field, because it makes everyone closer."

On Wednesdays, the team takes advantage of a deal at a local frozen yogurt store in which toppings are unlimited *just* on Wednesdays.

"No-weight Wednesdays," said senior tri-captain **Ali Drane**. "You can get as many toppings as you want!"

What else is unlimited? The Wildcats' potential. They currently sit at 7-0-1, with their only blemish a 3-3 tie at Bay State Conference foe Natick Monday night.

Milton is using camaraderie and offseason work to emerge as a legit BSC contender entering a stiff test against three-time defending Division 1 champion Walpole.

"This is a really big week for us," said Milton coach **Lindsey Scully**.

Milton graduated several key players from last year's squad, which finished 10-6-1 and was bounced from the MIAA Division 2 tournament in the Round of 16 by eventual finalist Hingham. The Wildcats knew that they would have to put in the offseason work to bring everyone, from newcomers to returners, up to the standards the graduates had set.

"We did a lot of work together this summer," said Drane. "We had 6 a.m. workouts where we would do our conditioning package together twice a week, every week. It was a really great time for everyone to come together and work hard and push each other."

Motivation was also generated from Milton's MIAA Division 2 girls' ice hockey championship last March. Nine current field hockey players were on that team, including Phaneuf and goalies **Caera Hart** and **Sophie McCosker**. The knowledge of what it takes to win a state title has been carried over to the field hockey side of the house.

"I think the win at the Garden really motivated everybody," said Phaneuf. "Not only the hockey players, but the whole school saw that a girls team was able to win a title last year."

Drane and Phaneuf knew that the Wildcats were up to something good when they earned a 5-2 victory at Needham on Sept. 16. Milton yielded two early goals, and then kept the Rockets from finding the back of the net the rest of the game.

"It really showed that, even though we were down, no one let that get to their head," said Phaneuf.

"They've always been a program who gives us a hard time," said Drane. "It's always a great game between the two of us."

Twelve days later, they earned a 3-1 win at home against defensively-minded Wellesley, and that's when junior tri-captain Piper Ber- ginn knew Milton was on a roll.

"They're notoriously really good," said Bergin. "We really put our mind to it in practice to work on our passing, transferring and everything, so that we could get around them."

Ranked fourth in Tuesday's MIAA Division 2 power rankings, Milton feels that its goals are with- in reach if they maintain their strong bond and continue to work hard. They have the blueprint from the Wildcats' hockey title, and a belief in each other formed both on the field and at the frozen yogurt shop.

"I think our record shows that there's a lot of trust among us," said Phaneuf. "Anybody could be on the field, you could give a pass to anybody and you trust them completely to do what needs to be done."

Corner hits

■ Newburyport arrived for last Wednesday's Cape Ann matchup at Manchester Essex in pink attire and posted a message on Insta- gram that it "stands united in support of all victims and survivors of sexual harassment and assault"

"We're just so impressed with their leadership and using their voice to stand united with one another," said fifth-year coach **Shan- non Haley**. "That was completely



WINSLOW TOWNSON FOR THE GLOBE

Elizabeth Ahearn scored a pair of goals for 12th-ranked Milton in Monday's draw with Natick.

Globe Top 20

No.	Franklin	Rec.	Last
1.	Franklin	10-0-1	2
2.	Belmont	8-0-1	4
3.	Sandwich	9-0-0	3
4.	Walpole	7-1-1	1
5.	Lincoln-Sudbury	8-0-0	5
6.	Andover	8-0-0	8
7.	Watertown	8-1-1	6
8.	Dover-Sherborn	6-0-0	7
9.	Somerset Berkley	6-1-0	9
10.	Winchester	7-1-1	12
11.	King Philip	8-2-0	10
12.	Milton	7-0-1	18
13.	Canton	7-2-0	20
14.	Dennis-Yarmouth	6-1-0	15
15.	Acton-Boxborough	6-3-0	-
16.	Concord-Carlisle	4-2-2	11
17.	Attleboro	7-2-0	17
18.	Monomoy	6-2-0	16
19.	Hingham	5-2-1	19
20.	Bishop Feehan	5-4-0	13

fuelled by our kids.

"They're really strong leaders on and off the field and we're so incredibly proud of them for uniting together."

Haley credited captains **Lottie O'Brien** and **Blaire Fox**, who "lift everyone up around them."

The team's pink theme will continue on Oct. 14 with its "Play for Pink" game vs. CAL rival Pentuck- et, in partnership with Runway for Recovery, a local organization based in Newburyport.

Newburyport is 5-1-0, its only defeat to Manchester Essex (2-0) after the graduation of a large senior class. Haley credits team chemistry on and off the field, and a commitment to supporting each other, for their great start to the season.

"Our initial instinct was that it would be a rebuilding year, and I think it's been anything but that," said Haley. "They are just a really great group of kids, and I think that their bond is really helping them to be so successful on the field."

Newburyport has three key matchups ahead: vs. No. 8 Dover-Sherborn, No. 2 Belmont, and Central Catholic.

"Our biggest thing is to always be better tomorrow than we were yesterday," said Haley.

■ Four teams in the Globe's Top 20 remain unbeaten: No. 3 Sand- wich (9-0-0), No. 5 Lincoln-Sud- bury (8-0-0), No. 6 Andover (8-0-0), and No. 8 Dover-Sherborn (6-0-0).

Top-ranked Franklin (10-0-1) has one blemish, rallying for a tie against perennial power Uxbridge.

"That was a great tie for us against a powerhouse team that has won five state championships and are ranked No. 4 in New Eng- land," said Franklin coach **Michelle Hess**. "Last year we lost, 4-0, to them, so we are just focused on keeping our momentum going and continuing to get better every day."

Senior **Ella Marzullo** recently scored her 100th career point.

■ Lincoln-Sudbury maintained its No. 1 ranking in Tuesday's Divi- sion 1 power rankings. Coach **Vicky Caburian** credits her senior leadership.

"They are truly just great lead- ers out there, great examples, high energy, high expectations, and very talented players," said Caburian.

Correspondent Inaaya Omer also contributed. Kat Cornetta can be reached at sportsgirlkat@gmail.com.

Schools

CROSS-COUNTRY	
BOYS	
CAPE & ISLANDS	
Nauset 28.....	Sandwich 31
Sturgis West 2.....	Rising Tide Charter 32
CATHOLIC CENTRAL	
Bp. Stang 16.....	Arlington Cath. 39
St. Mary's 15.....	Arlington Cath. 50
St. Mary's 20.....	Bp. Stang 39
CATHOLIC CONFERENCE	
BC High 15.....	Cath. Memorial 49
St. John's Prep 17.....	St. John's (S) 49
Xaverian 18.....	Malden Cath. 44
CMAC	
Adv. Math & Sci. 26.....	Burncoat 29
Keefe Tech 17.....	Assabet 40
Keefe Tech 15.....	Wor Tech/North 50
Parker Charter 17.....	Adv. Math & Sci. 44
MID-WACH	
Groton-Dunstable 15.....	Nashoba 42
Oakmont 19.....	Nashoba 42
PATRIOT	
Marshfield 17.....	Whit-Hanson 40
Pembroke 16.....	Hanover 50
Plymouth North 19.....	Hingham 40
NONLEAGUE	
South Shore 24.....	Bp. Feehan 33
Southeastern 23.....	Bp. Feehan 35
GIRLS	
CAPE & ISLANDS	
Sandwich 20.....	Nauset 36
Sturgis West 21.....	Rising Tide Charter 35
CATHOLIC CENTRAL	
Bp. Stang 27.....	Arlington Cath. 30
St. Mary's 21.....	Arlington Cath. 38
St. Mary's 20.....	Bp. Stang 38
CMAC	
Adv. Math & Sci. 16.....	Burncoat 47
Adv. Math & Sci. 16.....	Parker Charter 47
Keefe Tech 15.....	Assabet 40
Keefe Tech 24.....	Wor Tech/North 31
PATRIOT	
Hanover 15.....	Pembroke 44
Whit-Hanson 27.....	Marshfield 28
NONLEAGUE	
Bp. Feehan 15.....	South Shore 50
Bp. Feehan 15.....	Southeastern 50
FIELD HOCKEY	
CMAC	
Auburn 4.....	Quabog 0
Bay Path/David Prouty 2.....	Oxford 0
Hopedale 4.....	Doherty 0
St. Bernard's 5.....	Monty Tech 2
Tantasqua 6.....	Blackstone-Millville 0
Worcester South 5.....	Wor Tech/North 0
MAYFLOWER	
Westport 5.....	Wareham/Mashee 0
NORTHEASTERN	
Gloucester 1.....	Beverly 0
Masconomet 3.....	Danvers 1
Saugus 4.....	Peabody 0
Swampscott 1.....	Marblehead 0
SOUTH COAST	
Old Rochester 1.....	Joseph Case 0
Seekonk 9.....	Fairhaven 1
Somerset Berkley 9.....	Apponequet 0
SOUTH SHORE	
E. Bridgewater 7.....	Middleboro 2
Norwell 3.....	Carver 0
SUBURBAN	
S. Hadley 1.....	W. Springfield 0
TRI-VALLEY	
Ashland 2.....	Bellingham 0
Dedham 4.....	Holliston 0
Dover-Sherborn 3.....	Hopkinton 0
Medway 4.....	Medfield 1
VALLEY LEAGUE	
Smith Academy 2.....	Mohawk Trail 0
NONLEAGUE	
Belmont 5.....	Stonham 0
Franklin City Tech 5.....	Turners Falls 0
Moses Brown (R.I.) 6.....	Bp. Feehan 1
Northampton 1.....	Hampshire 1
Notre Dame (H) 2.....	Bp. Stang 0
Reading 1.....	Wilmington 0
Ursuline 10.....	Revere 0
Watertown 4.....	Arlington 0
Winchester 3.....	Burlington 0
GOLF	
BOYS	
Smith Voc. 154.....	Athol 192
BAY STATE	
Braintree 209.....	Weymouth 237
Brookline 244.....	Walpole 257
Milton 233.....	Natick 248
CAPE & ISLANDS	
Falmouth 260.....	Dennis-Yarmouth 261
Nantucket 255.....	Sturgis East 328
St. John Paul II 240.....	St. John Paul II 240
CAPE ANN	
Ham-Wenham 151.....	Amesbury 138
Ipswich 142.....	Rockport 134
Manchester 156.....	Georgetown 107
Pentucket 156.....	Lynnfield 182
CATHOLIC CENTRAL	
Abp. Williams 163.....	Bp. Feehan 212
St. Mary's 172.....	Arlington Cath. 199
CATHOLIC CONFERENCE	
Cath. Memorial 228.....	Malden Cath. 230
St. John's Prep 231.....	BC High 236
CMAC	
Auburn 156.....	Douglas 169
Doherty 165.....	Worcester Tech 168
Monty Tech 152.....	Assabet 182
Nipmuc 164.....	Hopedale 167
Tantasqua 157.....	Oxford 210
COMMONWEALTH	
Shawsheen 176.....	Mohawk Tech 133
DUAL COUNTY	
Lincoln-Sudbury 236.....	Boston Latin 263
Westford 244.....	Cambridge 245
Weston 234.....	Newton South 241
GREATER BOSTON	
Medford 39.....	Malden/Revere 32
HOCKOMOCK	
Franklin 168.....	Foxboro 170
North Attleboro 150.....	Canton 140
Oliver Ames 139.....	Mansfield 145
MAYFLOWER	
Blue Hills 6.....	Tri-County 2
MERRIMACK VALLEY	
Methuen 248.....	Dracut 254
Tewksbury 242.....	Lowell 252
MID-WACH	
Ayer Shirley 153.....	Hudson 177
Groton-Dunstable 188.....	Grafton 199
Leominster 160.....	Wachusett 161
Littleton 153.....	Bromfield 169
MIDDLESEX	
Stonham 38.....	Wilmington 34
NORTHEASTERN	
Marblehead 47.....	Gloucester 25
Saugus 49.....	Salem 23
PATRIOT	
Plymouth South 23.....	Quincy 259
Whit-Hanson 208.....	Marshfield 229
SOUTH COAST	
Old Rochester 227.....	Apponequet 270
Seekonk 261.....	Bourne 286
Somerset Berkley 263.....	Fairhaven 284
SOUTH SHORE	
Abington 143.....	Cohasset 138
Norwell 145.....	Carver 115
SUBURBAN	
Belchertown 156.....	Amherst-Pelham 165
Chicopee 156.....	Frontier 160
TRI-VALLEY	
Dover-Sherborn 205.....	Westwood 238
Norton 242.....	Hopkinton 246
Norwood 215.....	Walpole 245
Norwood 215.....	Holliston 223
Norwood 215.....	Millis 276
VALLEY LEAGUE	
Agawam 159.....	Westfield 170
Minnechaug 154.....	Longmeadow 156
W. Springfield 172.....	Southwick 202
NONLEAGUE	
Acton-Boxboro 226.....	Algonquin 240
Manchester 248.....	Barnstable 249
Card. Spellman 170.....	Rockland 166
E. Longmeadow 161.....	S. Hadley 187
Gardner 156.....	Fitchburg 192
Hampshire 160.....	Ludlow 167
King Philip 153.....	Sharon 170
Lowell Cath. 174.....	Northwest 139
St. Bernard's 142.....	Fitchburg 192
St. John's (S) 179.....	Nashoba 208
St. Mary's (Westfield) 158.....	Chicopee 244
Taunton 142.....	New Bedford 51
Westboro 221.....	Wellesley 225
Xaverian 232.....	Scituate 237
CMAC D Championship at Blissful Meadows Golf Club	
1. Auburn, 306; 2. Sutton, 314; 3. Bay Path, 333; 4. Douglas, 335; 5. Uxbridge, 347; 6. Millbury.....	
SOCCER	
BOYS	
BAY STATE	
Braintree 6.....	Needham 3
Brookline 3.....	Wellesley 3
Framingham 4.....	Walpole 1
Natick 3.....	Newton North 2
BOSTON CITY	
O'Bryan 1.....	Madison Park 1
O'Bryan 1.....	New Mills/English High 1
CAPE & ISLANDS	
Martha's Vnyd. 1.....	Nantucket 2
Nantucket 2.....	Falmouth 1
Nauset 5.....	Dennis-Yarmouth 0
St. John Paul II 4.....	Sturgis East 0
CAPE ANN	
Amesbury 3.....	Ham-Wenham 2
Essex Tech 3.....	Triton 1
Ipswich 3.....	Georgetown 2
Leominster 3.....	Wachusett 2
Newburyport 3.....	Lynnfield 0
Pentucket 2.....	N. Reading 0
CATHOLIC CONFERENCE	
BC High 7.....	Malden Cath. 1
Cath. Memorial 3.....	St. John's (S) 2
Xaverian 2.....	St. John's Prep 1
CHURCHILL	
Northampton 1.....	Agawam 0
Pittsfield 4.....	Minnechaug 1
COMMONWEALTH	
Gr. Lawrence 1.....	Shawheen 1
Innovation Academy 5.....	Lowell Cath. 4
DUAL COUNTY	
Bedford 1.....	Waltham 0
Boston Latin 1.....	Newton South 1
Lincoln-Sudbury 3.....	Cambridge 2
Wayland 2.....	Acton-Boxboro 1
Weston 2.....	Westford 1
GREATER BOSTON	
Chelsea 2.....	Malden 1
Revere 3.....	Medford 0
Somerville 5.....	Lynn English 1
HOCKOMOCK	
Foxboro 1.....	Canton 0
Franklin 1.....	Taunton 0
King Philip 1.....	North Attleboro 1
Mansfield 0.....	Oliver Ames 0
Millford 3.....	Attleboro 1
Stoughton 5.....	Sharon 4

Scoreboard

	WED 10/7	THU 10/8	FRI 10/9	SAT 10/10	SUN 10/11	MON 10/12	TUE 10/13
Home games shaded							
On the radio: Patriots, Bruins, and Revolution, WBZ-FM 98.5.							

ON THE AIR

4 p.m.	Cleveland at Chi. White Sox	TBS
6 p.m.	LA Dodgers at Atlanta	FS1
8 p.m.	Tampa Bay at NY Yankees	TBS
10 p.m.	Milwaukee at San Diego	FS1

PRO BASKETBALL

7 p.m.	Preseason: Indiana vs. Minnesota	NBA
7:30 p.m.	WNBA: New York at Atlanta	ESPN
9:30 p.m.	WNBA: Las Vegas at Golden State	NBCSN
10 p.m.	Preseason: Golden State at Portland	NBCA

COLLEGE FOOTBALL

7 p.m.	Jacksonville St. at Kennesaw St.	CBSSN
7:30 p.m.	New Mexico St. at Fla. International	ESPN2

GOLF

11 p.m.	PGA: Baycurrent Classic	Golf
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PRO HOCKEY

7:30 p.m.	Pittsburgh at Washington	TNT
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MEN'S COLLEGE SOCCER

10 p.m.	Oregon St. at Cal Baptist	ESPNU
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WOMEN'S COLLEGE VOLLEYBALL

7 p.m.	SMU at Pittsburgh	ACC
7 p.m.	Texas A&M at Oklahoma	SEC

■ For updates, go to bostonglobe.com/tvlistings

College Polls

FOOTBALL

AP Top 25 poll

The poll as of Oct. 4, with first-place votes in parentheses, records, total points based on 25 points for a first-place vote through 1 point for 25th, and last week's ranking:

	Rec.	Pts.	LW
1. Texas (61).....	4-0	1,737	1
2. Georgia (6).....	5-0	1,647	2
3. Notre Dame.....	5-0	1,532	3</

Remembered

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BY CITY AND TOWN

ARLINGTON ROSSETTI, Roberta A. (Caruso)	WEST NEWTON FISCH, Dr. Gilbert R.
BOSTON DOLAN, Ann M. (Mulhern) NEE, Daniel A.	WEST ROXBURY DOLAN, Ann M. (Mulhern) KEENAN, Margaret Susan (Davis)
HOLLISTON ROSSETTI, Roberta A. (Caruso)	WINCHESTER ROSSETTI, Roberta A. (Caruso)
HYDE PARK KEENAN, Margaret Susan (Davis)	YARMOUTH FARRINGTON, Lucille K.
JAMAICA PLAIN DOLAN, Ann M. (Mulhern) KEENAN, Margaret Susan (Davis)	YARMOUTHPORT BURMAN, Nancy Mae (Mack)
MILTON COSTIGAN, Thomas William NEE, Daniel A.	
MISSION HILL DOLAN, Ann M. (Mulhern)	OUT OF STATE
NEWTON FARRINGTON, Lucille K.	FLORIDA COSTIGAN, Thomas William FISCH, Dr. Gilbert R.
NORWOOD GROH, Mary G. (Hayes) KEENAN, Margaret Susan (Davis)	NEW HAMPSHIRE DOLAN, Ann M. (Mulhern)
ROSLUNDALE KEENAN, Margaret Susan (Davis)	OUT OF COUNTRY
SOUTH BOSTON NEE, Daniel A.	IRELAND NEE, Daniel A.

BURMAN, Nancy Mae (Mack)



Beloved mother and grandmother, passed away peacefully, on October 5, 2026, at the age of 93.

She was born on August 18, 1933, in Portland, Maine, to Jacob and Sarah Mack. She was the youngest of four siblings, Evelyn Aronson, Carl Mack and Harold Mack (now deceased). Nancy loved learning. She graduated from Brandeis University in 1954, where she met her husband, David Burman, (now deceased); and they moved to Manchester, NH, where she had three children, Jeffrey Burman, Cheri Paulson and Rhonda Perkins. Being a mother was her pride and joy. Also at that time, she taught nursery school, fostering her love for children.

Upon moving to Cape Cod to join the family clothing business, Burman's of Hyannis, Nancy partnered with her dear friend, Elaine Perkins, and founded The Tasty Morsel, a successful catering company, servicing the Cape and multiple celebrities. They also published a book, sharing their catering stories and recipes.

Nancy loved life! She enthusiastically loved her grandchildren, Zipporah and Jacob Burman, Drew Paulson and Zachary and Sarah Perkins. She loved cooking, entertaining, bridge, her book club, singing, music and art. She loved her many nieces and nephews who she called every year on their birthdays. She loved her many lifelong friends. Nancy was full of joy and could instantly light up a room with her smile and endless cheer. She will be dearly missed.

Funeral services will be on Thursday, October 8, at 11AM, Cape Cod Synagogue, 145 Winter Street, Hyannis. Donations can be made to Sawtelle Family Hospice, 320 Haverhill Street, Reading, MA 01867.

COSTIGAN, Thomas William



May 25, 1938 – October 4, 2026

Thomas William Costigan, 88, of Orlando, Florida, formerly of Milton, Massachusetts, passed away peacefully, following a short illness, surrounded by his loving family.

Born May 25, 1938, the beloved son of the late Thomas Costigan and Mary (Pardy) Costigan, Tom grew up in Milton, where he raised his family and spent most of his life. He proudly served in the United States Navy and worked for 40 years at The Boston Globe, where he was a member of Boston Typographical Union No. 13.

Tom's greatest pride was his family. He was a devoted father to his six children, and a steady presence his family could always count on. He was a hardworking, honest, and faithful man who lived with quiet strength and integrity.

Tom was preceded in death by his sister, Evelyn; and his twin brothers, William and Edward Costigan.

He is survived by his sister, Elaine (Costigan) Parks and her husband, Robert Parks of Needham, Massachusetts; his children, Kathleen Costigan, Ellen Costigan and her partner, David McDonald, Janet Costigan, John Costigan and his wife, Kerri Costigan, Theresa Costigan, Nancy (Costigan) Molla and her husband, Francis Molla, Jr.; his grandchildren, Grayson, Declan, Jeremy, Siena, Riley, Thomas and William; nieces and nephews, extended family and many friends.

A Funeral Mass will be held at St. Agatha's Church, at 10:30 a.m., Friday, October 9, 2026 followed by a repast. Private Burial Services will be held.

In lieu of flowers, memorial contributions may be made to Building Pathways, P.O. Box 3365, Windermere, FL 34786, in support of Tom's grandson, William. <https://www.building-pathways.com/pricing-plans/plans-pricing>

DOLAN, Ann M. (Mulhern)



Of West Roxbury, passed away peacefully, on October 2, 2026.

Daughter of the late James F. and Margaret (Doherty) Mulhern; Wife of the late Alfred J. Dolan. She is survived by her loving children, Mary M. Butler and her husband, Eric of West Roxbury, Kathleen A. Dolan Hermitage and her late husband, David of Weymouth, John P. Dolan and his wife, Teresa of Walpole and Ann Flanagan and her husband, Dennis of Weymouth. Cherished Nana of Jessica Creutz and her husband, Ian, Sara Hojnowski and her husband, Joseph, Cory, Annie, James, Daniel and Ryan. Great-nana of Sadie, Vanessa, Trevor and Lucas. Sister of Joseph Mulhern of Scituate and the late James F. Mulhern, Jr. Also survived by many nieces and nephews.

Ann was born and raised in Jamaica Plain. She worked many years for the telephone company, in Boston, before getting married in 1962. She enjoyed traveling to New Hampshire, to both the White Mountains and the Lakes Region. She loved shopping and playing the lottery. She was musical and knew the lyrics to many songs. Most of all, she enjoyed spending time with her family, who loved her dearly. Her family would like to thank Diana and each and every one of the caring staff at The German Center. Donations in her name may be made to The Altenheim German Center, 2222 Centre St., West Roxbury.

Relatives and friends are invited to attend. Visiting Hours will be held in the Robert J. Lawler and Crosby Funeral Home, 1803 Centre St., WEST ROXBURY, on Friday, October 9, from 4:00 to 7:00 PM. A Funeral Mass will be celebrated in St. Theresa of Avila Church, West Roxbury, on Saturday, October 10, at 11:00 AM.

Lawler & Crosby Funeral Home
www.lawlerfuneralhome.com

FARRINGTON, Lucille K.



Of Bass River and formerly of Newton, passed away, surrounded by the love of her family.

Lucille grew up in West Newton and was a loving wife, mother, grandmother, great-grandmother, sister, aunt, and friend. She was the devoted wife of Paul Farrington, who passed away almost one year before her. Lucille and Paul shared an incredible 67 years of marriage, building a life together centered around family, love, and plenty of wonderful memories.

Above all else, Lucille loved her family. She was the loving mother of Susan, Kelly and Renee; and mother-in-law to Peter, Matt and Steve. She was a proud and loving grandmother to Ryan and Amanda, Casey and Kelly, Kiley, Julia and Jack and Sarah; and a proud great-grandmother to Grace and Abby. She was also a devoted sister to Ellie Summers; and the amazing "Auntie Lu" to many.

Nothing made Lucille happier than having the people she loved close by. She loved her home and appreciated the simple things that made her happy —perfect pillows, a beautiful lawn, fabulous food, and, most of all, being surrounded by family. She even tolerated her granddogs, Darcy and Winnie, who were lucky enough to be part of it all.

Lucille will be remembered for her love of family, her devotion to Paul, her strong connection to the people and places she called home, and the many wonderful memories she leaves behind. After 67 years together, there is comfort in knowing that Lucille and Paul are together once again.

She will be deeply missed and lovingly remembered by her family, extended family, friends, and all those fortunate enough to have known her.

In place of flowers, donations may be made in Lucille's memory to St. Jude Children's Research Hospital, one of her absolute favorite charities and a cause that was especially close to her heart.

Visiting Hours will be held on Friday, October 9, from 9-10:30 am, at the Hallett Funeral Home, 273 Station Ave., SOUTH YARMOUTH, MA 02664, followed by a Funeral Mass at Saint Pius X Church, Station Ave., South Yarmouth, at 11 am. Burial at the Massachusetts National Cemetery will be private.

For online guestbook, please visit www.hallettfuneralhome.com

Visiting Hours: Friday, October 9, from 9-10:30 am

Hallett Funeral Home
273 Station Ave.
South Yarmouth, MA 02664

FISCH, Dr. Gilbert R.

Of West Palm Beach, FL, formerly of Holliston and West Newton, MA, passed away on October 1, 2026, in West Palm Beach, FL, after a short illness.

Gilbert was predeceased by his late parents, Philip and Pearl (Eisenberg) Fisch, brothers Perry Fisch and Norman Fisch, and son Robert Fisch.

For 68 years, the devoted husband of Marcia (Andelman) Fisch. Loving father to Paul Fisch (Deborah), Michael Fisch (Sudeshna), Steven Fisch (Rachel), and daughter-in-law Celia Fisch.

Beloved Grandpa Gil of Alitza, Max, Vijay, Rina, Zachary, Lauren, and Jacob.

A funeral service will be held at Temple Beth Avodah, 45 Puddingstone Lane, Newton, MA, on Sunday, October 11, 2026, at 12:00 PM, with burial to follow at Sharon Memorial Park, 40 Dedham Street, Sharon, MA.

Please refer to the Levine Chapels website for the full obituary and additional details.

Levine Chapels
617-277-8300
www.levinechapels.com

GROH, Mary G. “Gerry” (Hayes)



A longtime resident of Norwood, passed away peacefully, on Friday, October 2, 2026. She was 95. Born in Boston, she was the daughter of the late Mary A. Hayes and John C. Hayes. Beloved wife of the late Ronald D. Groh. She is survived by her niece, Deborah A. Groh; sister-in-law, Elaine Groh, both of Norwood; and many nieces, nephews, great-nieces and great-nephews. Visitation in the Gillooly Funeral Home, 126 Walpole Street (Rte. 1A), NORWOOD, on Friday, October 9, 2026, from 9-10:30 AM, prior to the Funeral Mass, which will be celebrated in St. Catherine of Siena Parish, 547 Washington Street, Norwood, at 11 o'clock. Interment will follow at Highland Cemetery, Norwood. In lieu of flowers, expressions of sympathy may be made in Gerry's memory to St. Catherine of Siena Parish or a charity of one's choice.

Gillooly Funeral Home
Norwood (781)-762-0174
www.GilloolyFuneralHome.com



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KEENAN, Margaret Susan (Davis)



Of Norwood, affectionately known throughout her life as “Suzy,” passed away on October 3, 2026, at the age of 69, peacefully surrounded by her loving family, after a period of declining health.

Suzy was, above all else, a woman of extraordinary strength. To her family, she was quite simply the strongest woman they had ever known. She faced life with determination, courage, humor, and more than a little sarcasm. Unwaveringly protective of the people she loved, Suzy was the kind of woman you always wanted in your corner. She fought with that same strength and determination until the very end.

Family was at the center of Suzy's world.

She was the loving mother of her three sons, Paul Corwin, Jr., Matthew Henkin, and Aaron Henkin; and the incredibly proud grandmother of PJ, Lyle, Violet, and Alden. Her grandchildren held an especially treasured place in her heart, and being their grandmother brought her tremendous happiness.

Suzy is survived by her loving companion, Gary Bradford. She is also survived by her siblings, Joseph, husband of the late Marilyn, John and his wife, Donna, Frank and his wife, Terri, James, husband of the late Kathy, Elizabeth and her husband, Daniel Rafferty, Barbara Bernard, wife of the late Robert; Thomas, Ann and her husband, Paul Beck and Charles and his wife, Rose Musto.

Suzy was predeceased by her parents, Joseph Davis and Babara (Martin); and siblings, Mary and her husband, Raymond Turilli, Patricia Davis and Catherine and her husband, Joseph Isbitsky.

Suzy was an aunt, great-aunt and great-great-aunt to many nieces and nephews. With a family as large as hers, the branches of her family tree stretched far and wide, but Suzy's love of family connected them all.

A proud Massachusetts woman through and through, Suzy loved where she came from. She was an avid New England Patriots fan, enjoyed a good game of Scrabble, and adored her beloved rescue dog, Marley, who wasn't simply a pet but a cherished member of her family.

Suzy devoted 32 years of her professional life to the West Roxbury, MA VA Hospital, serving in areas that included, Spinal Cord Injury, Home Care, and Cardiology. Her career was one of service, hard work, and caring for others, qualities that reflected the woman she was outside of work as well.

Those who knew Suzy will remember her strength, her quick wit and sarcasm, her loyalty, and the tremendous love she had for her family. Her sons and grandchildren will remember something even greater, the security of knowing that mom and nana were always in their corner.

Her absence leaves an enormous space in the lives of those who loved her, but so does the example she leaves behind, the strength to keep fighting, the importance of family, the ability to find humor even when life gets difficult, and the courage to stand up for and protect the people you love.

She was strong. She was funny. She was fiercely protective. She was mom. She was nana. She was Suzy. And she was deeply loved.

Family and friends are invited to honor and Celebrate Suzy's Life on Thursday, October 8, 2026, from 3:00-7:00 PM, at P.E. Murray – F.J. Higgins, George F. Doherty & Sons Funeral Home, 2000 Centre Street, WEST ROXBURY. A private Burial will take place at a later date.

In lieu of flowers, the family kindly requests that donations be made in Suzy's memory to Dana-Farber Cancer Institute, 44 Binney St., Boston, MA 02215. This will help continue the fight against the disease Suzy faced with such remarkable strength and courage. For online guestbook, pemurrayfuneral.com

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Announcements

SHEET METAL WORKERS' LOCAL UNION 17

Mourns the loss of retired member Paul Methot who passed away on September 17, 2026. He was a member of Local 17 for 37 years. Sadly missed but not forgotten.

Russell Bartash
President

NEE, Daniel A.



Of South Boston, passed away on October 4, 2026. He was born in Galway, Ireland, on October 24, 1934, to the late Patrick and Nora (Grealish) Nee. Devoted brother of the late Mary Dooley, Ann Nee, Michael Nee and Sarah Keane. Cherished uncle of Bernadette O'Sullivan, Sarah Dooley, Rosemarie Mullin, Christina Farrell, John, Francis and Gerard Dooley of Ireland; dear “Papa Danny” of Lorraine and Brian Lydon and Eileen and Jim Keaney of Milton. Long time employee of the Lenox Hotel. Visitation in the O'Brien Funeral Home, 146 Dorchester St., SOUTH BOSTON, on Thursday, October 8, from 10-11am. Followed by a Prayer Service at 11am. Relatives and friends are kindly invited to attend. Interment Blue Hill Cemetery Braintree. For directions and guestbook, please visit www.obrienfunerals.com

O'Brien Funeral Home
617-269-1600

ROSSETTI, Roberta A. (Caruso)



Of Arlington, passed away peacefully, on October 4, 2026. Devoted wife of the late Louis F. Rossetti, Jr. Loving mother of Nancy Malone and her husband, Stephen of Holliston and Linda Rossetti of Winchester; proud grandmother of Brendan Malone, Jacqui Schlesinger and William Schlesinger.

Roberta graduated from St. Aidan's, Brookline, St. Elizabeth's School of Nursing, and Boston College, and served as a nurse for over 60 years, during which she taught clinical nursing at MassBay Community College and contributed to groundbreaking geriatric research. A proud BC Eagle, she supported education and community service throughout her life. Roberta was a 60-year member of St. Agnes Parish and a passionate patron of the Boston Symphony Orchestra. She championed numerous causes, including the Dana-Farber Cancer Institute and the Museum of Science, where her late husband served as the volunteer representative on the Board of Trustees.

Special thanks to Roberta's devoted care team with whom she enjoyed many happy adventures.

Roberta was predeceased by her sister, Nancy Ferrari; and her parents, Marion (Lapp) and Tony Caruso. Many loving nieces, nephews, extended family members, and dear friends also survive her.

Visiting Hours will be held at the Keffe Funeral Home, 5 Chestnut St., Rt. 60, ARLINGTON (adjacent to Saint Agnes Church), on Thursday, October 8, 2026, from 4:00-7:00 PM. Her Funeral Mass will be held in St. Agnes Church, 30 Medford Street, Arlington, on Friday, October 9, 2026, at 11:30 AM. Relatives and friends are invited. Instead of flowers, donations may be made in Roberta's memory to the Arlington Food Pantry, www.arlingtoneats.org



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Obituaries

Eva Marie Saint, star of ‘North by Northwest’ and ‘On the Waterfront’

By Aljean Harmetz

NEW YORK TIMES

Eva Marie Saint, who won an Academy Award in 1955 for her gripping movie debut as the shy love interest of Marlon Brando's longshoreman in "On the Waterfront," and who proved equally convincing as a stylish siren opposite Cary Grant in the romantic Hitchcock thriller "North by Northwest," died Tuesday at her home in Los Angeles. She was 102.

A family representative, Jeff Sanderson, confirmed the death.

Blond and delicately beautiful — as a child, she played an angel in school pageants — Ms. Saint had been a working actress for eight years by the time she made her first movie. She learned her craft on live television dramas — which, with their three cameras and constant tumult, forced her to learn to concentrate, she said.

Her supporting performance in "On the Waterfront," which boasted one of the most impressive casts and crews ever assembled, would alone have assured her a place in movie history; the movie remains near the top of the American Film Institute's list of the country's greatest films. It won the Oscar for best picture and director (for Elia Kazan), and Brando took home the award for best actor, for his tormented performance as a former prizefighter who moonlights as muscle for a corrupt union.

Even if Brando had the most indelible lines ("I coulda been a contender"), Budd Schulberg, who won the screenwriting Oscar, said Ms. Saint had the riskiest assignment — portraying a convent-educated young woman, Edie, who simmers with passion for Brando's Terry Malloy. Edie, who discovers Terry played a role in the death of her brother, who had run afoul of union racketeers, plays a critical role waking his conscience.

Kazan said he selected Ms. Saint from among hundreds of actresses for her ability to convey the "simplicity and faith that well-brought-up Catholic girls have," but he noted that she also brought an explosive capacity for lust and an ability to keep up with Brando, a master of improvisation.

"In casting Eva Marie Saint," film critic A.H. Weiler wrote in The New York Times, "Mr. Kazan has come up with a pretty and blonde artisan who does not have to depend on these attributes. Her parochial school training is no bar to love with the proper stranger. Amid scenes of carnage, she gives tenderness and sensitivity to genuine romance."

Nine months pregnant with her first child when she picked up her Oscar at the RKO Pantages Theater in Hollywood, she told the audience, "I'm so excited I may have the baby right here." Her son was born two days later.



JOHN KOBAL FOUNDATION/GETTY IMAGES

Clockwise from above: Ms. Saint with Marlon Brando in 1954 during filming of "On the Waterfront." Both actors won Oscars for their roles in the film. Ms. Saint as Martha Kent in the movie "Superman Returns," released in 2006. Cary Grant and Ms. Saint in "North by Northwest," Alfred Hitchcock's 1959 film.



FILM FORUM

Stardom beckoned, but Ms. Saint decided to raise a family and to make only one movie a year while her two children were growing up. She later recalled turning down a three-picture deal that her agent promised would make her "a superstar." What she preferred, she reflected in 1996 to the Hollywood interviewers David Fantle and Tom Johnson, was "to be a working actress with a home life that worked."

"I have a life, and it is not lived on the set," she said. "I felt that way when I was raising my kids, and I feel that way now. I don't want make-believe children. When Donna Reed, the perfect American mother to millions of TV viewers in the 1950s, ended her show, her children were teenagers. She said to me, 'Now I'm going to get to know my kids.' I thought that was so very sad."

Nevertheless, Ms. Saint had a fruitful and celebrated career. Almost as acclaimed as her work in "On the Waterfront" was her

performance as a seductive mystery woman opposite Grant in "North by Northwest" (1959), which is also on the AFI list.

As Grant's Madison Avenue executive finds himself on the run, falsely accused of committing a high-profile murder, he finds himself seated in a train dining car with Ms. Saint. In a twist, and to his delight, she is the sexual aggressor.

"It's going to be a long night," she tells him. "And I don't particularly like the book I've started. You know what I mean?"

In later years, she said some of the easiest work in her entire professional life involved the many retakes required to film their kissing scenes.

Most of Ms. Saint's performances were intensely dramatic. She played the steadfast wife of a drug addict (Don Murray) in "A Hatful of Rain" (1957); the childhood sweetheart who loses Montgomery Clift to Elizabeth Taylor in "Raintree County" (1957); the widowed American nurse who falls in love with a

Jewish warrior (Paul Newman) during the fight to create the state of Israel in "Exodus" (1960); and the older woman who is bedded and betrayed by a young drifter (Warren Beatty) in "All Fall Down" (1962).

Portraying the wife of a mediocre artist (George Segal) who is about to run away with another woman in "Loving" (1970), Ms. Saint gave what the critic Pauline Kael called a "stunning performance in what might have been a cliché role."

"It's wonderful to see what reserves of talent performers can sometimes draw upon when they get the chance," Kael wrote, noting her ability to turn her character's "humiliating position" into one of unexpected poignancy.

When given the chance, though, Ms. Saint proved a deft comic actress, playing a secretary still half in love with her ex-husband (Bob Hope) in "That Certain Feeling" (1956) and Carl Reiner's wife in "The Russians Are Coming, the Russians Are

Coming" (1966), a Cold War farce about a New England town that thinks it's being invaded by the Soviets.

In the 1970s, when movie work grew increasingly scarce, Ms. Saint, always levelheaded and pragmatic, returned happily and successfully to television. She starred in TV movies; played Cybill Shepherd's mother in the late 1980s on the ABC comedy-drama series "Moonlighting"; and won an Emmy in 1990 as a nasty dowager in the NBC version of Dominick Dunne's biting novel about the upper crust, "People Like Us."

Eva Marie Saint, the younger of two daughters, was born in East Orange, N.J., on July 4, 1924, and grew up in Delmar, N.Y.

Her father, John Merle Saint, was an executive with B.F. Goodrich, the tire manufacturer. Her mother, Eva Marie (Rice) Saint, had been a schoolteacher.

She was a calm, almost grave, child, her mother told Cosmopolitan magazine in 1954; she



WARNER BROS.

thought her daughter had inherited her "serenity" from her father, a Quaker.

Becoming an actress was almost accidental. Ms. Saint followed her older sister, Adelaide, to Bowling Green State University in Ohio, and almost immediately found herself cast as the lead in college plays. Stunningly attractive, she was also voted "Sweater Queen" and "May Queen" by her fellow students.

She graduated in 1946 with a bachelor's degree in speech. (The university named a theater after her in 2012.) New York, and television, was the next step. Her early roles included playing a singing cheerleader in a tennis shoe commercial and, more notably, making an appearance on "Studio One" in the Ring Lardner-George S. Kaufman play "June Moon" in 1949, opposite another young hopeful, Jack Lemmon.

Playing the rebellious daughter Claudia for two years on the primetime television version of the radio soap opera "One Man's Family" earned her good money but left her discontented.

An equally discontented aspiring director, Jeffrey Hayden, invited her to lunch; they married in 1951. In the fourth decade of her marriage to Hayden, who had a long career as a television director, Ms. Saint told The Los Angeles Times: "I really don't wake up every morning and say, 'Well, now, isn't this unusual? I'm sleeping with the same man after 43 years.' I do say that you work at marriage. It doesn't just happen."

Hayden died in 2016 at 90. Ms. Saint leaves their two children, Darrell and Laurette; four grandchildren; and two great-grandchildren.

To a torrent of critical acclaim, Ms. Saint starred with Lillian Gish in Horton Foote's 1953 television play "The Trip to Bountiful," as a young woman befriended by an older one on a long bus ride. When "The Trip to Bountiful" moved to Broadway later in 1953, it was a commercial failure, but Kazan and Schulberg were in the audience at one of its 39 performances.

Foote said her "ability to transmit an inner purity" made her right for the part in "Bountiful," and that same quality, Kazan and Schulberg concurred, made her ideal for "On the Waterfront."

Well into her later years, Ms. Saint was still a working actress. She played Superman's foster mother, Martha Kent, in the movie "Superman Returns" (2006) and had a central role as a spinster librarian opposite a 10-year-old girl and a dog in "Because of Winn-Dixie" (2005).

Asked in an interview for Vanity Fair in 2011 if she ever watched her own films, Ms. Saint replied: "Sometimes I do. And I think, 'Well, gee. You did that? Good job!'"

Fred Claire, 91, former Dodgers GM who oversaw 1988 World Series champion team

By Beth Harris

ASSOCIATED PRESS

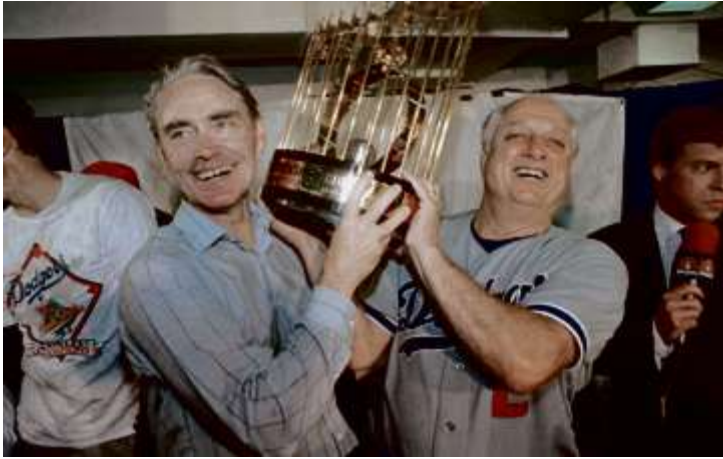
PASADENA, Calif. — Fred Claire, who parlayed early jobs as a sports writer and editor into a 30-year career with the Los Angeles Dodgers in public relations and as a World Series-winning general manager, has died. He was 91.

Mr. Claire died Monday, on his 91st birthday, in Pasadena, the team announced Tuesday. Mr. Claire had entered hospice care recently.

In January 2015, at age 80, Mr. Claire was diagnosed with squamous cell skin cancer on his lip. He had the cells removed, but the cancer later returned in his jaw and again in his neck. He had surgery to remove a nerve on the left side of his face along with several lymph nodes. He underwent radiation, chemotherapy, and immunotherapy as part of his 11-year journey with cancer.

He would jog regularly during his years on the road as the Dodgers general manager and said he was diligent about wearing sun screen except on his lips.

"Fred brought many victories and Dodger legends to our franchise, as well as the 1988 World Series title," team president Stan Kasten said in a statement, "and we are forever grateful for his leadership during such a memo-



BILL BEATTIE/ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE

Mr. Claire hoisted the Dodgers' World Series trophy with manager Tommy Lasorda following the team's 1988 win.

orable era."

Mr. Claire was covering the Dodgers during spring training in Florida for the Long Beach Press-Telegram in 1969 when one of the team's public relations assistants was fired.

He expressed interest in the job and was hired that July. He was promoted to vice president of public relations and promotions in 1975.

During his tenure, he was instrumental in creating the Dodger Blue branding and Think Blue campaign. The club drew 3.3 million fans in 1978, the first MLB team to exceed 3 million. He also hired announcer Ross Porter, who worked for the team from 1977 until being let go in

2004.

In 1976, Chicago Cubs outfielder Rick Monday ran over and saved an American fan from being burned on the Dodger Stadium field by two spectators. Mr. Claire directed the message board operator to type the words: "Rick Monday.....You Made a Great Play" on the board.

In April 1987, a public relations firestorm occurred over comments 70-year-old general manager Al Campanis made on ABC's "Nightline."

Campanis, who was white, was asked by host Ted Koppel about the lack of Black people in significant positions of authority in baseball.

"I truly believe they may not

have some of the necessities to be, let's say, a field manager, or perhaps, a general manager," Campanis said. "Why are Black people not good swimmers? Because they don't have buoyancy?"

Campanis had agreed to the interview without telling anyone in the Dodgers organization. Mr. Claire awoke the next day to a story about Campanis's comments in the newspaper.

"I couldn't believe what I was reading," he wrote in his 2004 memoir.

Campanis had been Jackie Robinson's roommate when the two were in the minor leagues in 1946, and he tutored Robinson in transitioning from shortstop to second base. Robinson broke baseball's color barrier with the Brooklyn Dodgers in 1947.

"Those who knew Al expressed shock. There had never been a hint of bigotry in anything he had ever said or done," Mr. Claire wrote. "In my view, what Al had attempted to do that night was to defend his beloved game of baseball in an area where there was no defense."

Campanis was fired after two decades as GM. Team owner Peter O'Malley handed control of one of the most storied teams in baseball to Mr. Claire. He accepted on the condition that he would have total and complete responsibility for baseball opera-

tions.

Mr. Claire wasn't intimidated, either, having been involved in discussions regarding free agents, arbitration, and team payroll since becoming a team vice president in 1975.

In his first full season as GM, the Dodgers finished with a 73-89 record in 1987. O'Malley informed Mr. Claire he was considering bringing in a more experienced person for the job. He called the New York Mets and asked for permission to speak to Joe McIlvaine, but was denied. O'Malley decided to stick with Mr. Claire.

"Fred was a talented team player and everyone in the organization enjoyed working with him," O'Malley said in a statement.

In January 1988, Mr. Claire signed Kirk Gibson and the outfielder made a huge difference in the Dodgers winning the World Series in five games over the heavily favored Oakland Athletics that fall. An injured Gibson hobbled to the plate as a pinch-hitter in the bottom of the ninth inning with the Dodgers trailing 4-3 in Game 1. He launched a two-strike, two-run homer — one of the most dramatic moments in baseball history — off closer Dennis Eckersley into the right field seats to win the game, 5-4.

Mr. Claire was named baseball's executive of the year, an award previously won by such Dodger greats as Larry MacPhail, Branch Rickey, Walter O'Malley, and Buzzie Bavasi.

The Dodgers returned to the playoffs just twice over the next decade, losing in the first round both times. It would be another 32 years before the Dodgers won the World Series again.

Among the trades that Mr. Claire was most proud of during his tenure as GM were those that brought John Shelby, Tim Lincecum, Alfredo Griffin, Jay Howell, Jesse Orosco, and John Tudor to Los Angeles — all of which had a connection with the 1988 World Series championship. He also traded for future Hall of Famer Eddie Murray in 1988 and again in 1997.

Born Fredic Marston Claire on Oct. 5, 1935, in Jamestown, Ohio, he cultivated his love of baseball while attending Cincinnati Reds games with his family at Crosley Field. He moved to Torrance, Calif., at age 15. He graduated from Torrance High, where he played junior varsity baseball and basketball. He graduated from San Jose State University with a journalism degree.

He leaves his wife, Sheryl, and children Jeff, Jennifer, and Kim.

Obituaries

Jim Bakker, 86, disgraced televangelist who was jailed for fraud

By Clyde Haberman
NEW YORK TIMES

Jim Bakker, a television evangelist who lost his popular and prosperous ministry in a 1980s sex scandal and then lost his freedom for five years, imprisoned for having violated federal laws with his conflation of God and mammon, died on Monday. He was 86.

His wife, Lori Bakker, announced the death in a statement on Mr. Bakker's official Instagram account. She did not cite a cause or say where he died. Mr. Bakker had what was described as a mild stroke in 2020.

In the 1970s and '80s, Mr. Bakker and his first wife, Tammy Faye Bakker, rode to fame and riches preaching the gospel of prosperity, the notion that those who embraced genuine Christian faith would reap material rewards. Their pulpit was the television ministry PTL, which stood for Praise the Lord and People That Love, and their appeal was a combination of sermons, songs, and tears. Both had a penchant for crying in public. Tammy Bakker wept on the air so often that she made sure her thickly applied mascara was waterproof.

The Bakkers drew as many as 13 million viewers a day and brought in yearly revenue as high as \$129 million. On a 2,500-acre site in Fort Mill, S.C., they created and sold shares in Heritage USA, a sort of Christian Disneyland, with water slides and skating to go along with prayer and Bible study.

Mr. Bakker was a gifted speaker who made no apologies for doing well in the name of the Lord. "Excess and success are close together," he said in 1985. "Anyone who is successful has got to be excessive."

By any measure, he and his wife enjoyed a life of opulence, which he defended by saying that they needed "good bait" to be effective "fishers of men." Their bait included six-figure salaries and bonuses for themselves, a 55-foot houseboat, a mini-fleet of Mercedes-Benzes and Rolls-Royces, diamonds and gold jewelry, gold-plated bathroom fixtures, an air-conditioned dog kennel, and homes and apartments in South Carolina, Florida, Tennessee, and Palm Springs, Calif. The spending was so lavish, and the ap-



LOU KRASKY/ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE



CHUCK BURTON/ASSOCIATED PRESS/FILE

peal for contributions so insistent, that some critics recast PTL as standing for Pass the Loot.

The Bakkers' world came tumbling down in 1987 with a revelation that in 1980, when he was 40, he had sex with a 21-year-old secretary in his Assemblies of God ministry. The woman, Jessica Hahn, claimed she had been raped. Mr. Bakker denied the accusation. Nonetheless, he tried to buy her silence in 1985 by tapping the PTL treasury to make a \$265,000 payoff, equivalent to roughly \$825,000 in 2026 dollars.

The transgression led to his banishment from the Assemblies of God, a Pentecostal denomination. Other evangelists turned on him. The Rev. Jerry Falwell, who took over the PTL

ministry, strongly suggested that Mr. Bakker's sins, despite his denials, included homosexual relations. With characteristic hyperbole, Falwell dismissed Mr. Bakker as "the greatest scab and a cancer on the face of Christianity in 2,000 years of church history."

Worse lay ahead for the televangelist couple. After persistent reporting on their behavior by the Charlotte Observer and a 16-month inquiry by a federal grand jury, Mr. Bakker was indicted in 1988 on 24 counts of fraud and conspiracy. During a six-week trial the following year, federal prosecutors described him as a "most brazen, accomplished con man" who had bilked the PTL faithful out of \$158 million with offers of lifetime vacations at Heritage USA

Mr. Bakker and his wife, Tammy Faye Bakker, talked to their television audience in 1986. At left, US marshals escorted Mr. Bakker from his lawyer's office to a waiting car in Charlotte, N.C., in 1989. He was charged with fraud and conspiracy.

that could not possibly have been provided. The government said that \$3.7 million had also been siphoned off to support the Bakkers' grand living.

At one point during the trial, Mr. Bakker, who in 1969 had what was described as a nervous breakdown, landed in a mental institution for observation. He was found in his lawyer's office hallucinating and cowering in a fetal position under a couch. But the proceedings soon resumed, and he was found guilty on all counts. The judge imposed a 45-year prison sentence, which came to be whittled down. After five years, Mr. Bakker was freed in 1994.

Tammy Bakker, who was never charged, did not stand by her man. Long before the trial, the marriage had been shaky, and in 1992 she divorced him. A year later she married Roe Messner, who had been a Bakker business associate and who in 1996 would be sentenced to 27 months in federal prison for bankruptcy fraud. Tammy Bakker died of cancer in 2007 at 65.

Jim Bakker tended to quote the Bible to justify his behavior

and to discredit his accusers. Interviewed, for instance, on ABC's "Nightline" in 1987, he invoked Psalms 38:12: "Those who want to kill me set their traps, those who would harm me talk of my ruin; all day long they scheme and lie." Psalms 37:4 was a go-to favorite, dovetailing with his prosperity gospel: "Take delight in the Lord, and He will give you the desires of your heart."

Over time, he came to acknowledge that his grasp of Scripture had been tenuous. In a 1996 book, "I Was Wrong," he wrote that his studies in prison had led him to understand that Jesus "did not have one good thing to say about money." He added, "When I came to the awareness that I had actually been contradicting Christ, I was horrified."

James Orsen Bakker was born in the Pentecostal faith on Jan. 2, 1940, in Muskegon, Mich. The middle name was his parents' misspelled tribute to Orson Welles, whose radio broadcast of "War of the Worlds" had been a national sensation 14 months earlier.

James was the youngest of four children of Raleigh Bakker, a machinist in a piston-ring factory, and Furnia (Irwin) Bakker, a housewife. His paternal grandfather handed out Bible readings on street corners, and his father claimed to have seen two angels while on a trip to Florida. For his part, James said he had gotten religion in his teens after he accidentally ran over a boy while driving. Upon learning that the boy would live, he said, he decided to put himself in God's hands.

After schooling in Muskegon, he attended North Central Bible College, now North Central University, in Minneapolis. There he met Tamara Faye LaValley, a fellow student, and married her in 1961 after only their third date.

The newlyweds dropped out of college and set off as itinerant evangelists. In 1966, they signed on with Pat Robertson's Christian Broadcasting Network in Portsmouth, Va., hosting a children's variety show. They were so successful that Robertson put Jim Bakker in charge of a new primetime program, "The 700 Club," whose name was derived from its goal of raising \$700 a month by way

of 70 people each contributing \$10.

The Bakkers and Robertson had a falling-out, and the couple turned elsewhere. In 1976, having moved to Charlotte, N.C., they began their PTL ministry, which came to be known also as "The Jim and Tammy Show."

Post-prison, in 2003, Mr. Bakker reemerged with yet another television program, "The Jim Bakker Show," broadcast out of a cafe in Branson, Mo., and carried by several dozen Christian-themed stations. His partner this time was his second wife, Lori Beth Graham, who had a troubled past of her own and whom he married in 1998 seven weeks after they met at an urban ministry in Los Angeles.

Mr. Bakker is survived by his wife; two children from his first marriage, Tammy Sue Chapman and Jamie Bakker; and five children whom he and Graham adopted in 2002: Maricella, Lori, Clarissa, Marie, and Ricky Bakker.

The new ministry was low-key compared with that of the Bakkers' high-flying PTL days. Its focus was different, too. The end of days was nigh, Mr. Bakker now preached, and he offered viewers what he said they would need to ride out the Apocalypse: long-lasting food, 10 buckets of it for \$600 plus shipping costs.

His message had a bluntly conservative political cast. "God has called" Donald Trump, he said. Barack Obama "sounded like the representative for Anti-christ," he said in 2016, and Hillary Clinton was "a bride of Satan."

Yet, once again, he ran afoul of officialdom by marketing a colloidal silver supplement that he had billed as a cure for assorted physical woes, including COVID-19.

Authorities in Missouri and New York ordered him in 2020 and 2021 to cease making such claims and to return \$156,000 to followers who had bought his silver solution.

Through it all, Mr. Bakker presented himself as an avatar of redemption. "I'm not back for the perfect people, the people who have it all together," he said of his ministry in 2007. "I'm here for the broken and the bruised and the hurt. I'm here to say we have a God of second and third chances."

Jeffrey Archer, at 86; British novelist whose real life rivaled his thrillers

By Alan Cowell
NEW YORK TIMES

Jeffrey Archer, a bestselling British author, politician, philanthropist, athlete, and one-time jailbird, whose resume sawed between achievement and disgrace, and who inspired abiding public fascination with headline-grabbing accounts, both fictional and personal, of ambition, self-promotion, misbehavior, and scandal, died Monday at his home in London. He was 86.

His publisher, HarperCollins, announced his death in a statement. His final novel, "Adam and Eve," about the intertwined destinies of the highborn and the humble, was scheduled for publication Tuesday.

Mr. Archer's thrillers and sagas of the rich and powerful sold hundreds of millions of copies worldwide. In his London apartment overlooking the Thames, the walls were adorned with paintings, including works by Claude Monet and Pablo Picasso.

As a host there, he became known for annual parties at which celebrity guests were served top-end Krug Champagne and lowly shepherd's pie. He also maintained homes in Mallorca and in the village of Gortchester outside Cambridge, England, where he bought the 17th-century Old Vicarage, once the home of poet Rupert Brooke. Routinely, he was reported to borrow the overseas homes of wealthy friends and acquaintances to compose the multiple first drafts of his novels.

In his days as a politician — both as a member of Parliament in the elected House of Commons and as deputy head of Margaret Thatcher's Conservative Party — he displayed a barely veiled hunger for the top job.

His friendships and alliances eventually won him a place in the unelected House of Lords with the title Baron Archer of Weston-super-Mare — his childhood hometown in southwest England.

A political Houdini, he survived many vicissitudes, including a perjury conviction in 2001 when he was found guilty of creating false diaries and concocting a story to win a trial over whether he had slept with a prostitute to whom he paid hush money.

He once said that politics was his first choice of career, but it was from his 40-plus books that he amassed wealth, starting with a novel titled "Not a Penny More, Not a Penny Less," published in 1976 after he had been defrauded of his personal fortune and stood down as a lawmaker. "I was so low I would have sold fake Gucci bags on street corners," he told the Chicago Tribune. "Once you've lost a million dollars, you may as well have lost a hundred million dollars."

A former public relations man, he turned to writing thrillers and found he had an immediate skill for quick action that connected with readers. "Where I come from in the West Country, we say 'Tell 'em a yarn, m'dear, and make 'em keep turning the pages, and you won't be far wrong,'" he explained.

His first published novel told the story of four men who banded together to defraud a con man who had robbed them of \$1 million each. Like the works that were to follow, the novel drew condescending criticism from some writers boasting more elevated literary credentials and less-padded bank accounts. Mr. Archer described himself as a storyteller, a qualification which he depicted as un-

usual and the object of resentment.

"Storytellers are very rare, but they create a lot of envy," Mr. Archer said in an interview with fellow author Anthony Horowitz for The Sunday Telegraph Magazine in 2011. "The people who survive are storytellers."

"Kane and Abel" kindled one of Mr. Archer's recurrent storylines — the rags-to-riches struggle of Abel Rosnovski, born in penury in a forest in Poland, who becomes a wealthy hotelier in the United States and archrival to William Kane, born on the same day but thousands of miles away as the scion of a wealthy banking family in New York.

Mr. Archer paid particular attention to sales of his books in the United States and went so far as to rewrite some of them specifically for the US market.

According to an unauthorized biography, "Stranger Than Fiction" (1995), by British journalist Michael Crick, he felt a greater affinity for the showbiz aspects of American public life and once said, "If I was born today and wanted to go into politics, I would want to be born in the United States."

In later years, though, he vouchsafed a less-flattering view of Americans in remarks that recalled his reputation for gaffes and blunt talking. During the presidential election campaign in 2024 in the United States, for instance, he told The Daily Telegraph he believed Donald Trump would win because "three-quarters of Americans are not intelligent."

Jeffrey Howard Archer was born in London on April 15, 1940, and grew up in Weston-super-Mare. His mother was Lola (Cook) Archer, a journalist with a column in a local newspaper and whom he described as largely "penniless."

Mr. Archer gave conflicting accounts of his father, William, whom he sometimes called a "printer," although by some accounts he was a bigamist and fraudster. Either way, he was not much of a presence in his son's life and died when Jeffrey was 11.

Mr. Archer was educated on a scholarship to a school in the county of Somerset and left with limited qualifications to train with the police and the army. He taught physical education at a school in the southeast and went on in 1963 to study for a diploma in education at the University of Oxford, where he was associated with Brasenose College.

At Oxford, he showed a flair for athletics as a sprinter and hurdler — running for the university and for his country — and for philanthropy, fundraising on behalf of the nonprofit Oxfam. A photograph from the era showed him with the Beatles, whose members he had persuaded to endorse a campaign by visiting Brasenose College. The drummer, Ringo Starr, was widely quoted as describing him as "a nice enough fella, but he's the kind of bloke who would bottle your piss and sell it." He went on later to raise funds for Iraqi Kurds.

He went into public relations and fund-raising and, in 1966, he married an Oxford chemistry undergraduate, Mary Weeden. In addition to his wife, who became a chemistry professor at the University of Cambridge, he leaves two sons, William and James, and five grandchildren.

Mr. Archer began a political career as a Conservative Party member of the Greater London Council from 1967 to 1970. He became one of the youngest lawmakers in the House of Commons in 1969, at age 29, win-

ning a special election for the district of Louth.

While a parliamentarian, he was defrauded of a major investment in a Canadian company called Aquablast and emerged with debts of some 500,000 pounds, worth millions in buying power at current exchange rates. He stepped down from Parliament rather than contest the national elections in 1974.

"I had begun to believe that everything I did was bound to be a success," he later told The Times of London. "The downfall showed me that I wasn't a god. I was a normal mortal, well able to make a bloody fool of myself, which I did."

In 1985, he became deputy chair of the Conservative Party, a high-profile, unelected position. Between the 1980s and the early 2000s, he wrote three stage plays that received uneven notices. Such was his fascination with the stage that, in 1988, he bought a controlling share in a London theater.

In his books, Mr. Archer showed a liking for multivolume series of novels revolving around central characters, such as the seven-book Clifton Chronicles charting the life and times of Harry Clifton, the son of a dockworker in southwest England, and the equally ambitious series of books such as "An Eye for an Eye" (2024) following the career of a Scotland Yard detective named William Warwick. Even in nonfiction, Mr. Archer turned two years spent in prison for perjury into a three-volume memoir called "A Prison Diary."

His jail term had its roots in a case in 1987, when Mr. Archer sued the tabloid Daily Star for libel for reporting that he had slept with a prostitute, Monica Coghlan. The judge, Bernard Caulfield, described Mr. Ar-



LEON NEAL/GETTY IMAGES/FILE

Mr. Archer was a Parliament member from 1969 to 1974.

cher's wife, Mary, as having "elegance" and "fragrance" and asked whether the writer would have needed "cold, unloving, rubber-insulated sex in a seedy hotel room." Mr. Archer won the case and was awarded 500,000 pounds in damages.

In 1992, with the support of Conservative backers including Thatcher and Prime Minister John Major, he was ennobled as Lord Archer. In 1999, he became the Conservative candidate in elections to choose a mayor of London despite never-proven allegations that he had used insider information in a deal to buy shares in Anglia Television five years earlier.

But before the vote was held, another newspaper, The News of the World, reported allegations that Mr. Archer had committed perjury at the original libel trial in 1987, forcing him to withdraw from the mayoral race.

Those charges came to trial in September 2000 and, in July 2001, he was given a four-year jail term for perjury and perverting the course of justice. After two years in a variety of correctional institutions, he was released, resuming his career as a prolific writer. He kept his title and retired from the House of Lords in 2024.

LivingArts

By James Sullivan
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

In September the band U2 announced its forthcoming album “Carnaval De Luz,” which will feature the last vocal recording from Dolly Parton, on the song “Torn.”

With any luck there will be plenty more Parton to come — outtakes from her remarkable 60-year career in music, following her death in late August at the age of 80. In the meantime, we already have one surprise gift: the joyful song “Bound to Ride,” from a forthcoming tribute album to bluegrass legends the Stanley Brothers, which dropped a couple of weeks ago.

Parton, of course, was Tennessee through and through. But this version of “Bound to Ride,” which celebrates a life in constant motion, takes a notable detour up to Boston. On the track, which was recorded a couple of years ago, Parton’s backing band is the First Ladies of Bluegrass, an acoustic supergroup led by the banjo virtuoso Alison Brown, who went to Harvard. It’s her label, Compass Records, that put together the Stanley Brothers tribute, “Where the Soul Never Dies.”

What’s more, two other members of the First Ladies, Sierra Hull and Molly Tuttle, are products of the American Roots Music Program at Berklee College of Music. All five of the First Ladies, including upright bassist Missy Raines and fiddler Becky Buller, were the first on their respective instruments to be honored as the International Bluegrass Music Association’s Instrumentalist of the Year.

Tuttle won for guitar in 2017 and again the following year, while Hull first won the IBMA Instrumentalist of the Year award for mandolin in 2016 and has since been honored six more times.

Like many Berklee students, both Hull and Tuttle were already touring musicians by the time they arrived at the college. They both graduated with degrees in an abbreviated program — Hull in 2011, Tuttle in 2015.

For more than 40 years violinist Matt Glaser has advocated on behalf of American string music and the development of the open-minded bluegrass offshoot dubbed “newgrass.” Glaser, the founding artistic director of Berklee’s American Roots Music program, has been a key part not only of Hull and Tuttle’s flourishing careers, but of hundreds of other players as well.

When Glaser first showed up at Berklee in 1981, following years of apprenticeship on the traditional folk scene of his native New York City, he plunked down in an academic environment that was deeply rooted in post-bop jazz. Hard rock guitar studies were just then making inroads in-



Sierra Hull (left) and Molly Tuttle were part of the backing band for Dolly Parton on the song “Bound to Ride.”

DAVE GREEN

Dolly Parton’s first posthumous song features Berklee alumnae Molly Tuttle and Sierra Hull

to the curriculum.

“The entire time, I’ve tried to create a safe environment for music that has not been looked upon very favorably by Western European conservatories,” Glaser said on a recent video call.

As it turns out, however, he was way ahead of his time. Having knocked around New York with superb musicians who were finding ways to modernize their beloved bluegrass, including Tony Trischka (who was Glaser’s roommate for a time) and a very young Béla Fleck (who was Trischka’s protégé), Glaser brought an expansive vision about the music to Boston.

He also brought an attitude, he said, about how music theory and performance should be taught. He’s always pushed back against the struc-

tures of the classroom — grades, syllabi, schedules. Instead, he focuses on “strengthening the bond between master musicians and younger musicians.”

His approach has earned him a bit of a reputation as a contrarian, he joked: “I’ve been the Larry David of Berklee for many decades.”

“Matt is a great ringleader,” said Tuttle in a phone conversation. “He’s a quirky, fun person who draws people together.”

Tuttle’s own touring band features Berklee alums Megan Jane on drums and newest member Chase Potter on fiddle.

Hull, born and raised in a tiny hamlet in Tennessee called Byrdstown, learned to play mandolin by ear. She signed with Rounder Records at age 13, where she was men-

tored by Alison Krauss, herself a former child prodigy. In 2009 Hull was offered a Presidential Scholarship to attend Berklee, making her the first bluegrass artist to receive the prestigious honor.

“Most of my bluegrass heroes didn’t go to any music school or conservatory,” she said. “The studious approach was a bit of a foreign thing to me.”

Unable to read music at the time, Hull recalled, “I felt like an imposter stepping into that crazy world.” She wondered: “These people are gonna understand what I really come from?”

But she quickly disavowed herself of that notion. Roger Brown, who was named Berklee president in 2004 (he stepped down in 2021), was a great advocate for the roots music pro-

Back to the ’80s with Devo, the Go-Go’s, Gang of Four, and more

By Mark Shanahan
GLOBE STAFF

There aren’t many music documentaries that Chris Slusarenko hasn’t seen, but there’s only one he’s obsessed with.

That would be “Urgh! A Music War,” an obscure 1982 concert film featuring performances by more than two dozen punk, post-punk, and New Wave bands. The movie made an enormous impression on Slusarenko when he was a kid, and as an adult he’s become something of an evangelist for the film, hosting screenings across the country and creating a podcast, “A Very Opinionated Look At ‘Urgh! A Music War.”

“It totally changed my life,” said Slusarenko, a Portland, Ore.-based musician who has played with Eyelids and Guided By Voices.

On Friday, Slusarenko and his podcast cohost, Chaki, will be at MassArt’s Tower Auditorium to screen “Urgh! A Music War” and have a conversation with drummer Hugo Burnham, whose famed post-punk band, Gang of Four, is among the 34 acts featured in the film.

“Urgh!” was filmed during a two-month period in 1980 at venues in Los Angeles, New York, England, and France. A double album of the live performances was issued a year later and the film was completed in 1982. But because “Urgh!” didn’t get a proper theatrical release, most people have only seen it, or portions of it, on “Night Flight” on cable television, on VHS tapes, or online.

The movie is a remarkable early ’80s artifact, documenting bands — many you’ve heard of, some you haven’t — whose uncommon look and sound was infinitely cooler, or at least more intriguing, than most of the music on the radio then. (Survivor’s “Eye of the Tiger” was No. 1 for six weeks in 1982.) It includes performances by Devo, Dead Kennedys, the Police, Wall of Voodoo, Or-



Clockwise from top left: Gang of Four, Devo, the Go-Go’s, and Gary Numan are among the acts who appear in the 1982 concert film “Urgh! A Music War.”

URGH! A MUSIC WAR

At Tower Auditorium, Massachusetts College of Art and Design, 621 Huntington Ave., Friday, Oct. 9, 7 p.m. Tickets: \$20 and up. tickets.24hourmusic.com

chestral Manoeuvres in the Dark, Steel Pulse, Oingo Boingo, Echo & the Bunnymen, and the Go-Go’s.

“I mean, XTC is in the film, and there’s no other band like XTC. The Cramps are in the film, and there’s no one else like the Cramps. Gary Numan’s in it, and no one else is like Gary Numan,” Slusarenko said on a recent phone call. “I was a weird kid already, but to see Pere Ubu, Gang of Four, and the Au Pairs, I was, like, ‘What the hell?!’”

On their podcast, Slusarenko and Chaki explore the origins and influence of the movie and its music, often with people — Burnham, Lesley Woods of the Au Pairs, Stan Ridgway of Wall of Voodoo, and Steve Bartek of Oingo Boingo — whose bands perform in the movie. So far, Slusarenko and Chaki have done 57 episodes devoted to the movie.

(The “Urgh!” podcast is a Patreon spinoff of Slusarenko’s other popular pod, “Revolutions Per Movie,” on which guests discuss their favorite music documentary, musical, or music-themed feature film.)

During a recent screening of “Urgh! A Music War” in San Francisco, a woman who has been friends with Slusarenko since they were in seventh grade together was in the audience. She told him she’s delighted that he hasn’t changed much since then.

“She said, ‘You’re still that 12- or 13-year-old kid wearing a Devo shirt who is obsessed with the Residents,’” Slusarenko recalled. “‘And now you’re standing on a stage and sharing all this wisdom.’”

But circumstances have changed, even if Slusarenko hasn’t.

“Watching this film as a kid was a total lifeline, but it was really lonely to watch it at home with no one to share it with,” he said. “It makes me so happy to see it with an audience, with people clapping and laughing. They find so much joy in it. It’s really kind of lovely.”

Mark Shanahan can be reached at mark.shanahan@globe.com.

NAMES

Aerosmith teases first major concerts in more than three years

By Matt Juul
GLOBE STAFF

It sounds like Aerosmith is heading back to the stage, with the Boston band bringing a few friends with them.

The legendary rockers teased their return in a clip shared on Instagram Monday. Frontman Steven Tyler teamed up with photographer Ross Halfin for a short video featuring the singer climbing a ladder to update the marquee signage outside the Hollywood Bowl to “Aerosmith & friends,” including the dates Oct. 29 and Nov. 1.

“Don’t you miss performing?” Halpin asks Tyler in the video, with the singer replying, “Of all the things that I ever missed, I miss my mind the most.”

The caption for Monday’s video promised that “all will be revealed tomorrow,” teasing an announcement for Tuesday at 10 a.m.

However, on Tuesday morning, the band only shared an outtakes clip of Tyler and Halfin from their previous video together outside of the Hollywood Bowl, once again promising more info to come.

“Should’ve known letting Steven do the marquee would take a few takes,” Aerosmith wrote in the caption for the

video posted on Tuesday. “More tomorrow.”

The likely upcoming performances would mark the band’s first major shows together in more than three years following the abrupt cancellation of Aerosmith’s 2023 “Peace Out: The Farewell Tour” due to damage Tyler suffered to his vocal cords, with the singer fracturing his larynx.

The group announced in 2024 that it was retiring from touring due to the situation, saying in a statement that “a full recovery from his vocal injury is not possible” for Tyler, prompting the band to make the “heartbreaking and difficult, but necessary, decision” to step away from touring.

Since stepping away from touring, Tyler has performed in a limited capacity in recent years, including 2025’s farewell concert for Ozzy Osbourne and Black Sabbath.

Tyler and Perry also joined YUNGBLUD for a tribute to Osbourne during the 2025 MTV Video Music Awards (Aerosmith and YUNGBLUD also released an album together last year).

Matt Juul can be reached at matthew.juul@globe.com.

Food



SLICE GUIDE
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PIZZA POINT: RONALD REAGAN DECLARED OCTOBER “NATIONAL PIZZA MONTH” VIA A PRESIDENTIAL PROCLAMATION IN 1984.

12 ESSENTIAL PIES

BY DEVRA FIRST | GLOBE STAFF

Pizza is everywhere. In every neighborhood. On practically every corner. One never need go far for pizza. This is a beautiful fact of American life.

However, there is pizza worth going far for. You know it when you taste it. These are pies you program into your driving route, even though it means going 20 minutes out of your way and there is plenty of food in the fridge. These are pies you program a weekend around, because of course you can find an excuse to be somewhere near Billerica, or Randolph, or Swampscott. Can't you?

Every few years, Globe Food makes it a point to survey the Boston-area pizza scene, to see what's new, what's great, and perhaps what isn't quite what it used to be. October is apparently National Pizza Month, as good an excuse as any to do so again. A privilege of this practice is getting to observe pizza fashion in flux. It's something you might not notice unless you immerse yourself in all the pizza that's fit to eat, because people are largely pizza creatures of habit. We find our favorites and stick with them, until there's a pressing reason to do otherwise.

For a while, Neapolitan-style pizza was the big thing. There was a thin-crust, wood-fired phase. Regionalisms like Detroit pizza joined the chat. Hot honey was everywhere. Pepperoni cups were everywhere. South Shore bar pies are eternal, but they took a star turn in the spotlight. And so on.

Here's where it's at now: Nostalgic, New York-style pies — crusty, chewy, tomato-y, somewhere between thick and thin, foldable but never droopy. Sourdough crusts, the de rigueur underpinning. Tomato pies with such vibrant flavor you don't miss the cheese. Smaller menus that laser-focus on pizza, with carefully calibrated topping combinations, plus maybe a sub or two, a few salads, and a really good chocolate chip cookie: fini. It's enough. It's perfect.

If New York-style pies have an outsize presence in pizza shops at the moment, there remain many shining examples in all styles. Where are the essential, defining pies of the Boston area today? This is the question we've spent the last months trying to answer. After eating far and wide, we've whittled it down to 12 — each one a compelling reason to break out of your pizza routine.



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

LYNWOOD CAFE

South Shore bar pizza is made in a 10-inch pan, the ideal size for one person. It has a crisp, biscuit-like crust. It has an almost buttery flavor, thanks to the cheddar-dominant cheese blend. It has crisp edges, sauce and cheese spread all the way to the pan. It is special. It is deeply regional. And Lynwood Cafe is a mecca for aficionados, serving bar-setting bar pizza in Randolph since 1949. If you want yours topped, try linguica or the bean special: baked beans, onion, and salami. Eat it here so you can enjoy the Lynwood's old-school vibe.

320 Centre St., Randolph, 781-963-3100, Instagram @lynwoodcafe



VOLO CRAFT PIZZA

This takeout-only Swampscott pizza place run by twins Dario and Claudio Paone with their parents, Tony and Josephine, serves Detroit- and New York-style pies (along with pasta, sandwiches, and more). The New York version is very good — the family first made these at Romano's, the Marblehead spot they ran for three decades — but the Detroit (above) is one of the best versions outside Michigan. It has thick, crusty edges lined in browned cheese, zesty sauce applied in stripes, and toppings that range from cupped pepperoni to pineapple, pancetta, and jalapenos.

152 Humphrey St., Swampscott, 781-584-6055, www.volopizzeria.com

BLUE SQUARE PIZZA

It started in Hopkinton, then expanded to Natick and Northborough. Blue Square is a sourdough pizzeria that otherwise refuses to pick a lane: It makes Chicago cracker thin (round and sliced into "party cut" squares), Detroit-style (covered with Wisconsin brick cheese, baked in rectangular pans, then sauced), grandma (baked in a rectangular sheet pan), and New York (round, hand-tossed) pies. They are all good, but start with the standout Detroit, with its crisp, browned edges and air-bubbled center; I like the margherita version made

with vodka sauce. Then move on to the Chicago, which is harder to find in these parts, crisp and perfect for snacking. The Gambino is irresistible, oregano-scented, strewn with cupped pepperoni and pinches of good sausage, a dollop of ricotta sitting at the center of each square. Don't expect a circus of toppings here. Blue Square's pies are made to showcase the dough.

30 Main St., Hopkinton, 508-435-0001; 1 S. Main St., Natick, 508-545-2094; 309 Main St., Northborough, 508-466-8010; www.bluesquarepizza.com



What did we miss?

Pizza in Greater Boston has never been more impressive — or more abundant or diverse. We crisscrossed the city and beyond on our hunt for 12 standout pies, but couldn't hit every single spot. So we want to hear from you about your favorites. Scan the QR code and fill out our Boston pizza survey.



REGINA PIZZERIA

You know it, you love it, you stand in line for it. The famed North End pizzeria has been producing brick-oven pies since 1926. They're classic,

and they're as wonderful as ever, with crisp, thin crusts and just the right amount of blistering and chew. They're worth the wait in the line that often wraps around the corner of the building (but you can also just order ahead).

11½ Thacher St., North End, Boston, 617-227-0765, www.pizzeriaregina.com

Continued on next page



JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

PIZZA POINT: IN 2001, PIZZA HUT DELIVERED A PIZZA TO THE INTERNATIONAL SPACE STATION.

Continued from preceding page

SI CARA
Do you like sourdough pies with just the right amount of tang, rimmed in puffy, leopard-spotted crusts? I very much do, which is why I love Si Cara. Chef Michael Lombardi (Del Posto, SRV) turns out Neapolitan-adjacent canotto-style pies, with wider, puffer BMX-tire crusts. The toppings are popping, from fried artichokes with garlic cream, pistachio, mint, and preserved lemon to potato and pesto with taleggio cheese. Find them in Cambridge or South Boston, along with natural wine. All selections are \$15 for a glass, \$60 for a bottle.

425 Massachusetts Ave., Central Square, Cambridge, 978-800-6720; 400 West Broadway, South Boston, 877-312-5709; [www.sicarapizza.com](#)



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF



LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

PIZZA PROJECT
Dan (above) and Allie Spinale started making pizza in 2021, holding pop-ups at breweries and other locations. Now the couple has a home at the Speedway in Brighton for these superb, New York-adjacent sourdough pies. The crust is thin and light, made from New England grains that

are stone-milled in Western Mass. It is very hard to choose between roasted mushroom, pepperoni with hot honey, vodka sauce, and seasonal specials that sell out (I nearly wept when I missed a late-summer peach, burrata, and prosciutto version), so it is a true service that Pizza Project allows us to order pies half-

and-half. My vote: half cheese, half white pie with ricotta, preserved lemon, pepper, and basil. I am not usually a white pie person, but for Pizza Project's I make an exception.

The Charles River Speedway, 525 Western Ave., Brighton, 617-208-8729, [www.piz-zaprojectboston.com](#)

SLICE CITY

BIG AL'S PIZZA
Word traveled fast when Big Al's opened last year: Tim Maslow, formerly of Strip-T's in Watertown and Ribelle in Brookline, was running a pizzeria in Billerica. This part of the Merrimack Valley has become something of a pie epicenter, home to worthy spots such as Joanie's in Chelmsford and Garlic Breath in North Andover. Big Al's stands out. I love the Va fa Napoli!, a tomato pie dappled with melting pools of burrata and basil. I enjoy the I'll Be an Angry 'Roni, with pepperoni, jalapenos, and hot honey. But my favorite is the traditional cheese. The crust is dusky but not burned. The cheese is charred in spots. It's in perfect proportion to the balanced sauce. Everything is in harmony. The place is cash-only, tiny, and oriented toward takeout; while you're here, don't miss the bonkers-good cheesesteak or the somehow-even-better chocolate chip cookie.

240 Nashua Road, Billerica, 978-667-6674, [www.bigalsbillerica.com](#)

OLD FRIEND
At my childhood pizzeria, those in the know always ordered a corner slice of Sicilian. So I am especially receptive to the pizza from Old Friend, baked in small pans yielding four rectangular slices. Every slice is a corner slice! The pizza splices together the DNA of Detroit, Sicilian, French bread, and bar pies, with a sprinkle of focaccia thrown in for good measure. The sauce is simple, applied lightly. The cheese crisps against the pan. But it's all about the dough, really. Fermented for three days, it's light and airy and springy. Get it topped with shredded oxtail, a rainbow of veggies, or pesto from founder Alden Cadwell's dad. The Roslindale pizza outfit is currently peripatetic; it started as a pop-up this summer and can be found at the Substation building, Exodus Bagels, the farmers' market, and more (check Instagram for up-to-date details). A brick-and-mortar is coming soon.

The Substation, 4228 Washington St., Roslindale; Exodus Bagels, 317 Belgrade Ave., Roslindale; 617-894-1539, [www.old-friendpizza.com](#). Check Instagram @old-friendpizza for location updates.

Devra First can be reached at [devra.first@globe.com](#). Follow her on Instagram @devra_first.



JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF

THE SQUARE DELI
"Massachusetts gets a bad rap for pizza, but that's not the case anymore," says Square Deli owner Chris Moreira. "There's this new wave of younger places and people doing something really special." The Everett pizza and sandwich spot has been open since 2010, but it is definitely doing something really special with its sourdough pies (and its cheesesteak, but that's a subject for another day). Two grand examples: the Grandma Flo (above), topped with "homemade meatballs, straight from the sauce" and dollops of creamy, sweet ricotta that would look at home on a wedding cake, and the Bianco Verde, an emerald collage of broccoli rabe, spinach, and several kinds of cheese. I got cat-called for these pies, crossing the street back to my vehicle: "Hey, can I please have one of your pizzas?" yelled a passerby in a pickup truck. Sorry, friend. These are mine.

421A Broadway, Everett, 617-389-9489, [www.thesquaredeli-everett.com](#)

WILLIE'S
I'm an admirer of chef Jamie Bissonnette's cooking in whatever form it comes, be it Korean cuisine or Basque pintxos. But I think Italian might be his truest metier. Willie's, in Beacon Hill, serves some pretty wonderful salads, snacks, and pasta dishes, with festive beverages to go with. But at this neighborhood joint, pizza is a passion, whether it's the perfectly pure P.C.T. (pizza con tomate with olive oil and Parmesan, a must-order), the 'Nduja (which includes not just tomato, mozzarella, sausage, and ricotta but celery root, a pizza first for me), or the pepperoni with vodka sauce. Tailor a pie to your tastes with mushrooms from the plancha, bottarga, fancy anchovies, and more. Bissonnette is in the house, focused on making these lightly charred, airy-crust beauties.

20 Charles St., Beacon Hill, Boston, 617-982-6613, [www.williesboston.com](#)



BREWER'S FORK
The dough is made by angel's hands, shaped by cherubic dimpled fingers. Either that or the folks at Brewer's Fork in Charlestown just know how to make wood-fired pizza. The Marge (you know, margherita but on a nickname basis) is inhalable. Topped pies — the Forager (above), with mushrooms, cream sauce, basil and arugula; the Puttanesca, with broccoli rabe, olives, chile flakes, and a drizzle of bagna cauda; the Cacio e Pepe, a white pizza with pepper and olive oil that's a favorite off-menu special — are creative, if sometimes oversalted. But that crust! It's pillowy and delicate, one of the tops in town.

7 Moulton St., Charlestown, 617-337-5703, [www.brewersfork.com](#)



CHATTMAN PHOTOGRAPHY

Pizzafy your food with this new spice blend

Claire Cheney, founder of North Cambridge-based Curio Spice Co., is renowned for her A-Z collection of meticulously sourced, top-quality whole spices, herbs, chiles, and extracts. But she's equally skilled at calibrating deeply fragrant spice blends that capture the flavors of a region or a specific dish.

Her latest, Pizza Tonight! (\$9.95 for 1.3 ounces), is a shortcut for cooks who want their food to taste like pizza without actually fussing over a pie themselves. The blend, which combines tomato powder, basil, garlic, parsley, oregano, and the subtle heat of Calabrian chile, is so fragrant that rubbing a few pinches between your palms perfumes the whole room.

"Our goal was to create a family-friendly spice mix that answered that ubiquitous pizza craving," Cheney says.

Sprinkle the blend over a pie (homemade, frozen, or takeout) to give it even more house-of-pizza oomph. Or shake it over mac and cheese, scrambled eggs, tater tots, popcorn, roasted vegetables, or a pot of beans — anything you wish to pizzafy.

Available at Curio Spice Co, 2265 Mass. Ave., Cambridge, 617-945-1888, and at Boston Public Market, 100 Haver St., Boston, or at [curiospice.com](#).

ANN TRIEGER KURLAND

Insider

Top-shelf pies fired from a South Shore pizza truck

There's no shortage of excellent local pizza these days. But you might not expect to find standout pies coming from a mobile pizza trailer — one that parks beside a brewery, sets up at local events, or rolls into a neighborhood to cater a backyard party.

One such roving pizzeria is Nor'Easter Pizza Co., based in Kingston. On a recent Sunday, the smoky aroma of blistered dough drifted through the parking lot outside Untold Brewery in Plymouth, where Nor'Easter's blue trailer was drawing a steady crowd. Inside, business partners Jay Layman, a former art director at America's Test Kitchen, and Brett Williams, executive chef at Hooper's Judge in Cohasset, slid 14-inch pies into a propane-fueled Gozney hearth. The oven's rolling flames blistered the pillowy crusts, creating that appealing spotty char known as leoparding.

Customers lined up to order from a menu of cleverly branded pies. Stormy picks include a white pie that pairs goat cheese with red onion, pistachios, and truffle honey ("The White Squall"); a sausage-banana pepper matchup ("Hurricane Bob"); and a classic Margherita ("The Perfect Storm"). Other creative combos feature prosciutto, figs, Gorgonzola, and arugula ("Pig and Fig"); and ground beef, pick-

le, onion, American cheese, and secret sauce ("The Molly Burger").

The dough itself is equally high-caliber — a sourdough-based mixture of finely milled Italian Tipo 00 flour, whole wheat, and semolina that Layman and Williams cold-ferment for nearly three days. Their red sauce starts with Bianco DiNapoli organic tomatoes from California; the cheese blend combines mozzarella, provolone, and aged cheddar.

"Our ingredients are upscale," says Layman.

Their attention to detail has also earned recognition beyond the Boston area. In March, the partners competed at the International Pizza Expo in Las Vegas, placing 33rd out of 110 competitors in a division that challenged participants to create a pizza using red sauce, cheese, and two toppings. Their entry — a pie topped with candied bacon and pickled Fresno chiles — helped them stand out.

As the line whittled down that Sunday, one customer had a request: "We'd like to hire you for a party."

When people taste our pizza, Layman says, "they grab a business card to book a private event later."

Nor'Easter Pizza Co. pizzas are \$20. For menu and catering information, visit [noreasterpizza.com](#).

ANN TRIEGER KURLAND

Ticket To The Arts

THEATER


OCTOBER 8-11 WANG THEATRE

THE TONY AWARD-WINNING BEST MUSICAL COMEDY IS BACK! Monty Python's SPAMALOT, which first galloped onto Broadway in 2005, was nominated for 14 Tony Awards and won 3, including Best Musical. The musical comedy lovingly ripped off from the film classic, Monty Python and the Holy Grail, SPAMALOT features well-known song titles such as "Always Look on the Bright Side of Life," "The Song That Goes Like This," "Find Your Grail," and more. Don't miss a night of pure fun at the theater! Tickets at [BOCHCENTER.ORG](#)

OPERA


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MUSIC


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Slice City

PIZZA POINT: THE AVERAGE AMERICAN EATS APPROXIMATELY 156 SLICES A YEAR.

Neapolitan

Floppy center

Small format

Minimal toppings

Soft, lightly crisp crust with leoparding (spotty char)

Foldable

New York

Hand-tossed; thin, elastic crust

South Shore Bar

“Laced” (read: “burned”) edges by request

Heavy on the cheddar

Sauce and cheese spread to the edge

The pizza lover’s style guide

Do you know a New York slice from New Haven apizza? From crust thickness to sauce placement, here are the details that make each style distinct.

BY LUIS G. RENDON AND ELIZABETH BOMZE

Beach

Square slice

Fruity, super sweet sauce

Thin crust

“Extra cheese” = a slice of provolone melted across the top

Detroit

Sauce “stripes” over cheese

Deeply caramelized edges

Rectangular slab

Thick, crispy crust

Greek

Crisp, oily crust

Thick, oregano-heavy sauce

Fluffy crumb

Sicilian

Sauce under the cheese

Thick, square

Bready, airy crumb with a crisp crust

New Haven

Famous for white clam pies (littlenecks, garlic, oregano, Pecorino Romano)

Oblong shape

Thin crust; sooty char

PIZZA POINT: IN JAPAN, CORN AND SEAWEED ARE POPULAR PIZZA TOPPINGS.

Slice City

THE CONFIDENT COOK GOOD FOOD AND KITCHEN KNOW-HOW

Pizza at home is easier than you think

By Sheryl Julian
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

As pizza-makers go, I'm in kindergarten. I bake a lot, I know how to make complicated pastries from many cuisines, so I'm not afraid of a yeast dough. At one point, I got interested enough in making pizza to buy an expensive steel for the oven to produce extra crusty dough. But when making pizza at home became something of a sport — I read about cooks using the oven cleaning setting to bake dough and other dangerous things — I lost interest.

Now pizza may be poised to become the new sourdough, engaging home cooks who aren't dough nerds. It takes some of the same skills as sourdough, but sourdough is actually trickier. If you mastered a beautiful loaf, pizza will be a walk in the park. I can tell you this firsthand. There's flour dust all over my kitchen to prove it. I've been making pan pizza, and it's the best homemade pizza I've ever had from a conventional oven.

Two comprehensive books on pizza were published this year. One is "King Arthur Baking Company's The Book of Pizza: Recipes for Every Pizza Maker" by Martin Philip and David Tamarkin with others (Simon Element books), from the Norwich, Vt. enterprise. The other is "Pizza Practice: Doughs, Techniques + Toppings," by Tara Jensen (Chronicle Books), a Maine native who now lives on a farm in Hamilton, Va.

The dough doesn't scare me; getting it off a pizza peel into the oven does. "The Book of Pizza" suggests using parchment paper. More on that shortly.

Now to the matter of making enough for a bunch of guests. One of the things I didn't like about my first foray into pizza is that you have to bake multiple pies, one after another. The crowd in the kitchen is having a wonderful time while you're constantly tending to the oven, getting everyone out of the way so you can reach in with your pizza peel. Yes, guests will offer to help, but it's still a nuisance.

I turned the page in "Pizza Practice" and found Pan Pizza, then Same-Day Pizza Dough, and my enthusiasm surged. You can make this in a variety of rectangular pans. I chose a large rimmed sheet pan (also called a half-sheet pan).

"Pan pizza hits you with comfort and crunch all at once," writes Jensen. "It's like bread and pizza had a delicious baby, and it's what I turn to for feeding a crowd or a weeknight dinner." Jensen is also the author of "Flour Power" and "A Baker's Year," about Smoke Signals Bakery, which she ran in the North Carolina mountains.

I made "Pizza Practice" Margherita Pan Pizza, which is focaccia-like, dense, and deliciously chewy, covered lightly with Uncooked Tomato Sauce (whole tomatoes crushed in a bowl with your hands), cherry tomatoes, and fresh mozzarella, torn into pieces. Once the pizza is baked, when it's hot from the oven, you pull it off the sheet and sprinkle the big rectangle with Parmesan, salt, olive oil, and basil.

You've made an impressive, gigantic pie, which can be cut into 16 generous squares. It requires about three hours of tending the dough — not constantly, but you do have to stick around. You also need a spot that's about 80 degrees. That's a little tricky in a New England kitchen. Free-standing radiators, when you heat the house, are a good place to rise dough. So is a cold oven with the oven light turned on.

Margherita toppings take very little prep and can be done in advance.

It helps to preheat a pizza steel or stone or a steel baking sheet. This makes the bottom crust crisp. My half-sheet pan, a large, rimmed baking sheet used for all kinds of roasting, gets abused and scrubbed regularly.

My first pizza stuck stubbornly to the bottom of the pan, so I emailed Jensen, the "Pizza Practice" author, to ask about using parchment paper. She signed off on the idea, and suggested the following: "I'd trim it to fit the pan so the edges don't burn or interfere with the heat reaching the bottom of the dough. Just make sure the parchment you're using is rated for the temperature at which you're baking your pizza."

Be generous with oil in the pan, she wrote. "The oil essentially fries the bottom of the dough as it bakes, which gives you that wonderful crispness."

She thought I should use the paper



SHERYL JULIAN FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

'Pizza Practice' Margherita Pan Pizza

Makes 1 half-sheet pan (12 inches by 16 inches)

"Pan pizza hits you with comfort and crunch all at once. It's like bread and pizza had a delicious baby," writes Tara Jensen in "Pizza Practice: Doughs, Techniques + Toppings." Jensen's extraordinary pan pizza — the version here is a traditional Margherita with tomatoes and mozzarella — demands a long baking schedule. Because the dough stuck the first time I made it, I lined it with parchment paper. In an email, Jensen suggested using the parchment for most of the bake, then carefully sliding the pizza out of the pan and finishing it directly on the steel. She also said not to skimp on oil in the pan: "The oil essentially fries the bottom of the dough as it bakes, which gives you that wonderful crispness." I made Jensen's Same-Day Pizza Dough, and her speedy Uncooked Tomato Sauce is simply tomatoes you crush by hand plus salt; refrigerate it for at least three hours to thicken. For equipment, you need a sturdy half-sheet pan and a pizza steel or stone. The results: focaccia-like dough that's perfect in every way, with just enough topping ingredients to make out-of-this-world pan pizza.

DOUGH

- 4 cups all-purpose flour
- ¼ teaspoon instant yeast
- 1½ cups warm water
- 2 teaspoons salt
- Extra flour (for sprinkling)
- Olive oil (for sprinkling)

1. Have on hand a half-sheet pan (12 inches by 16 inches), a dough scraper, and a pizza steel or stone or a heavy rimless baking sheet.
2. In a large bowl, combine the flour and yeast. Stir with your hand to blend and aerate them. Add all but a couple tablespoons of the water. Use your dominant hand shaped like a claw in the flour mixture, your other hand to stabilize the bowl. Stir to form a sticky dough; add the rest of the water, if needed. Grab and squeeze the dough several times until it forms a cohesive, shaggy mass. Cover and rest for 10 minutes.
3. Sprinkle the salt over the dough. Using a claw hand, pinch in the salt. The dough will tighten. Stop when the salt dissolves.
4. Sprinkle the work surface lightly with flour. Use a dough scraper to turn the dough out. With your dominant hand, push the dough away from you, then fold it back onto itself; rotate 90 degrees. Push, fold, rotate for 2 to 3 minutes, using flour as necessary to keep the dough from sticking to the surface. When the dough resists your touch, stop kneading.
5. Lightly oil a rectangular container or bowl. Add the dough and cover. Set the dough aside for 1 hour in a spot that is about 80 degrees.
6. Have a bowl of warm water near

- you. With wet fingers, working in the container, lift the dough up from the middle with both hands. One end will release from the container as you lift the dough. Let the loose end tuck under the middle of the dough. Repeat with the other end. Turn the container 90 degrees and repeat the process. Continue rotating and folding until the dough doesn't stretch or spread and the top is smooth. Cover and leave to rest for 1 hour.
7. Check the dough while it rests. It's ready when it smells yeasty and slowly springs back when gently prodded and feels like a pillow. (Add 30 minutes to the rising time, if necessary.)
 8. Sprinkle the sheet pan with olive oil. Use the dough scraper to turn the dough out, taking care not to degas it. With the pads of your fingertips, gently coax the dough toward the corners. Dip your fingers in olive oil if they're sticking to the dough. Cover and rest for 30 minutes. Continue pressing and pushing your fingers into the dough until the dough fills the pan and the corners; rest the dough when it resists and repeat the process.

TOPPING

- 1 can (about 14 ounces) whole peeled tomatoes
- ½ teaspoon salt
- 2 ounces fresh mozzarella, torn into ½-inch pieces
- 10 cherry tomatoes, halved
- 2 tablespoons freshly grated Parmesan cheese
- Small pinch of salt
- 1 tablespoon olive oil
- 6 fresh basil leaves, torn

1. In a bowl, work the tomatoes with your hands just until the large chunks are gone and the texture is irregular, with small bits of whole fruit.
 2. Cover and refrigerate for 3 hours before using.
 3. One hour before baking, set an oven rack 6 to 8 inches from the top of the oven. Set the baking steel, stone, or rimless sheet on the rack. Set the oven at 500 degrees.
 4. Spoon ½ cup of the tomato sauce down the middle of the rectangle. Use the back of a spoon to spread the sauce evenly, stopping at the rim. Use more sauce, if needed; you may have some leftover. Scatter the mozzarella and cherry tomatoes on top.
 5. Bake the pizza for 10 minutes. Rotate the pan. Lower the oven temperature to 450 degrees. Continue baking for 10 to 15 minutes, or until the underside is crispy and browned and the edges are golden. Thicker doughs will take longer. Be sure to bake the pizza thoroughly. (Total baking time is 20 to 25 minutes.)
 6. Remove the pan from the oven. Use a wide metal spatula to lift out the pizza and slide it onto a wire rack. Sprinkle with Parmesan and salt (add salt sparingly because the cheese may be salty), olive oil, and basil. Leave to cool for 5 minutes. Transfer to a cutting board and cut into squares.
- Sheryl Julian. Adapted from "Pizza Practice"

until the pizza is almost done, then slide the pie carefully out of the pan and finish it directly on the baking steel. The large rectangle is unwieldy, so I left it in the pan the whole time.

I've made six batches of her pan pizza. Each one gets a little easier. I know I need an hour here or there to rest the dough, and time to pat it into the baking sheet. I know it helps to

heat the oven for an hour with a stone (though the energy suck kills me) because the bottom of the pizza is so crisp.

I will never be sliding pizza rounds off a peel into my oven. But I'll be making this pan pizza often.

Sheryl Julian can be reached at sheryl.julian@globe.com.

PIZZA NIGHT RECIPES WHAT TO COOK THIS WEEK



SALLY PASLEY VARGAS FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Pepperoni French Bread Pizza

Serves 4

Put down that phone and make this quick French bread pizza instead. It uses a soft, slightly squishy, supermarket baguette, sliced in half crosswise and lengthwise to make four pieces. Toast them under the broiler for a minute or two. Once they're crisp, scrape the cut sides with a garlic clove and sprinkle them with dried oregano and crushed red pepper. To keep the bread crisp, spread a thin layer of cheese over the seasoned pieces and return them to the oven for a minute or two, just until the cheese melts. Now you're ready for the sauce (commercial pizza sauce or just canned crushed tomatoes), more cheese, and other toppings. Pepperoni is a favorite, but you could also add leftover cooked vegetables, bacon, or sausage. The key is not to go overboard with any of the toppings, including the sauce, so the bread stays crunchy.

- 1 large French bread (a soft supermarket baguette rather than a crusty artisan baguette), 18 to 20 inches long
- 3 tablespoons olive oil
- 1 large clove garlic, peeled
- 2 teaspoons dried oregano
- Few pinches crushed red pepper, or more to taste
- ½ cup freshly grated Parmesan cheese
- 1¼ cups shredded mozzarella, or more to taste
- About ¾ cup commercial pizza sauce, canned crushed tomatoes, or tomato sauce
- 24 slices pepperoni

Few fresh basil leaves (for garnish)

1. Position an oven rack in the top third of the oven. Turn on the broiler. Have on hand a large, rimmed baking sheet.
2. With a serrated knife, cut the bread in half crosswise. Split the halves lengthwise to make 4 pieces.
3. On a work surface, place the bread pieces cut sides down. With the heels of your hands or the baking sheet, press firmly on top of the bread pieces to flatten them slightly. Turn the bread so the cut sides are up. Place them on the baking sheet. Brush generously with olive oil.
4. Broil for 1½ to 2 minutes, watching them carefully, or until the bread is toasted and brown at the edges. Remove the bread from the oven.
5. Turn the oven temperature down to 425 degrees.
6. Scrape the cut surfaces of the bread with the garlic clove. Sprinkle each with about ½ teaspoon oregano and a pinch of red pepper. Spread 1 tablespoon of Parmesan and 2 tablespoons of mozzarella on each piece.
7. Return the baking sheet to the oven for 2 minutes, or just until the cheese melts.
8. Spoon 2 to 3 tablespoons of the sauce on each piece, add 1 tablespoon of Parmesan and 3 tablespoons of mozzarella. Add more mozzarella, if you like. Place about 6 slices of pepperoni on each piece.
9. Return to the oven. Bake for 8 to 10 minutes, or until the cheese melts and starts to brown. Top each piece with a few basil leaves. Cut into serving pieces.

Sally Pasley Vargas



KAROLINE BOEHM GOODNICK FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Greek Salad with Seared Halloumi

Serves 4

All you need to accompany pizza is a bright, tangy, leafy salad. Toss romaine with radicchio, basil, thinly sliced fennel, and black and green olives, and it's already heads above the Greek salad that comes with delivery pies. Take things to the next level with seared halloumi, the enticing, salty cheese from Cyprus that doesn't melt in the pan, but stays soft inside while crisping outside. Pizza night may never be the same.

DRESSING

- Grated rind of 1 lemon
- Juice of ½ lemon
- 3 tablespoons red wine vinegar
- ¼ cup olive oil
- 1 clove garlic, grated
- 1 tablespoon chopped fresh oregano
- Salt and pepper, to taste

1. In a bowl, combine lemon rind and juice, red wine vinegar, olive oil, garlic, oregano, and a pinch each of salt and pepper.
2. Stir well. Taste for seasoning and add more salt and pepper, if you like.

SALAD

- 1 small romaine heart, thinly sliced
- ½ head radicchio, thinly sliced
- 1 cup torn fresh basil leaves
- ½ bulb fresh fennel, thinly sliced
- ½ red onion, thinly sliced
- 1 cup mixed pitted olives, both green and black (Kalamata, for example), halved
- 3 tablespoons olive oil
- 1 pound halloumi, cut into 1-inch cubes
- Juice of ½ lemon
- 8 pickled pepperoncini peppers

1. In a large bowl, combine the romaine, radicchio, basil, fennel, red onion, and olives.
2. With your hands or salad tongs, toss well.
3. In a large skillet over medium-high heat, heat the olive oil. Add the halloumi, and cook for 3 minutes on each side, or until the cheese is golden brown all over.
4. Remove the skillet from the heat. Sprinkle the lemon juice over the cheese.
5. Add the dressing to the salad greens and toss well. Divide among 4 plates. Top each plate with pepperoncini and seared halloumi.

Karoline Boehm Goodnick

Slice City

PIZZA POINT: HAWAIIAN PIZZA WAS INVENTED BY A CANADIAN CHEF IN 1962.

It's 2 a.m. on a Saturday morning at Via Cannuccia in Dorchester. Chef Stefano Quaresima is hard at work making pizza.

"This is a labor of love, and it's only myself doing this," says Quaresima. "I have a team behind the scenes [at] dinner. But whatever is dough-related comes from my hands only."

This love affair with dough began a decade ago, when he left his chef job at Petit Robert Bistro. He set aside haute French cooking to become a private chef for wealthy clients in Chestnut Hill, where he was charged with making bread, croissants, and pizza.

But Quaresima, who grew up outside Rome, wasn't satisfied with his pies. So he traveled to the San Francisco Baking Institute to learn the intricacies of sourdough fermentation. He was hooked: the science, the precision, the timing, the delicate orchestration.

"Good pizza is about time and temperature," he says. "It's easy to mix four ingredients and make a pizza dough. But what makes pizza special is the knowledge."

With more skill and confidence, he returned to Boston and began making Roman-style pizza alla pala, oval and airy, at Via Cannuccia.

It's "fluffy as a cloud," he says.

He'll open Bottega Cannuccia this winter, serving even more pizza.

Quaresima is part of a growing number of local high-end chefs getting into the pizza game.

Last year, Jamie Mammano (Ostra, Mooo...) opened Gary's Pizza in the South End. This past spring, Jamie Bissonnette (Coppa, Little Donkey, Toro, Somaek, Zurito) added Willie's to Beacon Hill. Dan Rodriguez and Anne Thompson met at Craigie on Main; now they run Joanie's, a wildly popular New York-style pizzeria in a Chelmsford strip mall. Tim Maslow, once the maverick urban talent behind Strip-T's, Ribelle, and Whaling in Oklahoma, has Big Al's Pizza in North Billerica. Tiffani Faison has cooked high-end Italian at Orfano and Southeast Asian at Tiger Mama. But these days? The lunch crowds, construction workers, and tourists stream in for her pepperoni pie at Tenderoni's, a throwback parlor at downtown's High Street Place food hall.

Why are so many fine-dining vets turning to pie? Because it hits a sweet spot between craft, accessibility, crowd-pleasing reliability, and oftentimes, better economics.

Jinny's Pizzeria is the most profitable restaurant for Dave Punch, the Newton restaurateur who co-owns the wood-fired pizzeria with Lydia Reichert, and also runs Sycamore and Little Big Diner. Jinny's serves Neapolitan-ish pies with local ingredients.

"Volume cures all woes," Punch says, explaining that, even though each pie sells for about \$20 — far less than the steelhead trout or grilled steak he serves at Sycamore — the ROI is strong. "Labor costs are challenging these days. At Sycamore, for instance, it takes five, six, seven guys to pull off a night, whereas we can sell a record 380 pizzas at Jinny's out of a tiny little kitchen. We can do a pizza a minute, every minute, for four hours straight."

Plus, he adds, pizza ingredients are less expensive, which lowers the stakes in the kitchen, and the "formulaic" nature of stretching and topping pizza makes it "a very trainable business."

"Once you teach someone how to do that, they can do it over and over again," he says.

Various modes of distribution help, too. Jinny's has just 18 seats, but much of its business happens beyond the dining room, with customers ordering through Toast. Pizza travels — and that portability means more orders, more reach, and a stronger value proposition for both the restaurant and the customer who might prefer to eat pizza at home in PJs.

"The saying goes: Dough makes dough," Punch says.

It's a similar scenario for Joanie's in Chelmsford, where Rodriguez and Thompson rely almost entirely on takeout. Their 16-inch pies cost about \$20, and the shop sells roughly 350 per day on the weekends; on a slow Tuesday, it's about 200.

"Restaurants don't really make money, and pizza does," Rodriguez says.

The couple met in 2011 at what Thompson calls the height of owner-operated, chef-driven restaurants. Those days are over.

"The whole idea of a sit-down restaurant is really not what it used to be," Thompson says. "The uncompromising quality, the creativity, the hospitality: I think it's just so hard to make money as a restaurant now that you have to put economics first. It's really hard to run a whole operation while communicating the same passion and care on a shoestring margin."

With a small, suburban pizzeria, she says, "we can focus on making extremely high-quality, good food." Plus, Rodriguez adds, "what's beautiful about pizza is that someone can spend 20 bucks, and three people can happily eat."

Lower-cost ingredients and high volume are big pieces of the pizza economics puzzle. Another: slam-dunk reliability.

On Beacon Hill, Jamie Bissonnette pieces together the high-rent economics of his latest venture, Willie's, by sharing a kitchen with sister Spanish restaurant Zurito. The small pizzeria, part of B3 Hospitality's growing empire, also has a patio and benefits from the neighborhood's foot traffic, so Bissonnette says it didn't feel like a huge gamble.

"It's fun, but it's also safe," he says. "If you're going to spend the money to do all the infrastructure to open up a restaurant in Boston right now, pizza is a pretty safe bet in a lot of ways. You certainly don't need to have a full liquor license. At a pizzeria, you can get away with Lambrusco, beer, and some cordials and amaras. You can skirt that \$500[,000] to \$700,000 price tag," he says.

For chefs who've spent careers chasing the next big thing, there's also something satisfying about serving a food that just makes people smile. That was the appeal for Michael Lombar-



‘Dough makes dough’

Why top Boston chefs are betting on pizza

By Kara Baskin
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT



ANDREW BURKE-STEVENSON FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Chef Jamie Bissonnette's new Beacon Hill pizzeria, Willie's, shares a kitchen with his neighboring restaurant, Zurito.

di, who runs Si Cara in Cambridge and South Boston.

Lombardi has cooked in high-profile kitchens — most notably, at New York's Del Posto when the restaurant received four New York Times stars — but always adored pizza. After opening Venetian-inspired SRV in Boston, he started making pizza at home and opened Si Cara as a relatively safe passion project.

"One of the things that we talk about internally at Si Cara is just what pizza means in modern society. The first day of school, or the last day of school, or the end of Little League season is a

pizza party," says Lombardi, who grew up near the pizza capital of New Haven. "There's community around it."

Tiffani Faison also embraces that nostalgia and comfort vibe with Tenderoni's, where she's channeling the roller rinks and Pizza Huts of her youth. (The Fenway location shuttered in 2024; the original still runs at High Street Place.) The chef behind Big Heart Hospitality has opened and closed plenty of restaurants, from cocktail bars to barbecue joints. But pizza, she says, "hits on the heartstrings. It's understandable and democratic. It's not something that you neces-

sarily have to begin with a primer. People know what pizza is."

Nostalgia and familiarity are what make consumer demand for pizza much more consistent compared to fine dining, especially since so many families default to pizza during a busy week.

"You're not going to spend \$200 a person seven nights a week, but you're always going to have that one night where you're running late from an event, and you just want good food that's affordable," Lombardi says. "That's where I want Si Cara to live."

At the same time, chefs I spoke with called pizza a canvas for creativity. It gives dough obsessives something technical to geek out on: fermentation, hydration, flour, ovens, temperature, toppings. It's a universal food driven by chef-level ambition.

Consider Columbus Hospitality Group's Jamie Mammano, who opened Gary's in the South End as a place to make bread for his higher-end restaurants, such as Sorellina and Mistral. He grew up on pizza-centric Long Island, and had put a thin-crust pie on the menu at Mistral years ago. But he longed to create an elegant pizza that was also portable, and the swanky Mistral pies were not that.

"We wanted something that travels and is easy to execute," he says.

Gary's made good business sense — the space already had an oven—and his team perfected their Roman-style recipe for well over a year. Fermentation takes three days.

Meanwhile, Mario LaPosta's dough obsession starts with the flour. The chef behind da LaPosta in Newton and Portsmouth, N.H. apprenticed as a pizza-maker in Italy during college before cooking at New York City's Lupa and Babbo in Seaport. Now, he has his own

PIZZA POINT: NORWAY CONSUMES THE MOST PIZZA IN THE WORLD PER CAPITA. THE UNITED STATES IS SECOND.

Slice City



JOSH REYNOLDS FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

From left: Anne Thompson and Dan Rodríguez, owners, of Joanie's Pizza. The couple met at Craigie on Main and now run the New York style takeout shop in Chelmsford.

line of flour with Central Milling, a Utah-based company focusing on organic, whole-wheat, and specialty flours. LaPosta says making his thin, chewy pizza is a sensory experience that goes beyond cooking.

"I think that pizza almost takes it to another level, because you're touching the dough with your hands," he says. "Pizza is a little bit more intimate [than other foods] in that way ... there's an artistic standpoint that draws in chefs through that. You have some really amazing chefs that are taking dough as their canvas, if you will, and putting some pretty spectacular, unique ingredients on them."

Right now, he's experimenting with Roman-Neapolitan hybrid pizzas, trying to strike a balance between soft and crackery. His toppings include local corn, cherry tomatoes, and fresh figs.

In fact, there's so much room for pizza-fueled self-expression that chefs like Bissonnette aren't worried about oversaturation — even though Beacon Hill alone is home to roughly half a dozen pizzerias, and Andrew Blau is in the midst of opening a brick-and-mortar for his wildly popular Scrappie's Pizzeria down the street. "For me, there's always room for pizza," says Bissonnette. "Really good pizza brings more people into the neighborhood."

When a pizza enterprise doesn't work out, or a chef pivots with the menu, it might be because the concept didn't jibe well with the clientele or the neighborhood.

Colin Lynch, whose had long success in the South End with Bar Mezzana, Shore Leave, and No Relation, shuttered his 90-seat FiDo pizza at the Allston LabWorks building after a year. The pizzeria specialized in New York-style pies topped with braised greens, Calabrian chilies, and garlic honey, plus some traditional versions. There was also a pepperoni pizza-infused Negroni.

"It was the right concept in the wrong area," Lynch says. "I think if we had taken that exact restaurant and popped it in Seaport, the South End, or even Southie, it would have been a different story. If it had been a little takeout pizza place, it probably would have done better."

Lombardi switched things up at Si Cara when the food got too "cheffy," he says. People didn't want smoked trout or antipasto platters with prosciutto and cherry peppers. They wanted his Neapolitan, Canotto-style pie: puffy, lightly charred. (Si Cara means "yes, dear," in Italian.)

Prolific chef Douglass Williams no longer runs his New Haven-influenced Apizza stall amid the many vendors at Hub Hall. But he now serves pizza at his acclaimed series of MIDA restaurants, and still hopes that a small, standalone pizza shop is in his future someday.

"Pizza is just such a magical thing," says Williams. "Pizza is such a caveman, ethereal, simple thing that's not simple, but is also enjoyed by every single person. There's a reason why it's going to last forever, and hopefully it will take me to my last days."

Kara Baskin can be reached at kara.baskin@globe.com. Follow her @kcbaskin.

GETTING SALTY

‘I live and die by every pizza that I make’

Scrappie's Andrew Blau talks toppings and pepperoni fatigue

By Kara Baskin
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Beacon Hill's Andrew Blau, 29, is the mastermind behind pop-up Scrappie's, the in-demand pizza parlor that uses repurposed restaurant bread for its dough. Pies sell out quickly; customers need to order fast. But what started as a spinoff of Brick Street Bagels in Southie will become a standalone restaurant — with easier ordering — in the old Figs space (42 Charles St.) come October. He has a year-long lease.

Blau, who left a corporate job at Boston Beer Company to help run Brick Street, talks about his favorite pizza toppings, rescued bread, and the one restaurant he can't live without.

Who are you, and what do you do?

Whenever somebody asks me this question, I never really know what to say. Scrappie's started off as a little passion project. I'm also one of the owners of Brick Street Bagels. Way back when, we were only open from 7 [a.m.] to 11 [a.m.], I think, Wednesday through Sunday, so I had plenty of time on my hands.

I was working at Boston Beer, so I was used to having two jobs. The idea for Scrappie's is something that came to me before Brick Street. There's this company called Wasted in Copenhagen. They make pasta using bread scraps. I'd heard of them when I was doing some research at Boston Beer because I was big on the sustainability team over there.

I wondered if it would ever work for pizza. I started testing recipes, and I quickly found out it was going to be a lot harder than I thought. But I just walked down Charles Street and asked restaurants if there was bread that they were planning on throwing away, and they looked at me like I was crazy — and then they still gave me the bread. I think it was probably six months from when I started testing until I did my first pop-up in April 2025.

How'd it go?

The pizzas definitely weren't very good. I think the flavors were good, but the technique of the actual pizza was probably just terrible. But it's gotten a whole lot better, obviously. But up to that point, I'd never really made pizza. But it's been selling out since day one, which is cool.

Why do you think it's so popular, and what's your technique?

At first, people were really excited about the sustainability aspect, and then word of mouth kind of spread. It then turned into pizza that tasted really good, and people really wanted to get their hands on it. I'm sure being so difficult to get also played a huge part in it.

Every week, my technique would get a little bit better. I started off doing Neapolitan and then graduated into what I'm doing now, which is hard to describe. It's more like a mix between Neapolitan and New York style, but leaning more toward New York style. I definitely like to get a good amount of color on my pizzas. The crust is usually pretty dark brown because I love having that crunch, and I think that's what a lot of people are looking for. But it's very airy at the same time, which is where you get that Neapolitan aspect.

How do you determine where to get the scraps from? Do you have relationships with certain restaurants?

I built a good relationship with most of the restaurants that I get the bread from, and it's pretty consistent. Most of them are Beacon Hill. I have a couple in Southie as well, but they all ask to be anonymous.

Why?

I don't know. I just think they don't want people to know that they're throwing bread away, necessarily. Technically, it's good publicity, but I respect it. As long as I keep getting the bread, then I will respect their wishes.

How did you get into the food business?

I was what I would call a passionate home cook. I played lacrosse in college, and then all of a sudden you graduate and you're like: What else am I going to do? I got really into food in general my sophomore year of college, when my mom randomly had pneumonia one summer when I was home from school. I had to start cooking for myself and quickly fell in love with it.

Upon graduating, I did the corporate gig, and then during COVID, I think like everybody else, I re-evaluated what I wanted from work. Working at Boston Beer was fun but wasn't my passion.

My sister told me about this guy who was delivering bagels on his bike, and I reached out to him, and then we started working together, and started renting out Bar Mezzana from like 3 a.m. to 8 a.m. and then doing pop-ups, and then heading into our nine to fives. It was so much fun that I didn't care about how tired I was. I couldn't believe I got to be in the kitchen.

People wonder how to make a living in Boston



Scrappie's Andrew Blau

restaurants. How do you think you were able to make it work?

I'm very lucky. I go on a rant all the time about how hard it is to be an independent restaurateur in Boston. It's crazy with the rent, but in this space, they left all the equipment. My upfront cost was very low, and it's a year-long lease. I have a year to kind of make as many pizzas as I can. My rent is quite favorable, but if they didn't have the equipment, it probably would have been a dream that I would not have been able to do. You can take on investors, but that can always go sideways. I had to prove the concept, which I learned from Brick Street and at Scrappie's, just by doing pop-ups.

What do you think of Boston's pizza scene?

I wish I got out and had more pizza. I know Pizza Project is supposed to be incredible, and same with Square Deli in Everett. I love Picco, and apparently Posto is supposed to be pretty good.

It's surprisingly tough to find good pizza in Boston proper, especially. You're talking about things like rent and labor, and it's just hard to find places that can do that at the moment in Boston. I mean, it's just crazy how the rent is — just insane. It's hard to find people who want to put the time and effort in when they don't know if they're going to see much of a reward on the other side.

Why not make something else? Why pizza?

Pizza is just one of those things that everybody loves, more than even bagels. I can't think of a person I know who doesn't like pizza. And I think what makes a good pizza is obviously the dough. I think it's like 80 percent dough, 20 percent what you put on top of it. Dough, cheese, and sauce. I don't know why anybody wouldn't love that.

What are your favorite toppings, and what toppings do you hate?

I love a tomato pie: sauce and parm and some good olive oil. That's probably my favorite type of pizza. Kind of boring, but you get to taste actual pizza and actual dough.

I couldn't be more sick of putting pepperoni on pizza. It's just such a tedious process, but it's probably one of my best pizzas, my number-one seller, and I think it's probably the best-tasting pizza, or one of the best tasting. So it's all worth it. But putting thousands of little pepperonis on a pizza every week gets old pretty quick.

Where do you eat when you're not making pizza?

In Beacon Hill, my wife and I go to Zurito all the time, and 75 Chestnut is another great Beacon Hill spot. Where else do we eat? There's actually a pizza spot in Beacon Hill called Nino's right next to our apartment, and I go there for a slice at least once a week. It's a very nostalgic-tasting pizza. It feels like pizza from your childhood.

What do you think of pineapple on pizza?

I'm all about it. I love sweet and savory. I think all flavors need to be balanced. One of the guys who used to help me out at Scrappie's did a Hawaiian with pineapple, spam, jalapenos. Right there, you've got the saltiness from the spam, sweetness from the pineapple, and heat from the jalapenos. It doesn't make sense to me that people don't like that.

Is there any Boston restaurant that no longer exists that you really miss?

Thornton's in Fenway. My wife and I used to go for \$5 margaritas and 25-cent wings. Oh, and in Southie: The Junction. They had unbelievable wings. The honey mustard wings there were crazy.

Would you ever franchise? Do you have dreams of becoming the next Pizzeria Regina?

Absolutely not. It's another rant I could go down, but I don't think there's anything wrong with having just one location, maybe two. Becoming a consistent neighborhood spot is my dream, where everybody knows that you have an incredible reputation — but you just have one spot that you love and that's all you need.

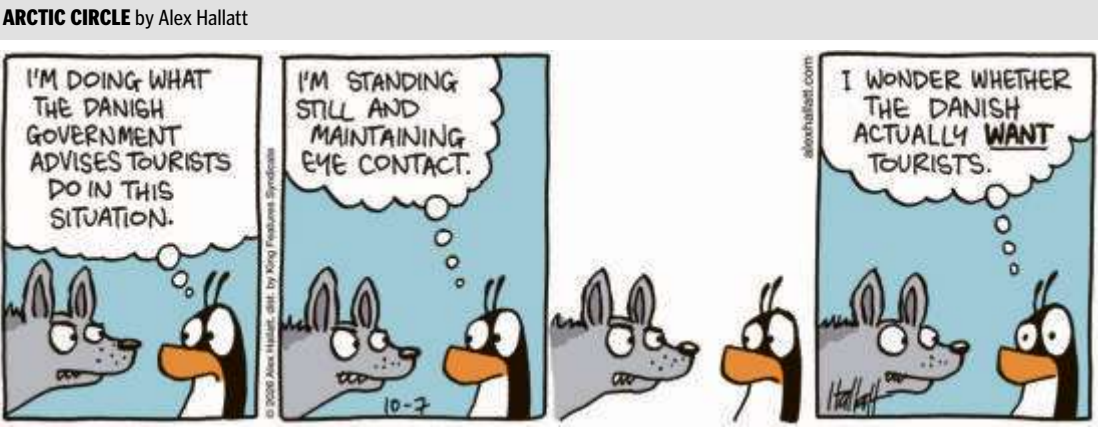
Franchising pizzas doesn't seem very interesting to me. My passion doesn't come from opening up shops. It comes from actually being in the kitchen and making the product. I live and die by every pizza that I make.

If you could open up any type of concept, what would it be?

Hot dogs. My favorite restaurant in the world is called Eats in Seekonk, which is like 10 minutes from where I grew up. There's nothing that gives me joy like a hot dog. I was actually there a couple weeks ago, and I was talking to the owner because I've been going there my entire life, and it just never disappoints. It's my favorite restaurant in the world and always will be.

Interview was edited for clarity.

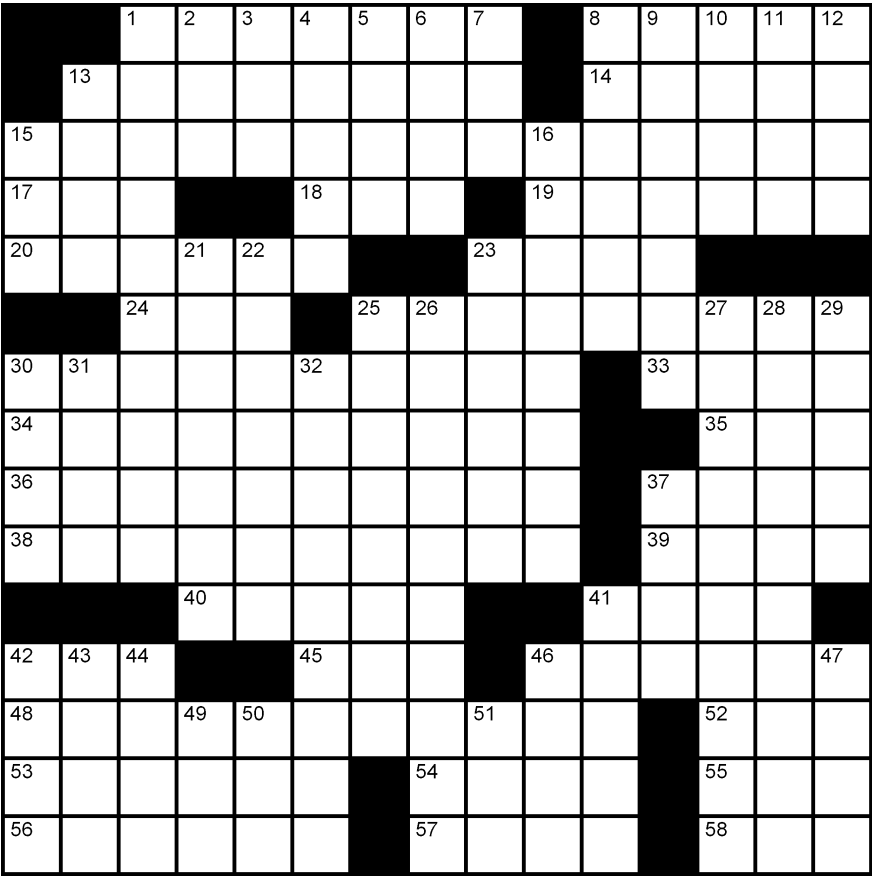
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UNIVERSAL CROSSWORD PUZZLE

FALL 2026 THEMELESS WEEK, PUZZLE 3 BY ADRIAN JOHNSON AND ALEXANDRA DOUMANI | EDITED BY DAVID STEINBERG

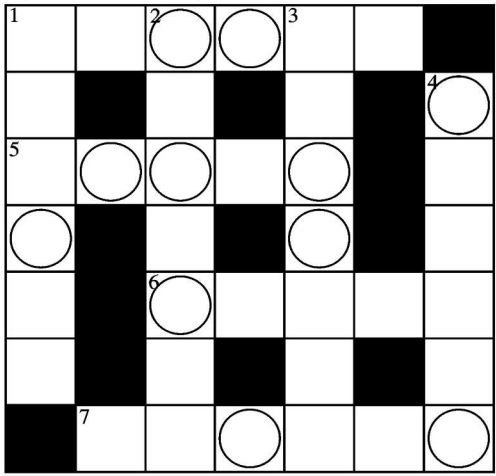
- ACROSS**
- 1 Event to declutter one's garage, perhaps
- 8 Nabisco wafer brand
- 13 Deli wrap, in a sense
- 14 Slightly beat out
- 15 "I see exactly what you're saying"
- 17 It's in vein!
- 18 Photo ____
- 19 "Gosh darn it!"
- 20 "Love your work!"
- 23 Something shown to a disrespectful guest
- 24 ____ Lanka
- 25 Voracious readers
- 30 Black Sabbath and Megadeth, for two
- 33 Decisively defeat
- 34 "No need to help me"
- 35 Longtime CBS police procedural
- 36 Garment with a series of dates on the back
- 37 Similar (to)
- 38 Turn out unhappily for all
- 39 Religious spinoff
- 40 Bow's opposite, on a ship
- 41 Search matches
- 42 M.A. seeker's exam
- 45 Not pos.
- 46 Disastrous failure
- 48 Singers' breaks?
- 52 "I Can't Breathe" singer
- 53 Apple product since 2007
- 54 Hush-hush docs
- 55 Cousin of LLC and Ltd.
- 56 "You've gone ____"
- 57 Hall of Fame running back Dorsett
- 58 Pod occupant
- DOWN**
- 1 Stop equivocating
- 2 Guitar, to a rocker
- 3 Family docs
- 4 Perched atop
- 5 For each
- 6 "We should!"
- 7 Part of a historical timeline
- 8 Person who didn't make it
- 9 By mistake
- 10 Actress Horne or Olin
- 11 ____ for life
- 12 Primates such as siamangs
- 13 Like a close guess
- 15 "Li'l ol' me?"
- 16 Li'l peeks
- 21 Pope before Leo XIV
- 22 Malady
- 23 Shohei Ohtani, for one
- 25 Traded repartee
- 26 Off-topic
- 27 One is upwardly mobile!



- 28 Local groups, concert venues, etc.
- 29 Work period
- 30 Blind rodents of song
- 31 MBA student's req.
- 32 Slinger of Singapore slings
- 37 Palestine's continent
- 41 ____ fit (tantrum)
- 42 The ability to dig in
- 43 Taken-back auto
- 44 Effect in this clue ... is clue ...
- 46 Creme caramel, by another name
- 47 Toothed whale in the dolphin family
- 49 "That sounds painful"
- 50 Messenger molecule
- 51 Unnecessary fuss

JUMBLE CROSSWORDS™

by David L. Hoyt 10-7-26



- CLUE ACROSS ANSWER**
1. Seen by the eye SIVLUA
5. ____ Sea HNRTO
6. Sibling's daughter NCEIE
7. Harsh RSVEE
- CLUE DOWN ANSWER**
1. Property defacer DLVAAN
2. Odd NTAEGSR
3. Attain HCEVIAE
4. Move back EECERD
- CLUE:** General Electric facilities discharged PCBs into the ____ for decades before the practice was banned.
- BONUS**
- Complete the crossword puzzle by looking at the clues and unscrambling the answers. When the puzzle is complete, unscramble the circled letters to solve the BONUS.
- How to play
- ©2026 Tribune Content Agency, LLC
ANSWERS: 1A-Virtual 5D-Strange 5D-Achieve 4P-Ricade 6A-Nice 7A-Sovere 1D-Vandal 2D-Straight 5A-North 6A-Nice 7A-Sovere
Send comments to DLHoyt@HoytInteractiveMedia.com

TELEVISION

What to know as merger creates Skydance Corp.



YUKI IWAMURA/AP

Skydance Corp. was created by the merger of Paramount and Warner Bros. Discovery, which closed Tuesday.

1986 library, including “The Wizard of Oz” and “Singin’ in the Rain,” plus substantial classic RKO holdings

Miramax library — partial ownership: Paramount’s 49 per-cent stake in Miramax, whose catalog includes “Pulp Fiction,” “Good Will Hunting,” and “Chi-cago”

Film and television studios

Paramount Pictures, Warner Bros. Pictures, New Line Cine-ma, DC Studios, CBS Studios, Warner Bros. Television, and Skydance’s film and television operations

Streaming services

HBO Max, featuring HBO originals such as “The Sopra-nos,” “Game of Thrones,” “The Wire,” and “Sex and the City”; Paramount+; discovery+; and Pluto TV

News

CNN, CNN International, CNN en Español, and CBS News, including “60 Minutes”

Broadcast and entertainment television

CBS and its owned local sta-tions; HBO, Showtime, Cine-max, TNT, TBS, Turner Classic Movies, Comedy Central, MTV, and BET

Reality, lifestyle, and documentary networks

Discovery Channel, HGTV, Food Network, TLC, Animal Planet, Investigation Discovery, Travel Channel, Smithsonian Channel, OWN, and Magnolia Network

Q. My brother and his wife recently cut off contact with my family, listing grievances related to what I consider to be unrealistic expectations or perceived injustices (like how quickly someone responds to their message on a group chat vs. someone else’s message). They stated they were establish-ing boundaries for their own well-being.

I value family highly and don’t think you can just decide that family isn’t family. When this brother was younger and going through personal struggles, I said as much to him, letting him know he couldn’t just push me away, I’d always be there for him.

My inclination is to respond to their message by reaching out more often and making sure they feel loved and cared for, but am I disrespecting their “boundaries” by doing that? Am I really supposed to ac-cept that they can just opt out of family?

UNBOUNDED

A. It will be helpful to think about what you consider to be being there for your brother and ask yourself if the way you express love and support is the way he receives them.

Neither of you is doing anything wrong, per se, but you clearly have different expec-tations and communication styles. Reach-ing out more often, when you’ve been ex-plicitly asked not to, won’t come across as supportive in this context; it will come across as dismissive at best.

Instead, consider writing your brother a letter acknowledging that you have heard his request and, though it makes you sad, you’ll respect it. Then put forward some-

thing that you need, whether it’s a quarterly check-in, or something lower contact that still keeps you connected in some way.

This may take time to build. He may need more space at first. That’s OK.

He’s clearly working through some hard things emotionally and trying to do what’s best for him. If you reaching out more doesn’t feel like love to him, it’s only going to make things harder.

You don’t have to lose your brother, but it will help your relationship to try to love him in the way he’s asking to be loved, even if that means loving from afar.

Q. My friend is nearly never available when I need him, despite asking for and accept-ing my help whenever he needs me.

We both have very small farms. I have hay-making equipment. In the past I have helped him with his hay, and he helps with mine. The unbalance is that it requires \$80,000 worth of my equipment, and my upkeep and setup of the equipment.

He knew I was making hay this weekend because we had spoken through text several times in the previous four days.

When I needed his help, he didn’t an-swer texts. He always has good excuses for not getting together or helping. The thing is, it isn’t until the next day, or days later, that I get a response about what wonderful, fun, or important thing he was involved in.

I found someone else I had to pay to help with the hay. The next day I got a text that he had spent the day with visiting relatives.

BIRD SIGHTINGS

winds included 3 American golden-plovers, 2 pectoral sandpipers, a Baird’s sandpiper, a South Polar skua, 2 long-tailed jaegers, 60 parasitic jaegers, 30 pomarine jaegers, a razorbill, 12 Black-legged kittiwake, 2 Sabine’s gulls, 2 lesser black-backed gulls, an Iceland gull, 5,000 common terns, 50 rose-ate terns, 70 Wilson’s storm-petrels, a Leach’s storm-petrel, 275 Northern ful-mars, 750 Cory’s shearwaters, 300 great shearwaters, 2 sooty shearwaters, 175 Manx shearwaters, 220 Northern gannets, and 2,500 tree swallows.

When the winds finally swung north-west, seabirds were piled up at First En-counter Beach in Eastham, including a long-tailed jaeger, 20 parasitic jaegers, 5 po-marine jaegers, a South Polar skua, 2 Sabi-

These guests were visiting for his son’s wed-ding and had been there for two weeks, and my wife and I consider these relatives friends as well.

He will be calling me to ask for help with his hay soon. I have decided that I will not help him in the future.

Should I wait until then to tell him how hurt I am by this action? Or because he doesn’t seem to care, just let it go?

NOT REALLY A FRIEND

A. The phrase “make hay” also means to make use of a situation in order to gain an advantage, and it certainly seems your friend is conversant in both definitions.

Were this an occasional thing, it might be easy to just chalk it up to misaligning schedules. But you’ve noticed a pattern.

It’s possible he doesn’t see the pattern, so for the sake of clarity it’s a good idea to talk to him about the imbalance you’re feel-ing. Before you do, decide if you just want him to be aware of what you’ve noticed, or if you want him to change his ways.

If it’s the latter, you might talk it out a bit and explain that while help with tasks isn’t a requirement of the friendship, his lack of availability and his willingness to ask you for your help is sending a message to you. It may not be a message he’s intending, and you may find, through conversation, that you can work out a better way to show up for each other.

R. Eric Thomas can be reached at eric@askingeric.com.

Wednesday October 7, 2026

	7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30
2	WGBH PBS	BBC News The	R. Steves	Big Cats 24/7 "Baby Boom"	NOVA "Space Wars" (N)		Secrets of the Dead		Amanpour and Company (N)	
4	WBZ CBS	Wheel (N)	Jeopardy! (N)	Survivor (N)		The Amazing Race (N)		News (N)	(:35) Comics	
5	WCVB ABC	News (N)	Chronicle	Scrubs (N)	Abbott (N) (SP)	Million Michael Keaton, Jon Lovett	Shark Tank "Diary of a Shark" (N)	NewsCenter 5 (N)	(:35) J. Kimmel	
6	WLNE ABC	Videos		Whose	Whose	Whose	Whose	Saturday Night Live	Saturday Night Live	
7	WHDH	Inside (N)	Extra (N)	Family Feud (N)	Family Feud (N)	7 News at 9PM (N)	7 News at 10PM (N)	7 News at 11PM (N)	Inside	
9	WMUR ABC	Chronicle	News (N)	Scrubs	Abbott	Million (N)	Shark Tank (N)	News (N)	J.Kimmel	
10	NBC Boston	NBC 10 Boston News at 7pm (N)		Chicago Med "Shots Fired" (N) (SP)	Chicago Fire "New Blood" (N) (SP)	Chicago P.D. (N) (SP)	Chicago P.D. (N) (SP)	Boston News (N)	(:35) J. Fallon (N)	
10	WJAR NBC	News (N)	Extra (N)	Chicago Med "Shots Fired" (N) (SP)	Chicago Fire "New Blood" (N) (SP)	Chicago P.D. (N) (SP)	Chicago P.D. (N) (SP)	News (Live)	(:35) J. Fallon (N)	
11	WENH PBS	Week-ends	Windows	Big Cats 24/7 "Baby Boom"	NOVA "Space Wars" (N)		Secrets of the Dead	Amanpour and Company (N)		
12	WPRI CBS	Wheel (N)	Jeopardy! (N)	Survivor (N)		The Amazing Race (N)		12 News at 11 (N)	(:35) Comics	
25	WFXT FOX	ET (N)	TMZ (N)	The Floor "In the Crosshairs" (N)	99 to Beat "Families on the Edge" (N)	Boston 25 News at 10PM (N) (Live)	News (Live)	(:35) News (N)		
27	WUNI	Rosa "La mujer perfecta"		Sabor a ti, entre hi "Amantes" (N)	Tierra de "Ayuda inmediata" (N)	Corazón de oro (N)	Noticias Univisión	SaborDe/ (:35) Noti..		
36	WSBE PBS	Milk Street TV	Mexican	Tim Janis: Our Natural World -- Returning to Earth		Visions of Italy, Southern Style		PBS News Hour		
38	WSBK	Big Bang	Big Bang	WBZ News 8p (N)	Patriots 1st Down	Jeopardy! (N)	Perfect (N)	Perfect (N)	Flip Side (N)	Flip Side (N)
44	WGBX PBS	Test Kitchen	Antiques	Whitstable Pearl "Hidden Treasures"	The Outlaws		Sisi: Austrian Empress		PBS News Hour (N)	
50	WWJE	Murder USA		Heartland Homicide	Killer Cases		Crime Stories		The FBI Files	
56	WLVI CW	Young Sheldon	Young Sheldon	Police 24/7 "Keep Testing Me, Man"	Great "Mother Road Country" (N)		7 News at 10PM on CW56 (N)	Modern Family	Modern Family	
64	WNAC FOX	Family Feud (N)	Family Feud (N)	The Floor "In the Crosshairs" (N)	99 to Beat "Families on the Edge" (N)		12 News on Fox Pr (N)	Seinfeld	Seinfeld	
68	WBXP ION	Blue Bloods "Open Secrets"		Blue Bloods "Insult to Injury"	Blue Bloods "Knockout Game"		Blue Bloods "Above and Beyond"		Blue Bloods "Exiles"	
PREMIUM CABLE										
Cinemax	(:20) ★★★ Batman ('89) Michael Keaton, Kim Basinger, Jack Nicholson.		(:25) ★★ Batman Returns ('92) Danny DeVito, Michael Keaton.		(:35) Batman ...					
Flix	(5:45) ★★★ Urban Cowboy ('80)		★★★★ Terms of Endearment ('83) Debra Winger, Shirley MacLaine.		(:15) ★★★ Galaxy Quest ('99) Sigourney Weaver, Alan Rickman, Tim Allen.					
HBO	(6:30) War	Youth	Lanterns		★★ Evil Dead Burn ('26) Tandi Wright, Souheila Yacoub.		(:50) ★★★ Eyes Wide Shut ('99) Tom Cruise. (P)			
HBO 2	(6:40) Lanterns	(:40) ★★★ The Departed ('06) Matt Damon, Jack Nicholson, Leonardo DiCaprio.		(:10) Jay-Z in 8	(:55) Jay-Z in 8		(:50) Youth			
Paramount-Sho	(6:15) ★★ Horrible Bosses ('11)		★★★ Rush Hour ('98) Chris Tucker, Jackie Chan.	(:45) ★★ Rush Hour 2 ('01) Chris Tucker, Jackie Chan.	(:15) ★ Rush Hour 3 ('07) Jackie Chan.					
Showtime 2	(6:10) ★★ ★ Side Effects ('13)		★★★ Magic Mike ('12) Alex Pettyfer, Channing Tatum.	(:55) ★★ Magic Mike XXL ('15) Matt Bomer, Channing Tatum.						
Starz!	★★★ Ant-Man ('15) Michael Douglas, Evangeline Lilly, Paul Rudd.		★★ Shelter ('26) Bodhi Rae, Breathnach, Jason Statham.	(:50) ★★ Pain & Gain ('13) Mark Wahlberg.						
TMC	(6:00) ★★ The Yards		★★ The Mechanic ('11) Ben Foster, Jason Statham.	(:35) ★★ Faster ('10) Billy Bob Thornton, Dwayne Johnson.	(:15) ★ The Snowman ('17) (P)					
SPORTS										
CBSSN	College Football Jacksonville State at Kennesaw State From Walens		College Football Jacksonville State at Kennesaw State From Walens		College Football Jacksonville State at Kennesaw State From Walens		College Football Jacksonville State at Kennesaw State From Walens		College Football Jacksonville State at Kennesaw State From Walens	
ESPN	WNBA Countdown (Live)		WNBA Basketball Semifinal: Teams TBA (Live)		SportsCenter (N)		SportsCenter (N)		SportsCenter (N)	
ESPN2	Football (N)		College Football New Mexico State at Florida International From Pitbull Stadium in Miami. (N) (Live)		30 for 30 The '85 Bears					
Fox Sports 1	(4:30) Baseball		Pregame (Live)		MLB Baseball Division Series: Teams TBA All the latest action from Major League Baseball. (N) (Live)		MLB on FS1 Postgame (N) (Live)			
Golf	The Smylie Show		Vanity		The Smylie Show		Vanity		PGA Tour Golf	
NBA	(5:00) Game of the Day									
NBC Sports	(6:30) Early (N)		Early Edition		Quick Snap		Tom Curran's		Quick Snap	
NESN	Rewind to '99		Martinez		Red Sox		Red Sox		Chat (N)	
FAMILY										
Cartoon	Burgers	Burgers	Burgers	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	RickMorty	RickMorty
Disney	Big City Greens	Big City Greens	Phineas and Ferb	Phineas and Ferb	Place	Phineas and Ferb	Phineas and Ferb	Kiff	Ladybug	Ladybug
Encore Family	(6:25) Running Free		★★ Last Chance Harvey ('08)	(:35) Yellowbird ('14)						
Nickelodeon	★★★ Minions ('15) Sandra Bullock.		Friends	Friends	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang	Big Bang
Nick Jr.	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	PAWPatr..	DORA (N)	DORA (N)	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig	Peppa Pig

	7 pm	7:30	8 pm	8:30	9 pm	9:30	10 pm	10:30	11 pm	11:30
BASIC CABLE										
A&E	Troopers "High-Speed Chase"		Troopers "Drugged, Drunk, & Deranged"		Alaska-Trooper "Smell of Death"		Troopers "Too Drunk To Drive"		(:05) Troopers "2-For-1 Takedown"	
AMC	★★ Child's Play ('88)		Catherine Hicks.		★ Bride of Chucky ('98)		Jennifer Tilly.		★ Seed of Chucky	
Animal Planet	Naked and Afraid		Naked and Afraid		"Toxic Redemption"		Naked and Afraid		"Return of the King"	
BBC America	Movie		★★ Judge Dredd ('95) Sylvester Stallone.		★★ Road House ('89) Kelly Lynch, Patrick Swayze.					
BET	Neighbor	Neighbor	Neighbor	Neighbor	Sistas "Hello Goodbye" (N)		Her Baby (N)	Zatima (N)	Martin	Martin
Bravo	Housewives SLC		The Real Housewives of Salt Lake City (N)		Housewives/NYC		Housewives SLC		Housewives/OC	
CMT	Mama's	Mama's	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Reba	Gold Girls	Gold Girls
CNN	OutFront (Live)		Cooper 360 (N)		The Source With (N)		CNN NewsNight		Laura (Live)	
Comedy Central	South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park	South Park	The Daily Show (N)	South Pa..
CSPAN	(6:00) Public Affairs		C-SPAN Primetime		Public Affairs Events		C-SPAN Primetime		Public Affairs Events	
CSPAN2	(6:00) Public Affairs		Public Affairs Events		Public Affairs Events		Public Affairs Events		Public Affairs Events	
Dest. America	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea	Flea
Discovery	Ghost Adventures		Ghost Adventures: Devil Island		Ghost Adv (N)		Ghost Adventures		Ghost Adventures	
Discovery Life	Hoard-Buried		Buried Al. "Randy"		Buried Al. "Bennie"		Buried Alive		Buried Al. "Valerie"	
E!	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	★★ Burlesque ('10) Christina Aguilera, Cher. (P)				
Encore	★★ How to Lose a Guy in 10 Days ('03)		★★ Sahara ('05) Matthew McConaughey.		(:10) ★ Surfer, Dude					
Food	Guy's Grocery Games		Guy's Grocery Games		Grocery "Guilty Pleasure Masters"		Grocery "Guy's Favorites"		Guy's Grocery Games	
Fox News	Ingraham (Live)		Jesse (N) (Live)		Hannity (Live)		Gutfeld! (N)		Fox News (Live)	
Freeform	(6:25) ★★★ Monsters, Inc.		★★★ Monsters University ('13) Billy Crystal.		The 700 Club					
FUSE	Eagles: The Long Road		The Beatles: In the Life		Cheaters		Cheaters		Cheaters	Cheaters
FX	(5:00) Ghostbusters		★★ Ghostbusters: Afterlife ('21) Carrie Coon.		Ghostbusters: Frozen Empire					
FXM	★★ Antebellum ('20) Janelle Monáe.		(:10) ★ Spiral: From the Book of Saw		★★ Antebellum					
Hallmark	(6:00) Kentucky Roses		A Knight to Remember ('26)		Gold Girls		Gold Girls		Gold Girls	Gold Girls
Hallmark Myst.	(6:00) Hailey Dean ...		Tipline Mysteries "Dial 1 for Murder"		Murder, She Wrote		Botched "Welcome to the Swamp" (N)		Murder, She Wrote	
HGTV	House Hunters	House Hunters	House "Buying the Last Frontier"		Sin City Rehab (N) (SP)		House Hunters		House Hunters	
History	Pawn Stars "Pawn of the Undead"		Pawn Stars (N) (SP)		Mountain Men (N) (SP)		(:05) Pawn Stars "I Don't Give a Dime"		(:05) Pawn Stars	
HLN	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic	Forensic
HSN	M. Asam Beauty		Mine Finds (N)		Beauty Report (N)		Beauty Report (N)		Mine Finds (N)	
ID	Monster "The Biker & His Bride"		American Monster "The Power Couple"		The Serial Killer Connection (N)		A Body in the Basement (N)		Body- Baseme. "Keep Me Safe"	
IFC	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men
Lifetime	Rizzoli & Isles		Rizzoli "5:26"		Rizzoli & Isles		(:05) Rizzoli & Isles		(:05) Rizzoli & Isles	
LMN	(6:00) Lonely Crime ...		Be Careful What You Say ('24)		The Killer With No Name ('24)					
MAGN	Fixer Upper		Maine		Maine		Maine		Maine	
MSNBC	The Weeknight		All in (Live)		Briefing (Live)		Last Word (Live)		The 11th (Live)	
MTV	Office	Office	Office	Office	Office	Office	Office	Office	Office	Office
National Geographic	Catch a Smuggler "Dirty Dealing"		Smuggler "Elderly Cocaine Carrier"		Contraband "Mystery Pork" (N)		Contraband Capture (N)		Catch a Smuggler "Khat Corridor"	
NatGeoWild	Secrets-Zoo		Zoo "Hiss and Hers"		Baby (N)		Baby (N)		Secrets-Zoo	
NECN	Your News (N)		Your News (N)		Your News (N)		Your News (N)		Your News (N)	
NewsNation	Vargas Report (N)		Cuomo		On Balance (N)		Katie Pavlich (N)		Jesse Web	
Ovation	Hudson & Rex		Hudson & Rex		Blue Skies		Hudson & Rex		Hudson & Rex	
OWN	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..	DreamH..
Oxygen	Dateline: Secrets		Dateline: Secrets		"Internal Affairs"		Prosecuting Evil "The Texas Seven"			
Paramount	(6:00) Jumanji: Welcome to the Jungle		★★ The Mummy ('99) Rachel Weisz, Brendan Fraser. (P)							
QVC	Holiday (N) (Live)		Kitchen (N) (Live)		Holiday Fun with Rick & Jane (N) (Live)					
Science	Catastrophes		Catastrophes		Catastrophes		Catastrophes		Catastrophes	
Sundance	Law & Order "Ambitious"		Law & Order "Admissions"		Law & Order "Refuge"		Law & Order "Gunshow"			
SyFy	(6:00) ★★ Jumanji		★★★ Matilda ('96) Mara Wilson.		The Ark (N)		★★ Jumanji ('95)			
TBS	(5:00) MLB Baseball		MLB Baseball Division Series: Teams TBA (N) (Live)							
TCM	(6:15) Hero at Large		★★ Matinee ('93) John Goodman.		★★ The 'Bubs ('89) Tom Hanks.					
TLC	ER: Ca.		ER: Ca.		ER: Ca. (N)		Save My Skin (N)		1000-lb Roomies	
TNT	NHL on T..		NHL Hockey Pittsburgh Penguins at Washington Capitals		Post-Ga..		★★ Skyscraper			
Travel	Paranormal Cam.		Paranormal Cam.		Paranormal Cam.		Paranormal Cam.		Paranormal Cam.	
TruTV	(5:00) MLB Baseball		MLB Baseball Division Series: Teams TBA (N) (Live)							
TV Land	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	(:20) Raymond		Raymond	Raymond	King	King
TV One	Sanford	Sanford	Sanford	Sanford	Sanford	Sanford	Sanford	Sanford	Sanford	Sanford
USA	9-1-1 "Haunted"		9-1-1 "Buck, Actually"		9-1-1 "Hen Begins"		9-1-1 "Merry Ex-Mas"		9-1-1 "New Beginnings"	
VH-1	Chris	Chris	Don't Be a Menace to South Central While ...		★ Blue Streak ('99) Martin Lawrence.					
WE	NCIS		NCIS		NCIS		NCIS		NCIS "Recruited"	

Content Ratings: TV-Y Appropriate for all children; TV-Y7 For children age 7 and older; TV-G General audience; TV-PG Parental guidance suggested; TV-14 May be unsuitable for children under 14; TV-MA Mature audience only Additional symbols: D Suggestive dialogue; FV Fantasy violence; L